

GM GUIDE

Pokemon Tabletop Evolution



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GM Guide Disclaimer

The purpose of this Guide is to provide suggestions on how you could run your game of PTE successfully.

You as the GM **don't need to follow the rules.** You as a GM could diverge off of anything listed here to run in a way you or your characters are comfortable with. For example, you don't need to use Cinematic Finishers, they're a suggestion.

As such, unlike the Rule Book, this document doesn't contain hard rules, more so heavy recommendations. Don't let rules lawyers force you to follow something you want to play in a different way.

Hard Rule: Using Flamethrower requires a Standard Action

Soft Rule: Increasing a bond with an NPC requires Favor Points to be gained.

We fully expect you to not run PTE like this verbatim, but we will give examples on how you can do so in a balanced manner. That being said, these are best practices and approved ways to run certain aspects of the game so if you choose to ignore them, that's on you. If you decide to give your Players overpowered homebrew Items, we will not care if you complain about power imbalances. If you want specific advice on building something specific, chances are it is in this Guide and we will just refer you here instead of reiterating.

Lastly, a lot of this Information is general GM etiquette and ways to run a campaign in which Players can enjoy. If you know how to make social connections matter as a GM and keep track of relationships, you can completely ignore sections here like Character Bonds or even Social Encounters, as you may find them more tedious to keep up with the granularity. This is solely here for people who may need an idea of how they could do that and for people like me who tend to like visible metrics of progress.

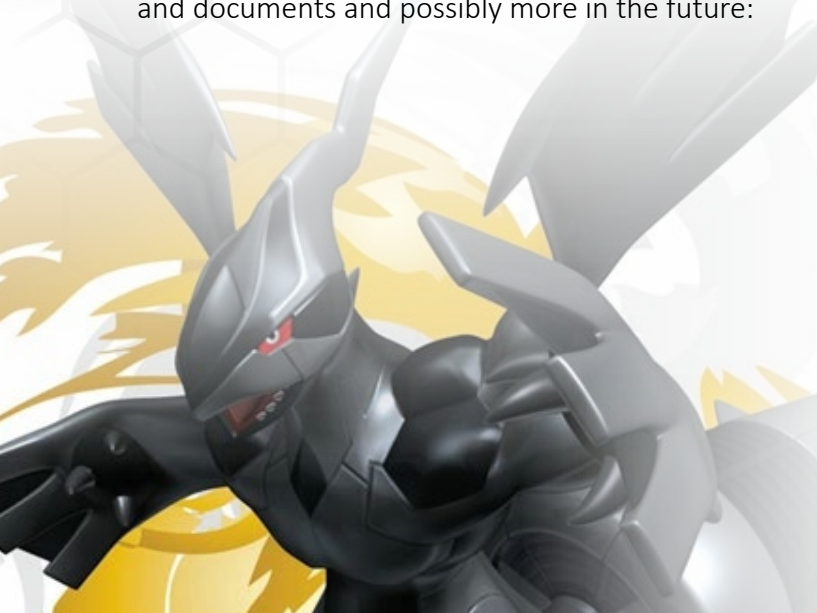
PTE Digital Tools & PDFs

All of the digital tools for the PTE System are organized in the Server Guide or the following linktree link.

<https://linktr.ee/pokemontabletopevolution>

In the link, there will be the following tools and documents and possibly more in the future:

- Rule Book** - Contains all of the rules of PTE needed to play the game
- Character Sheet** - A Digital Character Sheet to track Character Info
- Pokedex** - Contains all information for statting Pokemon
- Ability & Attack List** - Lists out the details of every Ability or Attack
- GM Guide** - This document! It contains all the GM Relevant rules of PTE
- Character Profiles** - Contains records which can be used to record NPC info
- Homebrew Compendium** - Contains all Homebrew created by Players and Devs
- Community Compendium** - Contains all associated media to PTE such as servers, podcasts, etc



Useful GM Tools

This list will be expanded each time something of value is suggested but below is a list of tools that could assist you as a GM, based on what you need:

MAP CREATION TOOLS

Dungeon Scrawl

<https://www.dungeonscrawl.com/>

Summary: Dungeon Scrawl is a web-based tool for quickly creating simple dungeon maps. It is designed for ease of use, making it ideal for creating basic layouts and floor plans for your Campaign.

Key Features: Quick old school battle map or floor plan creation.

Inkarnate

<https://inkarnate.com/>

Summary: Inkarnate is a web-based map-making tool that allows users to create detailed world maps, region maps, and battle maps.

Key Features: Detailed regional or battle map creation. Easily drag and drop image assets.

Wonderdraft

<https://www.wonderdraft.net/>

Summary: Wonderdraft is standalone software for creating high-quality fantasy maps, known for its artistic output and customization options.

Key Features: Detailed regional, world or city map creation. More advanced customization at a steeper learning curve.

BOOKKEEPING TOOLS

Obsidian Portal

<https://www.obsidianportal.com/>

Summary: Obsidian Portal is an online campaign management tool designed to help GMs organize their campaigns.

Key Features: Ability to store and share campaign notes, maps, characters and logs. Ability to create a Wiki with detailed information such as lore. Ability to upload and annotate maps with locations and history. Built in Calendar for scheduling.

World Anvil

<https://www.worldanvil.com/>

Summary: World Anvil is a world-building and campaign management tool designed to help GMs with organizing their world and campaign.

Key Features: Ability to create articles for locations, characters and world info. Interactive maps with labels and annotation for details. Timeline creation for world history. Character management for tracking characters and relationships. Ability to track and outline plots and story arcs.

VIRTUAL TABLETOPS

Roll 20

<https://roll20.net/>

Summary: Roll20 is a web-based virtual tabletop (VTT) platform that provides tools for running tabletop RPG sessions online.

Key Features: Offers an interactive digital ttrpg experience with drag and drop functionality. Provides campaign management for audio, characters and uploaded maps. Integrated voice and video chat. Can be played at no cost.

Foundry VTT

<https://foundryvtt.com/>

Summary: Foundry VTT is a standalone VTT application known for its high degree of customization and flexibility.

Key Features: Provides a fully customizable but steep learning curve for tabletop experiences. Provides all basic features plus advanced options like dynamic lighting with an in depth modding community for custom assets.

AUDIO TOOLS

Tabletop Audio

<https://tabletopaudio.com/>

Summary: Tabletop Audio is a web-based service that provides audio tracks designed specifically for TTRPGs.

Key Features: Provides ambient soundscapes designed for different settings. Provides a selection of music tracks for different scenarios. Allows for audio streaming without download. Has a customizable SoundPad for mixing and matching.

Using Modules & Homebrew

Pokemon Tabletop Evolution will eventually boast a large list of expansions, known as **Modules**, and homebrew content created by both developers and the community itself. All of this content will be organized in the Document known as the Homebrew Compendium, listed below.

[Homebrew Compendium](#)

We firmly believe that there are an infinite number of ways people prefer to play Pokemon (Look at how many fan games exist), so as such we embrace having a large list of homebrew options.

Why we built it this way- Pokemon as a concept can be implanted into any setting and still be Pokemon at the core. On one end you can have an sci-fi adventure in Ultra Space, then you could live in the past in a pre-modern era like Pokemon Legends, then you could be in a zombie apocalypse like Pokemon Snakewood. When factoring in how GMs can have their systems drastically differ, the system needed to be adaptable and be modular in nature. To accomplish this, we made the Core Rule Book be as small as possible and detached any other mechanics we deemed as [optional]. This would allow the base ruleset to be easily learned and any custom content could be plugged in without breaking anything.

When creating your campaign, you should briefly skim any homebrew or module options in that document to see if anything interests you and if it does, pluck it from the document and use it in your Campaign! Just remember that if you choose to use part of a homebrew, you don't need to allow the entire thing. You could like the breeding rules from the [future] Artisanry Module, but want to ignore the fishing and mining mechanics. These Modules are built with the intent to pick and choose how you want to run the game.

Below is a list of all the Modules that are planned to be released at some point during PTE's development period, along with a general description.

The Path of the Mundane - This Module follows rules on how Trainers can be built if you do not want Trainers to contribute to battles physically. If you do not want your Players to be punching or throwing fireballs at Nidokings, use this ruleset alteration. This will also massively quicken combat by halving participants.

The Path of Lethality - This Module provides rules on how to make a more lethal Campaign. It introduces concepts such as Injuries and Character

Death that should be left to narrative only in most Campaigns.

The Path of Elementalism - This Module provides a list of rules and bonus classes if you want an elemental facet in your Campaign. It introduces the concept of Elemental Connections that people may have and can allow Trainers to channel Elements similar to Pokemon.

The Path of Occultism - This Module provides a list of rules and bonus classes if you want supernatural facets in your Campaign and the occult is of high significance to your setting. Examples of this could be Trainers that can control time, use blood magic, or control the weather! It is recommended to add a few that would be possible in your world, as the base system will go with the assumption that no Supernatural abilities are possible. The only supernatural classes that are included in base PTE are canonical powers such as Empathy, Telepathy, Telekinesis, Witchcraft and Aura Abilities. .

The Path of Divinity - This Module provides a list of rules for Campaigns that treat Legendary and Mythical Pokemon as more divine in nature. It can go over what their strength level may be, how Trainers can pursue divine powers and how Pokemon can even be affected by following divinity.

The Path of the Eras - This Module is for campaigns that are either Higher Tech or Lower Tech. Higher Tech campaigns include optional items and systems such as Automaton Pokemon and Augmentation. Lower Tech campaigns can suggest alternatives to modern tech.

Path of Artisanry - This Module provides much more in depth systems of jobs and professions that your Players may be interested in pursuing and how it can factor into your campaign. Most Players will not have an interest in most of the mechanics explored here but one or two Players may align with content here. This Expansion includes concepts like players engaging in Pokemon Breeding, Farming, Fossils, Fishing, Cooking, Enchanting, Alchemy, etc

Book of Pokemon Gimmicks - This Module covers all of the Pokemon gimmicks that may be relevant in your world. This includes mechanics for Mega Pokemon, Terastralizing, Z-Moves, Burst Pokemon, Shadow Pokemon, Totem Pokemon, Ranger Stuff (Rentals) and Dynamaxing.

Converting from PTU

If you do want to convert from it, I would suggest a fresh campaign but it isn't impossible to do a conversion. If you're converting from PTA, I have no clue to be honest. If you're coming from something else like PTR or Pokeymanz or Pokerole, same goes, dunno how they play.

The steps below can facilitate how you would convert with as much ease as possible:

1. Get EVERYONE's approval and have them read the Rule Book.

Yes, you're the GM so you can run what you want but your players obviously need to look over the system's new rules and agree that yes, they want to run this instead. Additionally during this step they also need to have a general idea of how they want to convert their progress to PTE. During this phase before even proceeding, you'll need to compromise with your players so everyone has an idea of what they're Pokemon and Trainers will change mechanically.

If someone is a Juggler and will not compromise not having an equivalent class to convert to, you either need to grandfather some classes in, homebrew some options, convince them to choose something else, or keep the PTU system. A lot of classes may not have direct equivalents but there are a lot of ways to make things work. Some classes however like Capture Specialist are fundamentally unable to be transferred to PTE. Everyone should also be on the same page with how the system works as it is vastly different from PTU despite fundamental similarities.

2. Evaluate what level everyone should be.

The first thing to do is look at each Player and their Pokemon and determine what level they should be. Your Players can choose either Pokemon or Trainers to be the basis but the ones not chosen need to adjust their level accordingly, changing the Trainers are usually the easiest. This can be done by looking at the Level of your Pokemon and setting your Trainers to a Level based on their Max Pokemon Level equivalent. For example, if your Trainers are level 6 and have a level 18 Butterfree as their strongest, they'd likely reset to Trainer Level 4, whose Max Pokemon Level is 20. Alternatively they could have Butterfree bump to Level 30 but that tends to be more jarring and isn't recommended.

3. Evaluate the Trainer progression and convert it to their new Level.

Trainers have a different style of progression compared to PTU so they should go through the character creation process step by step as if they were making a new character. They should already have an idea of what classes they want in their new build so have them look through all of the orders, talents, features and classes to see what their new options should be for each level. They should try to convert as close as possible to their current build or pick new options that are more representative of their character if possible.

4. Convert each Pokemon based on the new Dex & Progression Rules.

There is a new dex with new Attack options, Ability options and new levelup lists. Basically every Pokemon is going to need to be re-statted starting from Level 1, then go through each level to their current level, going through the progression choices for each level. This will involve being re-statted (especially to align with glass cannon rules and BSR being removed), getting a role, choosing a new ability, getting new attack lists and going through each progression milestone like getting improved skills.

5. Remove all Items and figure out a lump sum of money to start anew.

This one will be a bit of a struggle as the Item lists are different from each system. Some conversions can obviously be one to one. If they have 4 Great Balls, it converts to 4 Pokeballs, easy. If they have 15 Lum berries and 3 Poffins however, it's a bit harder. For this stage, go through the Item Index and see which items cannot be converted. Items like an X Attack can easily be changed into a Greater Strength Potion for example. Any that cannot be converted and you do not wish to homebrew a new effect, they are instead converted to half of their cash value and given as a lump sum for them to get new items. They may spend this sum of money in the next Session 0.

If you have any homebrew items you wish to convert, refer to the Item creation section of the Rule Book and you'll need to adjust its effects accordingly with keywords that align to the new inventory system, especially if it's an equipment item or weapon.

6. Perform a new Session 0 with a massive Downtime Phase.

After all of this is done, the next session will be a break in time to pause and recap. During this session you will do the following. **First**, each player will go over their new mechanics and things that their Pokemon and Trainer can do differently so everyone is on the same page. **Second**, they'll take time as a group to possibly spend all of their money on new items that may be available or may have been available in their journey thus far. If they encountered an alchemist that would have had a type shifting potion, it is retconned that they were able to buy it at that time in the previous session. **Third**, each Character will compile a list of bonds that they think they would have among the NPCs they've interacted with and as a GM you should make notes of these relationships. If they met a trader who they've helped in the past, they may tell you to note them down as an ally that can provide them eggs as a favor because they've done so in the past.

The last thing you'll do during this session is compile a massive Downtime Phase that is different from normal ones. This phase will be a **retcon** for all existing actions that would have fallen under this downtime system. For each player, go through the following downtime actions to see how it affects the campaign if they did similar actions in the past.

First, address the **Socializing Action**. Go through each Player and determine who they've socialized with in the past and how their bond would be affected based on the results. This may have already been addressed in bringing up existing bonds. **Second**, address the **Crafting Action**. Some characters may have created custom items in the past, so review each Player's potential recipe list and see what items they can craft in the future. If you've already made custom items they can craft, make sure they comply with the current item rules so they can continue to be crafted in the future. **Lastly**, address the **Innovation and Research Action**. Each player must recollect their projects they're narratively working on and then as the GM, you'll assign them a Long Term Project Value and their current progress with that project. If they were in the middle of creating a new gadget that allows them to swim faster underwater, you could say that the TN would've started at 100 since it would've been Advanced, but it is lowered to 60 from their existing work. If a Player is researching an ancient artifact that they got from a Rayquaza cult, it could be designated that it has a Mythical TN of 150 and they only lowered it to 120.

7. If you have time, perform a basic Combat Session.

After the Retcon Downtime Phase is completed, if you still have time or before the campaign resumes, you should perform a basic, low stakes combat session against simple wild Pokemon related to where they currently are. This allows them to adjust to their new mechanics and the way combat works before they go back into the action of the campaign where stakes actually matter! This could be a canonical session or a one off. This is purely to get everyone used to the system so they aren't panicking mid session on what they're able to do. **And then, that's it! You're good to go!**



Picking your Campaign Type

So you've decided to GM, that's great! The first step in creating a Campaign is deciding on the structure of the Campaign and what type of Campaign it is. You may decide to throw caution to the wind and just say, "It's a team rocket game!", but we recommend building a good foundation so it leads to less frustration later on.

Below is a list of basic **Campaign Types** along with examples best associated with it and how to measure **milestones** for the sake of Trainers Leveling Up. In addition there is also a list of **Campaign Ideas** that could bring inspiration. If any of the listed Campaign types below are of interest, feel free to adopt it!

Note - Just because you select a specific Campaign Type, doesn't mean it has to solely be that. You can have a Gym Crawl with a narrative side plot like how the video games have villains on the side.

Gym Crawl Campaigns

Gym Crawls are the standard Campaign as it is most commonly the structure of the Video Games. Even when flavored in Alola as Trial Captains, it still follows the same structure of going from one organization to another, surpassing them in battle and gaining strength and it usually culminates in an Elite Four type of challenge to prove your Party's superiority as trainers. These Campaigns don't need to be Gyms per say but the structure is usually a series of challenges and the goal of the Campaign is to beat one challenge, gain power, then beat the next, then repeat. When running this Campaign type be sure to add some sort of variation between each challenge and vary each challenge so it doesn't become stale.

Examples - Pokemon Gyms in the Video Game. The Battle Frontier. Contest Circuits. Alolan Totem Trials.

Milestones - Major Milestones occur when a Gym is completed by all members of the Party. Minor Milestones depend on subplot and side requests that are unrelated or maybe related to taking the Gym Challenge.

Benefits of this Type - This is a tried and true formula that anyone who knows Pokemon will be used to, simply put, it's reliable. You know when you're progressing, you know when you're getting stronger and looking down at the first Gym after you beat the 7th feels good. There's also a definite

end point once the final challenge is completed so there doesn't have to be any meandering to end the Campaign.

Episodic Campaigns

Episodic Campaigns can also be called the "Slice of Life". By nature, they are very lax in progression and the content of said campaign is usually created on a whim. The setting in these Campaigns are usually stagnant or unchanging or casual in nature, unlike Narrative Campaigns. The main difference is that content is divided into Arcs or Episodes and when one is resolved, another one begins. While larger narratives can occur, leading to longer arcs, after they're resolved it will revert to normalcy.

Examples - The most prominent example are "Monsters of the Week" where there is no overarching goal, just a party of Players going from place to place to complete some mission. Think of the Pokemon Anime where every episode is a new encounter where this week, Ash finds a colony of Treecko. Another example could be that the players are a part of an association and each session is some mission or upkeep associated with that organization, such as a ranger team trying to stave off wild Shadow Pokemon from the havoc they cause every week. This is likely the best Campaign Type if dungeon crawling is prominent, as you can alternate between different locations easily without needing to be tied down. A Campaign based around mercenary work would also benefit from this type.

Milestones - Milestones are measured based on the difficulty and length of the Arc. If an Arc would span 2-3 Sessions, it would be considered a Major Milestone but you could easily level while padded with many small milestones that are accumulated.

Benefits of this Type - These Campaigns are much more simple to create and think about and don't even need to be on a routine schedule! In addition, the location tends to be stagnant so the focus of the Campaign is less on changing the world but by maintaining it and the joys of gameplay. Sessions could simply be, I came up with a cool idea for a Boss Delphox and decide to make a 2 part Session where the Party goes into the woods and discovers its crypt and has to capture it.

Narrative Campaigns

Narrative Campaigns are when the Plot is the central focus of the Campaign rather than any other goal. While all campaigns have a storyline, Narrative Campaigns have it as the sole incentive. The Players usually have their sole goal being fixing the narrative problem and every session has the narrative progress somehow.

Examples - Examples could include a grand Mystery that needs to be solved or a campaign that is focused on political intrigue

Milestones - Milestones are based entirely on the Plot and how much an event has impacted it. If the Party has made a major stride in the narrative, it's a Major Milestone. If they made a small step towards the greater goal, it's a Minor Milestone.

Benefits of this Type - These Campaigns are structured like a story rather than a game with the gameplay being secondary to the narrative. As such, each session of combat has much more meaningful stakes and value compared to just running into wild Pokemon for the sake of finding one.

Conquest Campaigns

Conquest Campaigns have structure based on claiming or restoring areas of a region to resolve some sort of problem. As such, each time they would start a new arc, they enter an entirely new area with new problems to resolve and new npcs. The campaign is usually resolved once the problem no longer plagues any areas or the reason they're taking over areas is resolved.

Examples - A Shadow Pokemon plague has covered the Hoenn Region and the Party goes around purifying shadow Pokemon and taking down Guardians to purge an area. A Turf war is occurring between two rival factions and the Party goes to each encampment of their rival to dismantle them. The Party is part of a rebellion to overthrow an oppressive empire, going from village to village to clear any authority from the empire that is in charge and to build a resistance.

Milestones - Major Milestones occur when a large area is claimed by the Party in some way. Minor Milestones occur if they take over a small area or make a step towards completing a major area.

Benefits of this Type - These campaigns usually start off the players from a position of great weakness, usually the antagonists having won in the past. This leads the campaign to be a very underdog and

rag to riches tone, which can be very satisfying the more the party gains control and becomes empowered.

Western March Campaigns

Western March Campaigns have two distinguishers compared to other Campaign types, the home base and the Player count. For the Player count, usually Campaigns shouldn't exceed 4 Players. However Western Marches can be set up with multiple groups of Players or a large group of Players that can join when they're free in order to complete missions. This shared environment allows all Players to have a similar goal of expanding the world and the base by which they work. Lastly, whereas other campaign types may have you journey around the world, Western Marches are all central around one location which the party goes back to after missions. Not to mention progress can also be found by expanding the town, gaining new resources as time progresses.

Examples - The Party settles in a research base in a new region, exploring areas covered by mysterious fog in order to map the region. The Party is in an old western town with a grand plan of growing into a city but is in a dangerous badlands area with violent pokemon!

Milestones - Major Milestones occur whenever a large mission is completed such as uncovering a mystery or fully researching an area. Minor Milestones occur based on side content such as helping your home base, helping expand the base or side quests.

Benefits of this Type - This Type of Campaign is great for worldbuilding and those who enjoy exploration. It's similar to the Episodic Campaign, where something new can be explored frequently, however it is centralized under a main base that is shared and grown among players. It additionally can be set up in a way that allows for multiple Players to be in the same campaign doing different things such as a group of 4-12 that swap out on availability.

Random Campaign Ideas

Want to run something but don't know what? There are some ideas!

Gym Crawl - Defeat a number of gyms and become Pokemon Champion!

Pokemon Rangers - You're part of an enforcement organization and spend your time saving others and defeating villains!

Villainous Campaign - You're the bad guy! The goal of this campaign isn't exactly a happy ending for most.

Redeemed Villains - Perhaps you were the bad guys but are trying to reform them for the better! Antiheroes galore!

Time Travelers - This focuses on traveling through the ages or even being stuck in a specific time era and having to deal with temporal anomalies or possibly returning back home!

Faction War - You're a part of a Faction that seeks victory over all other Factions in the world, for one way or another. Deal with other Factions and turf wars!

Survival Campaign - Attrition is a huge deal and the world is harsh here, spend your time focusing on gaining strength and resources to guarantee survival.

The Odyssey - You're on a Journey! This could be to find some greater treasure or to solve a goal but this involves a lot of exploration around the world.

Shadow Pokemon - Shadow Pokemon are a major part of this Campaign and the Party either embraces them or has them as an antagonistic force from enemies!

The Apocalypse - The World is in ruin, something major has affected the world and the party has to deal with the fallout or just survive in this different world.

Mythical Quest - Something has occurred with a Legendary Pokemon that has disturbed the balance of the world somehow and the Party needs to resolve this!

Pokemon Academy - You're in School. Your Campaign focuses on dealing with whatever narrative is going on while still sticking to the obligations of your academic life!

The Isekai - Pick your favorite fantasy setting and throw them into the Pokemon world!

Pirate Adventure - The Odyssey...but at Sea! Focus on finding mythical dungeon, finding treasures and exploring unique islands

Ancient Ruins - A mystery has recently been unearthed and needs to be explored, or perhaps it unleashed something ominous on the world and needs to be resolved. The ruins can have multiple layers.

Spacial Odyssey - The Odyssey...but in Space! Explore a high sci fi setting going from planet to planet or resolving problems in space. Think Honkai Star Rail!

Battle Royale - Multiple Trainers enter, only one can end on top! Compete with plenty of NPCs in your pursuit to be the best!

Raising Divinity - Baby Legendary Pokemon need to be trained over time to reach their full potential and your Party must facilitate that!

The Cartographers - The Party has discovered an unknown and undocumented location and the duration of the Campaign is spent uncovering its many mysteries.

The Rebellion - Major change is going on in the world and the Party wishes to oppose it in the hopes of a better world. The campaign is spent attempting to enact change for the better!

Special Research - The Party is sent on an assignment to help some Academic organization. Think of the mystery of the G.S Ball!



Determining Milestones

The PTE System does not use an Experience Point system, instead opting towards purely Milestones as a metric towards your Players leveling up their Trainers. Well, psuedo EXP System because we use Merits as a rubric for the scale of Milestones completed. Just so it's clear, Milestones are granted as a Party so everyone is on the same level. Though you may ask, what determines when a Milestone has occurred? And how many Milestones are needed in order to level up? That is what this section is for!

This is explained in the Trainer Progression Section in the Rule Book but we will reiterate our recommendation as listed below. In the notes section of your Character Sheet you'll find a session tracker so you know when you'll level up!

That being said, how do you determine what category a Milestone is? The Session Types section in the Rule Book will explain in full detail on each Session Type but it is mostly guess work depending on the narrative vibe of what they accomplished. As much as I'd like to say something more definitive, usually the best time to grant a level is if you "Feel" like your character would have progressed in this moment.

If your Players have defeated their rivals or defeated a gym or done something impressive narratively, they likely have gained a milestone as a Party. If you have trouble distinguishing what category a Milestone should be, instead just hand out Level-ups intermittently whenever you feel like it or they've gone a decent amount of time without one. Unless you're planning to pace out progression for a few years, one Level per 2-3 Sessions is about the average.

To determine what Category a Milestone could be, look to the list on the right:

Note- Milestones don't have to only be granted at the end of a session or upon completing a questline, you could also grant Excursion Milestones akin to handing out Inspiration in DnD whenever an impactful moment of success occurs or whenever your Players do something that leads to a great moment or twist in the campaign! Just don't hand out too much like this as it'll be expected and lead to pacing being too fast.

Excursion Milestone Examples

Excursions usually are either quick side quests or something that takes all or half of a Session. These quests are usually unrelated to an overall plot. Excursions should have effort done to complete them and not be something like a Questing Downtime Action.

- » A Group of villain PCs finish a side quest for one of their scientists who wanted them to find a Dome Fossil at some point in their Journey.
- » A Party finds and captured an Injured Beedrill that escaped from the Pokemon Center nearby.
- » A Trainer convinces the Villain to not Attack a village, causing a crisis through succeeding an Extreme CR (5).
- » The Party delivers a parcel from Professor Oak to Saffron City.

Mission Milestone Examples

Missions usually are the main content in a campaign that takes one or two Sessions length in duration or completes a step towards the greater goal of the Campaign. Missions usually are related to the Plot or is content they should be doing.

- » A group of villain PCs successfully complete a heist and steal a Sacred Bell from a mansion for their benefactor.
- » A Party ventures into a Team Rocket base and successfully stops an Admin from cloning Azelf.
- » A Party successfully defends a village from a large invasion of Pokemon that they knew was coming and dangerous.
- » A Party of students successfully pass a practical exam in their current Pokemon battling class in their academy.
- » A Party defeats a Gym.

Expedition Milestone Examples

Expeditions usually are usually long term goals that must advance the plot forward or serve as large steps in a greater goal of the campaign.

- » A group of villain PCs completed the prior mentioned heist, but as a result they were given a promotion to the Admin of the organization, allowing them to organize their own team.
- » A Party successfully stops an Ultra Beast invasion that was attacking the Player's home town, promoting them in their Ranger Academy.
- » A Party was told about an ancient labyrinth that is massive in scope with Zygarde at the bottom. Over a few sessions they clear out the labyrinth and meet Zygarde, gaining its favor.
- » A Party stops a rampaging Dialga who was recently consumed by a Shadow Virus, turning into its primal form.

Player Character Creation

Creating a character is one of the most exciting parts of starting a new campaign, but it can also be daunting for players, especially those who are new to the game or the setting. As a GM, your role is to guide and support your players through this process to ensure they create characters that they are excited to play and that fit well within your Setting.

Here are some essential tips to help you assist your players with character creation.

1. Solidify your Campaign Tone

Before diving into character creation, give your players an overview of the campaign's themes, tone, and setting. Are you running a light-hearted Pokémon Academy campaign, a gritty Team Rocket campaign, or a mysterious exploration campaign? This context helps players create characters that fit the story and party dynamic and don't mismatch the tone you're trying to set. For example, if you're doing an evil Rocket Campaign, don't let your Players make a Character that actively doesn't want to do evil things if the rest of the Party makes Characters that do. This will lead to table conflict and PvP. Everyone needs to be on board with the theme.

2. Balance the Party Composition

Discuss the importance of having a diverse set of skills and roles within the party. Ensure that essential roles, such as healers, damage dealers, and support characters are considered so there's no drastic overlap among party members. While multiple Players can have a Character that are tanks, it could lead to overlap and weak points in the Party's Synergy. More importantly however, have each Player tell the group what skills they're going to be specialized in. While there can be some overlap, having two characters that are strong leaders with good Command Skill may lead to one character stealing a moment the other could have had because they both would excel in that scenario. Some skills like Charm and Athletics are fine for overlap, but if you have two Characters that are both Tech Geniuses, it leads to them not being as unique and it leads to the Party lacking in some skills.

3. Have a Session 0

Make sure everyone comes to this Session with an idea of what kind of Character they want to play, but tell them to not have too many details. They only need general ideas for this phase. During this Session you can go over the campaign and then have a brainstorming session amongst the players so they can refine each other's Characters. This way, all the Players will know what each other are bringing to the table and can shape their own Characters to better synergize with their allies, mechanically and narratively. For example, two characters could tie their backgrounds together by shared NPC friends. This also allows Players to ask questions about your world in order to better ground their Character in it.

4. Ensure everyone has a Motive

Regardless of everything else a Character has, they must have a motivation to engage with the main theme of the Campaign. If they don't have a "call to adventure", there will be no reason for them to stay with the Party and their goals won't align. Please make sure everyone is on the same page and Characters that the Players make will cooperate with each other. Strife and conflict is okay! But make sure they all ultimately share a goal. If the Campaign is an evil empire that is oppressing the poor villages, the Players can have different motivations but the goal must be that the Empire is destroyed by the party. One player could be motivated by revenge because their parent's business was shut down by them. Another one could even be motivated to take down the empire because they have a conflicting economic agenda they wish to establish. What shouldn't be allowed however is someone who sympathizes with the Empire and will disagree constantly with the plans the party has to take them down. This tends to only work with player want them to eventually grow and change their ways over time.

Handing out Starters

Deciding on what Pokemon will be their starter is an important part of Character Creation and will likely be an important partner in their journey so make sure to follow some of the tips below when deciding on what your Players can take.

1. Decide how they get their Starters

Most Players won't want a random Pokemon as their starter being given to them and they'll want some sort of meaning attached behind their first Pokemon. This being said, before decisions are even made, discuss with the Party how they'll get their starters and if it's within their control or your control as a GM. They could have their Starter from their backstory, having already met in the past. They could have it given to them by a close bond of theirs. They could have it given to them by a professor or an organization like the league. If the Starter is given to them of their own backstory or connections, have them choose what Pokemon it is and coordinate with them of all other aspects of the Pokemon. If the Start is given to them by an NPC of your creations, you can decide, but make sure it's something the Character would connect with.

2. Be generous with what's available

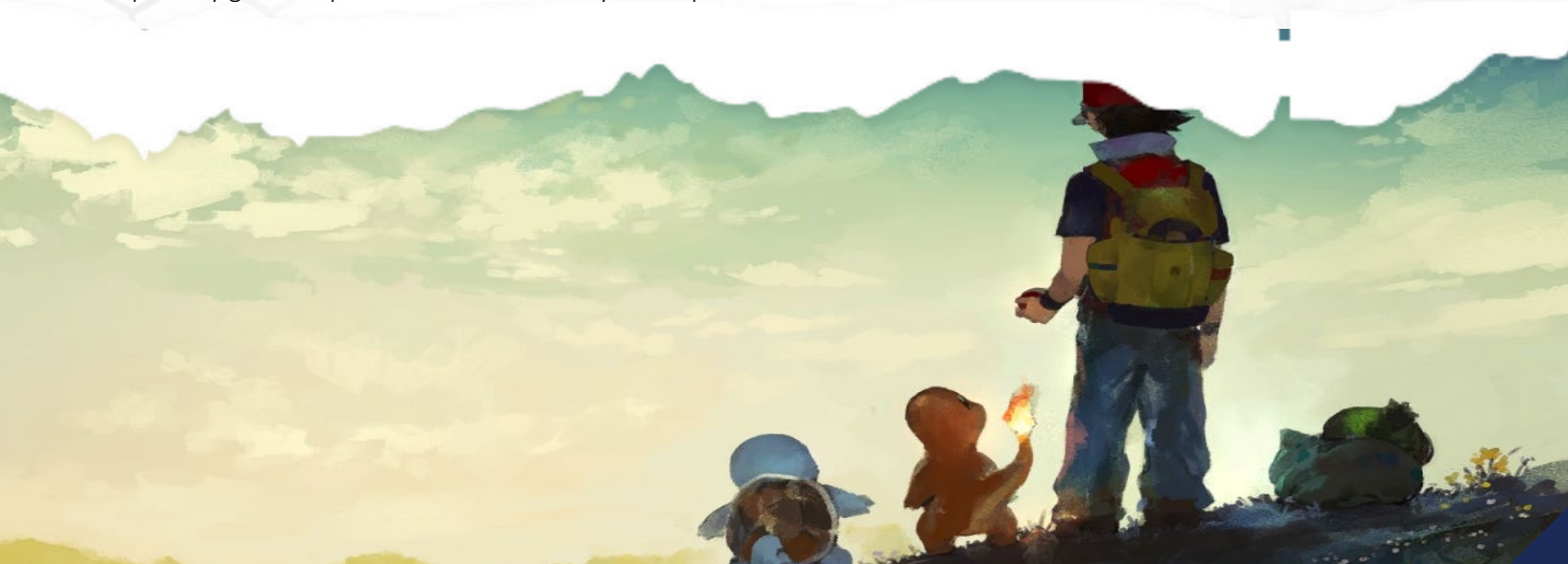
While some Pokemon in the game series and PTU would be terrible starters. (I'm looking at you Gastly), this is largely not a concern in PTE, as Base Stats aren't extremely relevant and Movepools have been revamped for all stages of the game, so this means you can choose a lot more Pokemon. What we would recommend however is that a Starter Pokemon not be a Pokemon without an Evolution such as Absol, as their Base Stats are skewed for early game and it's fun to see your Starter progress. Even Pokemon not recommended before such as Ghost or Steel Types would be fine provided you as a GM account for being able to damage them. Lastly, we suggest you don't use a standard regional starter as the only option like Torchic, Mudkip or Treecko and nothing else. I've had characters in the past start with a Zigzagoon, an Espurr, a Shinx, an Axew and a Drillbur, all without issue so let them be creative!

3. Link the Starter to the Character

Each of the Starter Pokemon should have some kind of connection to their Trainer, or the potential for a match with their Trainer. Even if they initially don't like the Trainer, they could still grow to like them such as Ash's Pikachu and Liko's Sprigatito, but unless the Player wants it, it's safer to have some sort of common link between them. This could be the Starter's Origin, such as being given by a cherished companion. This could be their personality, having a similar attitude and vibing well together. This could also be their existing history, such as saving a Charmander a few years ago and getting connected that way.

4. Consider making Starters Unique

Ideally, your Players shouldn't be abandoning their starter for the next Pokemon they find or keeping it in their box because they don't like it. In order to prevent this, you can do some of the following. You could make their Starter a Pokemon from their wishlist, knowing that they'll like using it. You could grant each starter a Variant Effect that's possibly scalable to make them more interesting. And lastly you could grant them a custom Ability or Attack that possibly grows in power with them as they level up!



Determining Starting Resources

As a GM you will also determine how affluent your Characters are upon starting their Campaign. This is heavily dependent on the setting and negotiations but below are three common levels that you could choose from if desired.'

Fresh Trainers

Fresh Trainers are any Character that is either starting their journey without any support or does not have access to any source of resources as they begin the campaign. This could be a Trainer from a poor village or someone who was abandoned by family to go off on their own. If this is the starting line, these Trainers start with \$1,000- \$2,000 worth of Money or Items whose value equals this range. If they are a combat trainer, they would likely have a Training Weapon, being very crude.

Supported Trainers

Supported Trainers are any Character they either are starting from an easier starting point or have some support network so they start with more resources. This could be a Trainer who's been given basic supplies from their family or a Trainer who's older and worked a bit to gain some resources of their own. If this is the starting line, these Trainers start with \$3,000- \$5,000 worth of Money or Items whose value equals this range. If they are a combat trainer, they would likely have a simple Weapon to start with.

Privileged Trainers

Privileged Trainers are any Character that is starting with affluence of some kind and have a solid support network for them to start their journey. This could include a Trainer who has come from a wealthy side of town or lives in a well off community. If this is the starting line, these Trainers start with \$3,000- \$8,000 worth of Money or Items whose value equals this range. If they are a combat trainer, they would likely have a simple weapon to start with.



Coordinating Party Builds

As a GM you should also try to coordinate your Party's builds to prevent possible problems that may arise in the future. You should not take this as an excuse to micro manage your Players and force them to play classes they don't want, but you should also be aware of potential problems that may arise if they build in a certain way as a party.

When your Players suggest the direction of their characters, refer to the list of issues below and then suggest ways that these could be avoided if you foresee them happening.

1. Overlapping Skills

Ideally, each Character should have their own niche and specialty in a party, a strength they have over their allies that they're good at. If multiple Players have overlapping skills with each other, that'll create skill deficiencies in other areas in the party and it'll lead to multiple people competing for the spotlight whenever that skill is relevant. If two people are good at Command, they will likely always be bouncing back and forth on who will be commanding others. If nobody in a party is good at Stealth because 3 people invested in Command, when a Stealth Skill Check comes up, nobody will be able to succeed. While this isn't necessarily a bad thing and there can be some overlap, it feels good when the party needs something and one person in the group can do it well. If the party needs someone to pickpocket a guard and one Trainer has good stealth, that Trainer will feel important.

2. Overlapping Roles

In the same vein as Overlapping Skills, Party Roles can also be overlapped. A party with 3 bards tends to be less balanced than if the party was a bard, wizard and fighter. When overviewing your Player's potential builds, determine what role they'll fulfill and make sure others shape their builds accordingly. If your Party has two players and both are Tanks going Defender, sure, they're doing what they want. But then their damage output suffers and you don't really need to intercept for someone who is already tanky, so the tank suffers if they have few to tank for. This rule can be mitigated slightly due to the fact that Trainers always battle with their Pokemon and they have separate builds of their own, but it's nice to keep in mind to spread your Party's strengths and weaknesses so they're more well rounded.

3. Hyper Focused Builds

A large reason why the [Advanced] Class rule exists is to prevent Players from investing in one specific idea and to encourage builds to be more well rounded. Otherwise someone could go Defender and take all of their Advanced Classes and become a mega tank. While this is a bandaid to remedy Players who may feel the need to build like that, it doesn't prevent making a build hyper focused around one thing, like a lot of DR or a lot of Damage. When reviewing your Player's builds, remind them that the more they focus on one concept, the more they'll suffer in other areas. While this should be more difficult with the way the system is designed, if someone's build is only good in combat, they'll not be as good in every other setting. It is recommended that Trainers usually split their focus and have Classes from different categories. While it is fine to have a Defender, Bastion, Fighter, Monk build, maybe vary it by making it a Defender, Bastion, Provocateur, Training Specialist! Comparatively, that gives them more Pokemon Support and Social Utility options.

4. Trainer Combat Enabling

If Trainers are meant to participate in battle, make sure their Characters have actions in which they can do so they can participate in battle. Conversely, if Trainers cannot participate in battle, make sure they don't take classes whose features are meant to be used in Combat. While this seems obvious, I've seen way too many PTU players be Level 10+ and they can only use [Orders] twice every round. Ensure that each player has a plan on what they can do in combat and how they can contribute to fights.

Coordinating Party Goals

The one thing that will encourage enthusiasm at your table is your Players have goals that they see as achievable that can progress their Character further. When facilitating Character Creation, follow the tips below to ensure that all Players have goals they're excited for and their goals intertwine with their allies and the narrative around them:

1. Define Shared Goals.

As a Party, all Characters should have a motive for grouping up together or a reason they're traveling together. It could be a story of separate origins all banding together to defeat a greater evil. It could be a group of misfits befriending each other and all wanting to succeed in their academic life. It could be a group of co-worker rangers that just want to make the region a better place. Define what binds your Players together and this should be the central focus of the Campaign with all other plots and goals being secondary.

2. Define Individual Goals.

Each Player should also have a list of a few individual goals that may not interest the other party members but may serve as content their character would enjoy a lot. This serves as your piecemeal content that you can sprinkle in when you need ideas or need to lure another Player to pursue something. This could be a Player wanting to find the truth behind the disappearance of their father. It could be a Character wanting to brew an antidote to a rare toxin they were poisoned by. It could be financial wealth. It could be any myriad of options.

3. Figure out Character Ties.

Once you determine all the Goals of your Players, you should, likely during Session 0, figure out the ties your Players have to the World and their fellow Allies. This will allow backstories to intertwine and bond player characters together because they're essential to their backstory or achieving their goals. A Player could have known another Player in the Party because they're from the same small town and both went to the same school. A Player could have their uncle be some renown scientist that specializes in toxins and could help another Player create an antidote to their condition. There are many options and ways they can be connected but make sure you don't create immediate solutions to their goals, this is purely creating connections and directions that can be pursued. Perhaps the uncle is egotistical and doesn't help people unless they prove themselves first.



Campaign Safety Tools

When you gather all of your Players, it is essential to perform a **[Session 0]** before the campaign begins. This is to primarily set the scene for the Campaign and serve as an exciting introduction to the world you've built!

However, before this can even begin, we highly recommend that you hand out our **Campaign Safety Guide** to all of your Players. The Players should fill out the following form and then submit it to you, as their GM. If you wish, you can fill out these forms together but it is easier for you to consolidate all the information before Session 0, so you can make any changes to the Campaign to account for Player Preferences if need be. I'll likely redesign this at some point since, in retrospect, it's packed with a lot of information, small in size and it's not easy to use but that's a project down the line.

The digital link is [here](#) and the printable version is [here](#).

Why is this Important?

A lot of Campaigns fail due to crossing unspoken boundaries. They have a whole subreddit for it called "DnD Horror Stories". In order to ensure success for your campaign, you should ensure that all of your Players are on board with whatever they may encounter during the Campaign. This may also allow for conversations you may not think about until it happens, such as, are you okay with temporarily having a Pokemon stolen and having a questline to get it back? You may have a Team Rocket centric campaign but one player's intended perspective could be cartoonish violence while you intended for a more gritty mafia-like experience. The mismatching of tone and expectations is one killer of interest.

Secondly, this is important purely to ensure the experience is safe and fun. GMs can casually create encounters that to some may bring up trauma so knowing what to avoid when designing questlines can save everyone the pain of digging up sensitive subjects. This also lets you catch things and discuss them before you're 3+ Sessions deep. For example, if one Player does not want religious themes included at all, that may be an issue if Legendaries are deific entities that have a cult-like following in the world.

Lastly, it can give you clearance to add things you may have thought the Players wouldn't have liked! While most Players may not like tedious attrition gameplay, your Players may enjoy it, allowing you to craft your world to encompass it! Some mechanics like Puzzles are notoriously annoying to some players so throwing in a puzzle only to have to give a clue every 20 minutes is a mood killer, but if they enjoy it, it gives you a pass to add them! Also if anyone marks Great for "NPC Betrayals", I'll personally add so many red flags that they won't know who to trust.

Session 0

Session 0 is likely the most important session you'll have because it sets the tone for the rest of your campaign and determines how excited people will be going forward, as it literally is first impressions of the group as a whole. For your first session (Session 0), everything preliminary about your Campaign should be the focus and discussed, including the following:

1. Safety Guidelines.

This can be done before the Session if desired but the Safety Form listed under Campaign Safety Tools should be filled out at some point. You can use time in Session 0 to verify everything is filled out so you have an idea of what needs to be restricted and it can possibly be discussed at the table. Some Players may have questions or want to reach out about private concerns which is okay!

2. Campaign Tone & Expectations.

The primary point of a Session Zero is to expand on the premise of the Campaign and what the players should expect during this game. This is basically a terms and conditions that by continuing to Session 1, they accept being part of this game. If your game is in a noble bright setting and your players are expected to be the heroes that defeat team rocket, this needs to be the stage it's expanded on, if you haven't done it already. You should also go as much into depth about public knowledge that your Characters would know about the setting and the current state of the world that surrounds the issue of the Campaign.

3. Roundtable Questions.

After you do your information dump, encourage and go around the table to let the Players ask questions. These could be questions about the gameplay and homebrew being added, possible expectations regarding Pokemon they find or encounter, or possibly worldbuilding questions that they may want the answers to. Session 0 should be as clarifying as possible so players can leave more informed and excited than they came in.

4. Create your Characters.

This is optional and likely should be done before Session 0 but some tables may want to discuss together about what Characters they want to play. Allow your players to browse through the book and theory craft ideas together and see what direction they want to each take with their Character. As the GM, if some have trouble getting a foundation, recommend a path they should go down depending on what they're interested in playing. For example if they like playing a wizard in another TTRPG, they could perhaps look at Mystic and its related classes. Most of the time people know what they generally want to play but don't know where to start.

5. Character & Player Introductions.

With all the other steps out of the way, you can now actually start playing if you're ready to do so! If you're ready, you should treat this stage of Session 0 as the preamble, the prologue to your story! If your Table is full of strangers, have the Players introduce themselves, who they are and what characters they plan on using, if they're comfortable doing so. Then go through each player and do a small 5-10 minute scene regarding where they start in your World and what they would be doing as of present day. After each player introduces their Character, have them describe how they would eventually meet up to where your Campaign begins. If a Player is a farmhand, perhaps they get a notice in the mail from their relative in the capital city that they need help and they leave immediately. This stage should end when all Characters are generally in the same place where the Campaign intends to begin, the Tavern Phase.

6. Start the Campaign Plot Hook.

At this point, your goal is to end Session 0 with a plot hook and to get the party integrated with each other. You should also, in character, explain the goals of the Campaign in some sort of way so that the goals of each Player are clear. If your characters need to defeat an evil team, perhaps they all meet after rushing into a burning Pokemon center only to find the evil team stealing Pokemon and they all help defeat them! If they're simply students in an academy, perhaps they all meet up in an after school club they were all convinced to join or detention! Session 0 should end whenever the Players integrate their party and can anticipate the future of the Campaign, leaving them in a hopeful and excited state of continuing the Campaign.

Important Setting Questions

Before you even start to start your Campaign there are a few questions you need to answer that are setting dependant that are major factors to how players will build their Character. Below are a few of these questions you should probably know the answer to before starting the campaign and if not, now's the time to do so!

League & Trainer Combat

1. Is there a Pokemon League?

If so, how is it structured? Is it a conventional Elite 4 + Champion? Additionally, how is the Champion perceived in society?

2. Is it a standard 8 Gyms or is it unconventional?

Additionally, how are the Gym Battles performed? Are they traditionally mono-typed or built on a theme?

3. Is Trainer Combat legal?

If so, is it the norm that most people have supernatural or physical abilities to fight against Pokemon or is it a rare talent that few would possess. If it's illegal, in what situations could Trainers participate in combat without penalty? Is it normal to walk around in equipment and weapons used for combat? If it's legal, how does it change how Gym Challenges are run?

Pokemon

1. How are Pokemon seen in your World?

Are they treated as dangerous monsters, equal to humans or easily domesticable companions? Are they seen with fear or normalized?

2. Are Pokemon commonly Trained?

Does it take proper training and education in order to capture and raise a Pokemon or can anyone do it? How common is it to see high level Pokemon? How many Pokemon would the average NPC have?

3. What is the Intelligence level of most Pokemon?

Are they about the intelligence of a pet or completely wild? Can they understand human language and orders or do they act on training and instinct? Is the intellect based on their type or physiology like Psychic Types being smarter?

Culture & Society

1. What are the major geographic areas?

Are all cities relatively equal in prosperity or are some areas more affluent? Which city would be the most populous or be the capital? Are there any important landmarks in the region and what is their significance?

2. What are the major culture and factions?

Does the campaign have multiple different cultures such as Johto and Kanto? Do any factions or cultures have conflicts and what's their relationship? What is the summary of each culture such as what their values are? Are there any factions that are universally despised or idolized?

3. What is the Tech Level of the World?

How are major inventions such as the Pokeball and Pokedex treated if the Tech Age is lower? What was the most recent innovative invention and how has it changed the world? How would a lower or higher tech age impact the healing of damage sustained from Pokemon battles?

The Supernatural

1. Is there a Magic System in your World?

If so, what powers can be obtained and by whom. If there is not, what explains the divide between Pokemon having supernatural abilities and humans being unable to? If they can, how are they obtained and can it be through training? If there is, what are the common abilities from the lowest power tier to the highest tier, such as a basic chronomancer vs Dialga itself?

2. How are Legendaries applied to your World?

Are they just rare Pokemon that are slightly stronger? If so, is there a history of certain Pokemon being captured in the past like Tobias and Darkrai? Are they extremely strong Pokemon but beatable with enough firepower? Are they divine beings that can't possibly be beaten by normal means? If so, do they have servants and can they be followed similar to a Greek god? Is there a hierarchy of power compared to all other Legends, with some being stronger than others? What would occur if a Trainer wishes to pursue servitude of a legend?

Creating Interesting Locations

So you have an interconnected and interesting world! Now what? Time to fill it with interesting locations and points of interest. When attempting to create a location such as a cave in a town, go over the questions below to make it more intriguing. I've also answered each question in the example where I've built my own Location.

1. What is unique about this location compared to its surrounding area?

When creating interesting locations, focus on what sets this place apart from its surroundings. Is it a hidden oasis in a barren desert, a technologically advanced lab amidst medieval towns, or a mystical forest where magic flows freely? Highlight these unique characteristics to make the location stand out and spark the players' curiosity. If the location isn't unique and just a normal forest for example, it doesn't matter what interesting encounters you have planned, they'll likely think there's nothing special within.

Example- The area I'm making in my example is a cursed forest that has a perpetual darkness within. What makes it unique compared to its surroundings is the fact that it comes right across from a happy go lucky village that is relatively normal, it just tries to prevent weaker Trainers from entering the woods and keeps it barricaded. Unlike other forests, the canopies of the tree are massive, blocking out the sun and a dense fog expands on the floor of the woods the closer you get to the center.

2. How does this Location tie into the world and the overarching Plot?

While not all locations need to be plot relevant, they should tie into the world somehow to make the world feel lived in. If you're making a simple cave, think of a few questions to expand its purpose. What resources does it provide? Does it have mineral deposits that a nearby village can forge into Mega Stones? That could make nearby settlements flocked to, similar to the gold rush in the west. Is it home to a dangerous Aggron that dislikes outsider intrusion? If so, how do the nearby settlements or nearby Pokemon react to the cave's presence? If it's actively avoided, maybe you can introduce it as having little life nearby and strangely quiet.

Example- This area ties into the overarching Plot because the Players are trying to find hidden relics of great power and one of the fragments is in this forest. These fragments have the power to massively boost the power of Pokemon that possess them and what they don't know is that a Shiftry in the woods currently has it. There are many mysterious places around the world but the information of these relics and why the world is like this is relatively unknown, so the Players would naturally think this is a place of interest.

3. What is the history of this location and significant events regarding it?

The most interesting of places likely have had a rich history such as abandoned homes where the prior tenants were murdered or a ghost town that used to be a hotspot for gold deposits. When making areas, think of the history of your world and if significant events have occurred nearby and the result it had on the location. For example, there could be a bountiful flower field behind Floaroma Town that came into being because Shaymin once visited it and blessed the land. Ever since, many Fairy types and Grass types tend to the land and it attracted many botanists that study the flora which is unique to the region.

Example- When the Players talk about the woods with the locals, they realize it is a very hushed topic with many urban legends regarding it. After digging around they find people more willing to talk about it, realizing that a recent event of disappearing children has led the town to ban entry to the woods and for it to be blocked off nearly 20 years ago. Since then, many rumors have been popping up about it such as mystical forces that are being summoned by a cult (That doesn't exist) and is indeed just a rumor.

4. What does the Ecosystem look like in this area?

When you think about what is encounterable in your location, it usually leads to it becoming more interesting. What kind of Pokemon and people would be attracted to this location? If the area is in a cave, you usually wouldn't find Pokemon like Pachirisu and instead would find those who like a dark earthy environment like Roggenrola. When adding predator pokemon like Houndour, think about what kind of Pokemon they'd like to hunt, such as Zangoose usually being in an area that Seviper are in. Lastly, factor in the resources of the location and who would be attracted to it. If a cave is known to grow large crystals, maybe a bunch of Sableye would be native considering they're Terravores. This doesn't mean you need to be predictable however, as deviating from what makes sense lead areas to be even more interesting! For example, You could have rattata with extremely hard teeth that can chew through these crystals. They could even become regional variants!

Example- The ecosystem that has formed as a result of this Guardian Shiftry is one that is darker than normal woods. Perhaps many Pokemon have shifted to the Dark or Ghost Type as a result of the eternal fog. More Pokemon like Phantump could be native rather than weaker Pokemon like weedles and caterpie. Predator Pokemon probably have occupied the region more like Poochyena but as a result of the competition for prey, have become much more hostile towards anyone they perceive as a threat.

How to Retrain Builds

Especially when Players are just learning a system, people can make mistakes and make suboptimal choices, and that's okay! Whenever a build isn't working out or the Player wants to take their character in a different direction, they're allowed to retrain and make different choices with how they leveled up. **There are two different directions you can go with allowing retrains.**

1. Free Retrain - It is highly recommended to allow each Player to have one full retrain for their Character without having to earn it in Character. During the first 5 Sessions, retrains should also be completely free because Players are still getting used to their character and trying to figure out what suits them personality and mechanic wise. If they realize two classes don't work the way they thought, they shouldn't be locked into the mistake for the rest of the campaign. Don't let people make too many retrains for the sake of character integrity but it should be fairly obvious when a Player is retraining to fix a mistake vs retraining to hyper optimize or cycle through classes that ruin the Character's identity.

2. Earned Retrain - Earned Retrains should only be done if a Campaign is well under way and a Character is firmly set in place as to who they are and what they identify with mechanically, unless your Player would prefer this method. Earned Retrains are when a Character must complete a set of milestones in order to qualify for retraining. Some examples of ways in which a Character can earn a retrain are listed below:

Mentorship - Let's say a Trainer wishes to retrain their Empath Class into the Strategist Class. In Character, they find a Strategist within the city's military barracks who has been a leader for the city for their entire life and is experienced. The GM tells that player that if they socialize or train with this NPC for at least 3 successful Downtime Phases, they can learn in character how to enact strategy and become a Strategist if they qualify.

Gained Knowledge - Sometimes Characters grow in ways that make sense for them to shape their Classes accordingly. One of my Characters found an occult book based on the practice of Aura. They already had good focus so they became interested and started to read it in their downtime. As a Research Downtime Action, the GM allowed me to learn aura techniques and open a latent ability, allowing me to retrain into an Aura Guardian if I desired. Retraining this way however required me to research the book more in order to gain higher rank Aura Guardian Features. While it was inconvenient and tedious, it felt way more satisfying in character and felt like I earned being an Aura Guardian because I dedicated the time.

Sudden Change - Sometimes a sudden event occurs in which your Character is blessed with the ability to pursue a different mechanical build. One example is a Reshiram granting a Trainer an innate connection to the Fire Type, allowing them to make more sense becoming a Fire Specialist. Another example is a dramatic event causing a character to become enraged. This trauma lead to the Trainer becoming a Berserker, using it as an outlet to achieve their goals and enact revenge.



Making Memorable NPCs

The worst feeling i've had as a GM is preparing a rival or important NPC only for the players to not be interested or just treat them as unimportant. This section will help you create NPCs that are fleshed out enough to be memorable. **Consider some of the steps below** when making an NPC, especially if it's recurring and you want them to be memorable and beloved:

Note- You shouldn't have every NPC you make follow these rules. If they're extremely frequent they'll become the norm and it'll be less special, then ironically bob the shard collector will become memorable by comparison. If minor characters like Nurse Joy have some strong dramatic introduction and every character has a weird quirk and some tie to the grand plot, it'll get stale. Sometimes the minor details are the most memorable, like Nurse Joy actually being a day-trader in her off time and having a vast knowledge of economics which she sneaks into conversations.

1. Fill out most of the Character Profile...but not too detailed- The solution to overplanning NPCs is simple, don't do that. Refer to the Character Profile section and fill out brief sentences for each section for each NPC you create. If they're important, write a few more! They don't have to be super detailed as the more you play them, the more you'll figure out details about them.

Important Details for an NPC to have are their Personality, Motivations, Desires, Morality, Strengths, Flaws, Bonds, Pokemon Team and Backstory. Filling out small notes and sentences ensures you have details to pull from but they're not so in depth that it takes forever or you feel bad if the Players don't feel invested in them. Also do not fully stat a Pokemon team unless they're planned to be battled against in that session.

2. Make a strong Introduction - If you want an NPC to be remembered, give them a strong first impression. To do this, take a trait of the NPC and highlight it. This could either be one of their strengths or an aspect of their personality or character.

Example 1 - The Party's first session they all meet up at the town square to find an Aura Guardian being executed. They know occult users are discriminated against but right before the gallows fall, a burst of aura comes from the prisoner, breaking their chains and the guillotine he was in. He then starts to flee at a walking pace, wiping out anyone in his way with aura powers and unfortunately the players are in the way. The players recently heard about the crimes this guy has committed so they attempt to stop him, only to be wiped by someone who is 15 Levels above them, but he doesn't finish them off, only leaving them badly injured. He leaves the city before telling the Players that maybe someday they'll know the truth.

Example 2 - The Party walks behind a tavern to find a child that is probably around 11 years old playing with some sort of controller while there is a mechanical pikachu nearby. Automatons are fairly common in this setting but they're restricted in public settings and it takes skilled engineers to create or even control them. As they watch the child from the shadows, they see the pikachu releasing a massive bolt of electricity, leading to a building being caught on fire and the kid panicking from the damage. They grab the automaton and run off trying to flee the scene. After the party puts out the fire they attempt to find the kid but they ran away too fast. Later down the line they find the kid performing janitorial duties and cleaning up the tavern after hours as their drunk father berates them for leaving his scraps around the place. From this introduction, they know the child is very gifted, technologically advanced and likely in a bad home environment.

3. Make them distinct - People are complex, so your NPCs should also be distinct in some sort of way. If they are distinct, your Players will actually be interested in talking to them compared to if they were just your standard "Town Guard" that is copy pasted to each location. How do you do this? Give them quirks! Whenever you create an NPC, give them some kind of unique factor that makes them different from others. This could be a physical trait, personality trait, a skill, a preference that's odd, something that goes against their trope, an odd Pokemon, etc.

Example- Nurse Joy in this town has a deep southern accent. The top gladiator in this town has a cutieflly that helps him pick flowers for his daughter. Gary Oak always says "Smell ya later" after leaving a conversation with Ash Ketchum. A Trainer has a Charmander who is obsessed with watching ice melt. An Officer Jenny is loose with the law and has a pink streak in her hair which is very against uniform code. A Scientist is obsessed with the "Sound" Type despite it not being a thing and will frequently rant about it. A Hunter carries a bone necklace with lost teeth from the Lycanroc he's owned over the years. Trader has an obsession with fancy stones and will buy ones that interest him for way more than market value so he can give them to his mother.

4. Determine how they're involved with your World -

Every NPC should be involved in society somehow, even if they're just a vagabond or wandering traveler. When making an NPC, determine how they contribute to your world, how they make ends meet or what they even do for fun! Finding this information will help your NPCs become grounded and make the world feel more alive. In addition, what kind of relationships do they have to other NPCs that are local to them? They've likely interacted with each other for their entire life so it's entirely plausible that the Tavern Keeper has a bad relationship with the town gambler, knowing his reputation as a drunkard. After all, NPCs can be expanded in depth based on the things others say about them.

5. What are they like Off-Screen? - When you make an NPC, imagine what they would do while they aren't interacting with your Players. Does the blacksmith like to go to the mines with his Machoke in order to find more ore? Does the town minstrel like to snoop around in the back alleys and write gossip anonymously? Thinking about these kinds of details lets you flesh out an NPC more and make them more personable and easier to relate to.

6. How can they defy expectations? - While defying expectations too many times can be cliché, it can be nice every now and then to have oddball NPCs that you expect to act one way but acts in the non traditional way in some aspect.

Example - A very vocal provocateur is actually pretty sensitive to criticism and backs down easily when stood up to. A Berserker has an emotional support Furfrou to help him calm down after he's enraged. A Merchant that seems very friendly and honest on the surface commands an army of gimmighoul that pickpocket from other civilians. An old lady that's an herbalist is actually a Mismagius in disguise. The quiet kid was actually a Zorua and the child was missing for a few months. The cheerleader has a Gible that protects her when walking home after sporting events. His name is Gibby.

7. What can they offer the Players? - Most NPCs should have the potential to grant the Players something if they're pursued. Not all of them should, but having most NPCs grant unique benefits encourages socializing with your world, as they'll never know what an NPC could offer. What an NPC can offer can be displayed in multiple methods. If an NPC is pursued, likes the players or has side quest completed, they can offer any of the following as a positive for interacting with them:

Services or Rewards - The most common thing that NPCs can offer is their services or rewards they have on hand. If a Player has a connection with a Mega Stone Merchant, they could exchange a favor to have the Merchant search for an absolute for them or even help them researching how to create one. A Paleontologist that they saved could also be used as a resource to revive a fossil the party found and can't do anything with on their own.

Social Connections - Some NPCs can expand the social network of the party. One merchant may have a daughter who has beaten the 8th gym leader and knows the secret to the gym's puzzle and could assist them with leaked information! Another guard could repay the party for a well cooked meal with higher priority and letting them have an audience with the king despite it being difficult normally. Your NPCs likely know people in this world better than the party so make use of it!

Sharing of Knowledge - NPCs that like the Players will be happy to share knowledge they know and can assist with their problems. Being connected with NPCs is an extension of the party itself, so when they find some mysterious tablet in the Ruins of Alph, maybe the scientist they helped a few sessions ago would know how to decipher unown glyphs! Other NPCs are specialized in more things than your party likely is, so have them as resources for the party to gain information from.

Note - Don't worry if you follow these steps and Players don't latch onto the NPC or remember them. Players are weird and tend to be interested by different aspects of an NPC. If you create an NPC to be unimportant but the Players like them, be sure to flesh them out and make them more recurring!

Balancing Encounters

Balancing Encounters is a Skill that most GMs pick up the more they play the system and learn how powerful certain enemies are. The basic thing you need to know is:

[Action Economy is King]

What does this mean? Simply put, the side that has more Actions they can use tend to be highly favored to win an Encounter. If 3 level 5 Pokemon are pitted against 1 Level 15 Pokemon, the Level 5's will tend to win solely because they can do more compared to the action output of the Level 15 Pokemon. At a certain point, the Level of your Enemies does not matter, it matters more of how many enemies there are. So when in doubt, just use similar leveled enemies and match how many Player combatants will be in the fight!

This doesn't mean that Levels are useless, at certain milestones, especially early on, certain Pokemon gain access to milestones that give them a boost in power such as evolving, roles or abilities. Additionally, at a certain level difference, Stats become too vast and the weaker Pokemon is unable to do damage to their enemy because their Defense exceeds their Attack. This in mind, if you want to get more granular with if your Encounter is balanced, follow the steps below. At the end, each side will have a Point Value.

1. Determine the Combatant Point Value

Each Trainer is worth 1 Point. Each Pokemon is worth 1 Point. Each Underling Minion is worth half a Point. Each Boss is worth a number of Points equal to their number of Turns or HP Bars (Whichever is higher). Remember to factor in non Active Pokemon on a reserve team or reinforcements that may be added!

2. Determine the Level Point Value

The value of X is equal to your Player's Maximum Pokemon Level. The Value of Y is equal to your Player's current Trainer Level. If an Enemy Pokemon's Level is half of X or less, they're treated as half of their Point Value. If they are at least double the value of X, their side gains +2 Points. If a Trainer would be +4 Levels higher than Y, their side gains +1 Point. If they would be 4 Levels or more lower than Y, they're treated as half their Point value.

3. Determine any Advantages

If one side would gain an Advantage based on the circumstances of the Scene, they gain 1-3 Points depending on the impact of the advantage. This can include traps being set against the Players or a field blessing affecting the field before Scene would start.

4. Determine any Disadvantages

If one side would be disadvantaged in one way or another, they lose points based on the disadvantage, usually 1-3 Points depending on the impact. The most common one is being outnumbered. If one side has more than 2 Active Combatants at a time compared to the other side, they're outnumbered and the outnumbered team loses -3 Points. For example, if the Enemies have 6 Pokemon on the field at once and they face a singular Trainer who has 6 Pokemon in their Party but only one out at a time, this is a vast disadvantage despite having an equal number of Pokemon at their disposal, resulting in 2 Active Allies vs 6+ Active Enemies.

5. Calculate the Point Difference

Take the Enemy's Point value and subtract it from the Player's Point value then refer to the scale to the right to calculate how difficult the Encounter would be for the Players.

If the result is **Negative 4 or lower**, the Encounter is **Very Easy**. If the result is **Negative 1-3**, the Encounter is **Easy**. If the result is **0-1**, the Encounter is **Balanced**. If the result is **2-4**, the Encounter is **Hard**. If the result is **5+**, the Encounter is **Very Hard**.

Example 1 - Simple Encounter

The Players come across a group of wild birds led by a Swellow that's in charge. This Encounter is **Easy**.

Calculations are as follows:

Players - 2 Trainers (Level 4) each with 3 Pokemon (Each Level 20) in their Party. This results in 2 Points for the Trainers and +6 Points for the Pokemon. This is a total of 8 Points.

Enemies - There are three Pidgys that are Level 15 and an Alpha boss Swellow that has two Turns. This results in 3 Points from the Pidgy and 2 Points from the Swellow. This is a total of 5 Points.

Example 2 - Complex Encounter

The Players find themselves in a Team Rocket hideout! This Encounter is **Balanced**. Calculations are as follows:

Players - 2 Trainers (Level 7) each with 3 Pokemon (Each Level 35). They also have an allied NPC (Level 2) with their own set of 3 Pokemon (Level 10). They are also protecting an NPC in a Defend Objective. They have 2 ½ Points for the Trainers, the half being from the NPC that is low leveled. They have 7 ½ Points for their Pokemon, considering each of the NPC's Pokemon are worth half a point. The NPC they're protecting is considered a disadvantage of 2 Points since they're being protected. This results in 8 Points.

Enemies - There is one Alpha Nidoking that is Level 50 and two Rocket Trainers (Level 6) but they each only have 1 Pokemon (Level 30). They have 2 Points from Nidoking that has 2 Turns, 2 Points come from the Rocket Trainers and 2 Points come from their Pokemon, leading to a result of 6 Points. They do have an advantage as they're in their headquarters and can trigger Traps, which results in a bonus of 2 Points. This results in 8 Points.

Speeding up Combat

One annoyance to many in TTRPGs is how long Combat takes. When the pacing is bad and the scene drags, especially when it's one sided, it can reduce the fun of the system. A few changes have been made to PTE to speed up combat by default, but that doesn't mean more changes can be done! A few examples of what has been implemented are listed below alongside some suggestions you could do to speed up gameplay.

What we've done

1. Change Initiative Rules

The days of gathering Initiative Values by everyone shouting out their Speed is long gone. No more are the days where people forget to take someone that fainted off the chart or failed to adjust an initiative value because they're Slowed or Paralyzed. Initiative now follows "Popcorn" rules where after the Initiative Check is made, Turns bounce back and forth between the Player and Enemy groups and whoever wants to go next can do so. This allows combat to be more dynamic, allows for more planning and doesn't run into issues where it's someone's turn and they have to think of what they want to do. Instead, deciding on what Actions are done is a party wide decision on what they want to do next and makes decisions more collaborative and quicker. If the party knows a Golem is about to explode, they may tell their Swampert to go next to deal with it instead of having to wait 6 turns until it reaches its turn.

2. Implement Combat Pairs

How do you solve having too many combatants? Group them together and have them all act at once! Combat Pairs are groups of 2, usually a Trainer and their Active Pokemon, so when a pair gains initiative, both combatants can use actions simultaneously. This tends to knock out two combatant's turns in the amount of time it would take for one player to take their turn!

3. Reduce Party Size

Compared to the 6 Pokemon per Party in PTU, we've reduced the limit to each Trainer having a maximum of 3 Pokemon when venturing out.

4. Optimized the Combat Tab

An Action Cheat Sheet has been added to the Trainer Combat Tab in the Character Sheet, allowing you to note your most frequent actions used for each Action type. Instead of diving through your feats tab and looking through 18 options on what you can do, you now can quickly look to see your options which should lessen decision making.

5. Add Path of the Mundane

Well, we haven't implemented it yet! If Combat taking too long is a concern, we suggest adding the Path of the Mundane Module. This module removes the Trainer's ability to be active combatants in a fight, relegating them to background combatants that can influence fights rather than fight alongside them. Adding this normally halves the amount of turns in combat!

Other Options you can add

1. Use Minions instead of normal Pokemon

Most of the time, fully statting a Pokemon is fine, however, if a Pokemon is only meant to be padding in an encounter, instead make them a Minion, especially if they aren't the focus of the encounter. This can primarily be used where there are many pokemon flooding the area or a boss that is commanding smaller pokemon. Having minions reduces the options you can choose and are quicker to eliminate from the initiative, thereby making combat simpler but faster. You can also run multiple Minions of the same species by just having their Pokedex page open instead of needing a full Pokemon Sheet!

2. End Combat early

Is it clear that the Players already won? End combat! You don't need to waste time finishing an encounter if it's clear the enemy's decisions won't impact the players at all outside of a few damage or maybe fainting someone. This can simply be done by having the enemies flee, surrender, or some kind of intervention occurs in which combat would end by their presence.

3. Implement Cinematic Finishers

At many points during an Encounter you could choose to initiate a "Cinematic Finisher" on an enemy. This may occur whenever an Enemy drops below 25% Hit Points but still isn't fainted. Whenever this would occur, tell the Player to describe how they use the Attack that caused the finisher to occur. Depending on the potency of it and the context of the fight, you may set a Target Number and then have the Player perform a Luck Roll. If it beats the TN, the Enemy instead faints immediately but if not, they hang on as you describe the dramatic moment. Examples are below.

Ex 1 - An enraged quilava uses a flamethrower on a nuzleaf that manages to take out 90% of its hit points. After describing how the rage of the pokemon fuels the infernal beam into a blue hue, overpowering the grass type, the GM sets the TN to 5 and has them roll. They roll a 7 and the GM describes how the flames engulf the Nuzleaf, immediately knocking it out, burnt to a crisp.

Ex 2 - An Exploud Boss Pokemon is hit with a cross chop by a Machop, knocking it from 60% HP to 10%. After describing the force that goes into the Attack, the GM has them perform a Luck Roll with a TN of 15, however they only got an 11. This was set higher because the Exploud still had another HP Bar left and it was a Boss. The Gm then describes how despite the impactful hit, Exploud staggers to its feet and carries on.

Encounter Objectives

You're in an Encounter. Now what? How do you determine the success or failure of the party? Simple, Encounter Objectives! In this section we'll discuss all of the possible Encounter Objectives that can occur during a Session.

Below is a list of each possible objective and a brief synopsis. Further on we'll go through each Objective, how to run it, special rules and actions in the objectives and examples of Encounters with that objective as a basis.

1. [Objective] Rout!

This is the simplest objective. The Players win whenever all enemies are fainted or are in a state of surrender.

2. [Objective] Capture!

This objective involves gaining possession of an object or creature in an area. Once they capture the object or creature, they must flee the encounter with enough distance or cause all enemies to become fainted or be in a state of surrender.

3. [Objective] Defend!

This objective involves defending a location, object or creature for a set duration of rounds or until all enemies are fainted or are in a state of surrender.

4. [Objective] Destroy!

This objective involves needing to destroy a location or object in order to succeed. Once they destroy the objective, they must flee the encounter with enough distance or cause all enemies to become fainted or be in a state of surrender.

5. [Objective] Escape!

This objective involves fleeing an area while facing obstacles such as the environment or opposing enemy forces.

6. [Objective] Survive!

This objective simply involves outlasting a timer while faced with overwhelming odds, reaching the end of a certain round before something occurs that helps your party win.

Example Multi-Objective Encounter- The Party comes across the Scene where they have to rescue a Teddiursa that is being beaten up by enemy Primeapes that are enraged. The Encounter has multiple objectives:

- » Objective [Rout or Escape]- They must defeat the Primeape or escape with a [Capture]'d Teddiursa
- » Objective [Survive]- The Teddiursa needs drastic medical attention by the end of Round 3 or else it'll be extremely injured.



Objective [Rout]

Rout Objectives are usually the default Objective when it comes to combat and is completed when all Enemies are Fainted or are in a state of surrender. Below are a few examples of how this Objective can be combined with others.

Scenario 1 - The Party must [Rout] a group of thugs as they [Defend] a Pokemon they're bullying.

Scenario 2 - The Party must [Rout] a group of wild Pokemon because they want to capture a Shinx in the group.

Scenario 3 - The Party must [Rout] a group of wild Pokemon defending a Team Rocket Encampment.

Objective Rules

1. If all Combatants in the allied Party are Fainted, the Objective is considered failed.
2. If all Enemies opposing the Party are Fainted or surrender, they succeed the Objective.

Running a Rout Objective

Rout Objectives are fairly standard and simple so there's nothing too special about them. When setting up a Rout Encounter, answer the following question.

1. Who are the Enemies?

That's it really. How many enemies will they face. Is the encounter balanced based on the party's capabilities, etc.

Example Rout Encounter - The party comes across a group of two Nidoking that are guarding the entrance of a building and decide to fight rather than deal with the situation socially or tactfully. They have a standard fight and beat up the Nidoking. The end.



Objective [Capture]

Capture Objectives always require a specific Object, Creature or Location to be taken until an alternate Encounter Objective is completed. When referring to the Object, Creature or Location(s) being captured, we'll call them the **"Points of Interest"**. Below are a few examples of how this Objective can be combined with others.

Scenario 1 - The Party must [Capture] a Garden Area from Rocket Grunts until they are [Rout]'ed

Scenario 2 - The Party must [Capture] an Artifact from a Museum and [Escape] before they're caught.

Scenario 3 - The Party must [Capture] an NPC in Jail and [Defend] them until they [Escape]

Objective Rules

1. The Objective is a success if the Party has the Point of Interest in a state of "Captured" and completes the other Objective.
2. The Objective is a failure if the Party is unable to capture the Point of Interest, are all fainted before they can or fails to complete the other Objective
3. Rules for what determines if a Point of Interest is considered "Captured" are listed below:

If the **Point of Interest is a Location**, create a Zone that determines how many spaces this location occupies, such as a 5x5 Zone. Capturing this Location involves ending a round with no enemies within this Zone.

If the **Point of Interest is an Inanimate Object**, the Point of Interest is captured when the object is put in a Player's Inventory, which can be done as a Swift Action if the Player is capable of picking it up. This can be done relatively easily if the Object is [Small], however, if the Object is [Large], it will likely need to be carried. When the Point of Interest is Large, consider how heavy it is and what the Power Value is of the Player that is carrying it, as they may be slowed in the process.

If the **Point of Interest is an Sentient Creature**, the Point of Interest is considered captured while they're in a Space that is Adjacent to you and no other Enemies are within 1m of them. These Points of Interest are often full NPCs and have their own Actions to use in battle. The creature can also either Willingly or Unwillingly follow you, leading to different rules. If they're unwilling, in order to be considered Captured, they need to be forced into willingness. This can be performed either by coercing them to follow you or forcing them to follow you such as carrying them.

Running a Capture Objective

When setting up a Capture Encounter, answer the following questions.

1. What are they Capturing?

There are a few categories of things that can be the Point of Interest, listed above. If they're capturing a location, they may need to rush towards a location and defend it from invading Pokemon for 3 Rounds! If they're capturing a priceless artifact, they may need to rush through a building to find the object, then stash it away before security can find out. If they're rescuing a Prisoner, maybe the party can divide itself into those that will defend them and those that will retaliate against their captors!

2. Can the Point of Interest assist the Party?

Sometimes the Point of Interest has innate abilities that can assist the Party while they're in a state of being captured. For example, a Location like a field of flowers could provide a soft buff of restoring 2 Ticks every Round. A shadow artifact being stolen may give an aura that temporarily buffs Dark Attacks while held in a Burst 2! Living Creatures being captured can also be statted or have a few actions they can do to help as they are escorted out. An example could be a sage that provides some DR once per Round to help the Party

Fun Fact - While I was playing Baldur's Gate 3, the most memorable encounter was the Iron Throne Prisoner fight in Act 3. Why? It was essentially a [Survive] & [Capture] Encounter where you were thrown into a literal sinking ship and expected to save and defend as many prisoners as possible. The enemies weren't difficult they just got in your way. Not to mention the high stakes of literal death if any couldn't be rescued. These types of encounters can lead to a lot of tension and excitement for your Players if done right.

3. Does the Point of Interest Harm the Party?

Sometimes the Point of Interest can conversely harm the party while it's captured, leading to more dire situations of needing to flee fast while they have it. It can also lead to decisions such as choosing who captures it and who can handle the debuffs. For example, locations like a overloading lab could shock and paralyze combatants every round. A rare artifact being captured could drain the life of those who hold it, the holder being permanently suppressed while it's held. An unwilling victim being captured could refuse to move alongside the party and actively struggle against them.

4. Who is resisting the Party?

If nobody was resisting the party, it wouldn't need a capture objective since they can just take it! When making the encounter, think of who is standing in the way of the Party and how they could prevent the Point of Interest from being taken. If they're capturing a prisoner, it could be the guards on duty or even other prisoners that don't like that guy in particular. If they're capturing a location, who else wants to occupy the location? They may need to capture a nest of Vullaby while a researcher is studying one of their eggs and they have to stave off swarms of birds attacking them.

5. Are there any complications in Capturing?

Sometimes capturing something doesn't exactly involve walking up to them, picking it up and leaving. In fact, it shouldn't! There should usually be some kind of complication that needs to be resolved in order to Capture the Point of Interest. For a Location, it could be clearing out any Pokemon in that Zone already. For an Object, the Object could be secure and the Players need to retrieve it somehow. For a Creature, there could be situations that lead them to be trapped and they Players need to resolve it. The Players could have to pick a lock to get in a cell or dispel a curse that keeps them trapped in the location or many other options.

Example Capture Encounter - During this Encounter, the Party needs to rescue one of their allied artificers that is being forced into working for the Empire in one of their military jails. The Players have done some research and have figured out the guard schedule of the jail and the inner workings of a magical neck brace that will harm anyone wearing it if they exceed a certain number of meters away from the jail.

During this encounter, they try to sneak in, dodging security checkpoints and finding the blindspots of the security cameras. They also use some devices to cause guards that are in their path to fall asleep and neutralize them. Eventually they reach the cell area and find the NPC they need to capture, however the cell has an electronic lock. The Player with decent Tech Edu tries to focus and make Skill checks to unlock it and does so, but triggers an alarm in the process. The party then quickly tries to take off their neck brace without harming them and manages to do so with a good result from an Occult Edu Skill Check, as it is magical in nature. The NPC is a Willing Creature and is now captured so long as they're Adjacent to a Player or their Pokemon. As they rush and try to flee the jail, they come across some guards and their Pokemon trying to stop them which they have to fight. Every now and then, the captured Artificer use their skills to alter the Items that Party has equipped, such as changing a Type Booster to Fire Type from Poison, then they may try to use Maneuvers every now and then like provoking the guards. After the battle resolves, they successfully flee the jail and are now fugitives harboring the escaped prisoner.



Objective [Defend]

Defend Objectives always require a specific Object, Creature or Location to be defended until an alternate Encounter Objective is completed. When referring to the Object, Creature or Location(s) being defended, we'll call them the "**Defendant**". Below are a few examples of how this Objective can be combined with others

Scenario 1 - The Party must [**Defend**] the City Gates from damage until all enemies are [**Rout**]'ed

Scenario 2 - The Party must [**Defend**] the City Gates and [**Survive**] until Round 5 when backup guards arrive.

Scenario 3 - The Party must escort and [**Defend**] an NPC out of a dungeon that they [**Capture**]'d

Objective Rules

1. If the defendant faints and the party has no way to revive them, the Objective is considered to have failed, however they still can escape with them.
2. If the defendant isn't Fainted (At GM Discretion) and the alternate Objective is completed, they succeed the Objective.
3. Rules for some Maneuvers are altered for the duration of this Objective:

» If the Party intercepts for an area of effect attack that hits the defendant, they may choose to have it miss the defendant instead of being treated as resisted, but it is one step more super effective against the Interceptor.

» The Intercept Maneuver may also be used as a Free Action if desired if intercepting for the defendant. After the Attack's resolution, the intercepting ally becomes Vulnerable until the end of the next Round. While Vulnerable this way, they cannot perform the Intercept Maneuver.

» When Intercepting for the defendant, the Party ignores all limitations of only being able to Intercept once per Round, such as through Defender Classes.

» When using the Riposte Maneuver for an Attack Targeting solely the defendant, it may be successful multiple times per Scene instead of only once per Scene.

4. The Defendant has the following Stats depending on if it's **Inanimate** or **Animate** and must be assigned a Tier of strength upon being created [These are different than Character Tiers such as Tier 1-3]. Animate Objects gain the values under their own column alongside the values for Inanimate Objects of their Tier. **(Defendants have Evasion equal to their DR divided by 5)**

Defendant Tier	Inanimate Object Stats	Animate Object Stats
Bronze Tier	50 Hit Points 10 Damage Reduction	...and 20 Attack & Special Attack
Silver Tier	100 Hit Points 20 Damage Reduction	...and 40 Attack & Special Attack
Gold Tier	200 Hit Points 30 Damage Reduction	...and 60 Attack & Special Attack
Platinum Tier	300 Hit Points 40 Damage Reduction	...and 80 Attack & Special Attack

What Tier is my Defendant?

The stat distributions in the table above allow your defendant to have multiple levels of durability and strength, depending on what you need. Remember it doesn't need to correspond to your Party's Tier! Listed below are some examples:

» City Walls (Platinum- Inanimate) | Village Walls (Silver- Inanimate) | City Walls with Archers ontop (Animate- Platinum)
 a Cult Altar (Gold- Animate) | a Merchant Stall (Bronze- Inanimate) | a Weak Trainer (Bronze- Animate)
 a Weak and Fearful Civilian (Bronze- Inanimate) | a Display Case with Treasure (Silver- Inanimate)

Running a Defend Objective

When setting up an Defend Encounter, answer the following questions.

1. What is the Defendant?

Simply put, what is the party defending? If they're defending an inanimate object, it likely can't assist in battle, whereas an animate object such as an NPC can possibly assist in battle. Next, how strong is the Defendant? This can be determined by its listed Tier which determine its Stats. If the Defendant is a simple group of NPCs, have it represented by a group of 5 tokens that are all Bronze Tier, all having 50 HP, 10 Damage Reduction, etc. Its tier can also be determined by how sturdy it is, such as Castle Walls being defended being Gold Tier and having 200 HP and 30 DR. Maybe you're even low level Trainers defending some wise master Aura Guardian who is Platinum Tier and can assist with Aura Attacks and have 80 Special Attack! If the Defendant is Animate, they also have their own turn in Combat, being able to move around and attack on their own.

2. Can the Defendant Assist?

The defendant doesn't have to be a sitting duck, even if it is Inanimate. When making a Defend Objective, consider how the Defendant can assist. It could be a wise Aura Master who uses Aura Sphere to help take out enemies. Even if it's Inanimate, it could be a defended City wall that on their turn, has archers above attack someone. Sometimes the defended object may not be able to act, such as a scared child, so keep all of this in mind to make combat interesting.

3. Are there multiple Defendants?

Sometimes it won't be one thing being defended but multiple, such as a location or group of creatures. When multiple things need defending, have them separated into different locations and each represented by a Token and their own stats and abilities. Be sure when you do this that it isn't expected that every Defendant comes out unscathed, as it's difficult for a party's attention to be split multiple directions.

It tends to feel more fair when a result happens because of dice and luck rather than a GM choosing to Target the defendant more.

4. Who are the Enemies?

Enemies in this objective will usually either want to [Destroy] the Defendant or [Capture] them back if they're being escorted out. When setting up the enemies, consider how they're related to the Defendant and what they can do to counteract the Player's goals. An example could be a swarm of invading Pokemon that only seek to attack the defended wall so a future swarm can rush into the city, and as such, they have blunt Attacks that ignore Damage Reduction like a Conkeldurr's weapon. This could allow for cool moments like a Player using an Analyze Maneuver on the weapon which tells them that yes, this is more effective at smashing walls.

Example Defend Encounter - In this Encounter, a group of Team Rocket grunts have caused a scene in a Marketplace full of Luxury Items, consisting of three vendor stalls. A Smokescreen was sent off and it seems that the grunts are sending out their Pokemon. Each vendor of the marketplace has a Pokemon of their own and requests the Party to quickly defend their items from being stolen. The map is set up where within a 10x10 Zone, there are three Vendor Stall Tokens, each 2x2 in size and being Silver Tier in Stats. The GM states that when a stall is "Fainted", they may steal from it and run off with loot.

The battlefield is chaotic and large. There are 4 Grunts with their own Pokemon, an Admin commanding from the backline and on the Player's side, 3 NPCs and their Pokemon along with 2 Players and their Pokemon, chaos everywhere. During the battle they learn that one of the stalls has a special component they're specifically targeting so they have one player defend that stall while the others try to take out the grunts. A few grunts focus the side stalls as they realize they're losing, letting a few attacks go through and one of the three stalls are destroyed. A few of the grunts walk up to the stall and [Capture] some loot but as they try to run, one of the Player's Pokemon traps them, keeping them from escaping as the Players faint the rest of the enemies and they flee. Despite a stall being destroyed and some of the items there damaged, most of the merchandise was protected and the vendors are thankful and reward the players.

Enemy Aggro

Sometimes it can be difficult to know what your enemies are going to target. If the Enemies only target the Players and basically ignore the Defendant, it feels like a [Rout] Objective with extra steps. On the other side, if they target the defendant too much, the Players may feel like it's unfair and they have to waste their turn making sure the Defendant doesn't get injured. So how do you strike a balance? We suggest that unless an Enemy has a good reason to target the Defendant, their Target is randomized by dice.

To do this Roll a d4. On a 1, they'll Target the Defendant if it's able to be attacked. Otherwise they attack the ones protecting the Defendant.

Objective [Destroy]

Destroy Objectives always require a specific Object or Location to be destroyed instead of enemy Pokemon or Trainers. This is essentially the opposite of the Defend Objective. When referring to the Object or Location(s) being destroyed, we'll call them the **"Points of Interest"**. Below are a few examples of how this Objective can be combined with others

Scenario 1 - The Party must [Destroy] the City Gates before the enemies [Rout] them

Scenario 2 - The Party must [Destroy] the City Gates while the enemies try to [Survive] until Round 5 when backup guards arrive.

Scenario 3 - The Party must [Destroy] a Generator that keeps creating solosis minions, then they must [Rout] all remaining Pokemon.

Objective Rules

1. If the Point of Interest is Fainted, the Party succeeds this Objective.
2. If the Point of Interest is not Fainted and defended by the enemies, the Party fails this Objective.
3. The Point of Interest has the following Stats depending on if it's **Passive or Active** and must be assigned a Tier of strength upon being created. **Active Objects** gain the values under their own column alongside the values for **Passive Objects** of their Tier. If desired, Objects can have multiple HP Bars if you wish to increase the difficulty, as if they were a boss. **(Points of Interest have Evasion equal to their DR divided by 5)**

Strength Tier	Passive Object Stats	Active Object Stats
Bronze Tier	100 Hit Points 10 Damage Reduction	...and 20 Attack & Special Attack
Silver Tier	200 Hit Points 20 Damage Reduction	...and 40 Attack & Special Attack
Gold Tier	300 Hit Points 40 Damage Reduction	...and 60 Attack & Special Attack
Platinum Tier	500 Hit Points 60 Damage Reduction	...and 80 Attack & Special Attack

Running a Destroy Objective

When setting up a Destroy Encounter, answer the following questions.

1. What are they destroying?

Unlike Defend Objectives, Objects you're meant to destroy should always be Inanimate (Otherwise it's just a Rout if they're a full Combatant), however some of these are Active and some are Passive in terms of Combat utility. Passive Objects may include a Farmhouse that is just sitting there and needs to be razed to the ground due to the amount of drugs stored inside. It cannot participate in the encounter. However, Active Objects like a Factory Generator may be treated as a Combatant and given a Turn in the Initiative to perform Actions, or just acts at the end of the Round. It should also be given Stats based on its Tier of Strength, listed in the chart above. If they're destroyed a Wooden Statue, it may be Bronze Tier but if they're razing a giant Automaton Framework, it may be Gold or Platinum. If it's weird to give stats to something inanimate, just imagine that this is the amount of damage it can take before it structurally collapses.

Active Point of Interest Examples

Below are some examples of Active Points of Interest:

- » The Party is attempting to destroy an Altar to Yveltal that is radiating dark energy. The Altar resists Ranged Attacks by an additional step and at the end of each Round it will use Dark Pulse in a Burst 2 Range. The Altar is Gold Tier.
- » The Party is attempting to destroy a generator that is going haywire and will explode in 3 Rounds. The generator is Silver Tier and each time an Enemy ends their turn within 2m of it, it'll use Thunder Wave on it. At the end of each Round it will target 2 Random Enemies within 5m to use Thunderbolt on or use Discharge.
- » The Party sees 3 Portals spawn during an Encounter with Palkia, each being Gold Tier. Whenever a Round ends with less than 4 Minion Pokemon, each Portal will spawn one until there are 4 Minions. Additionally after a Portal is Attacked by an Enemy within 2m, they'll use Expanding Force but can only do so once per Round.

2. How does the Point of Interest contribute to Combat?

If the Object is active, such as the Factory Generator in the example earlier, the GM or Encounter Creator may determine a list of actions it can use on its turn. For the Generator it could as a Standard Action increase any Electric Type by +2 CS in a Stat or use the Attack Zap Cannon. However some Passive Objects may also have battle effects despite not having a Turn. If you're trying to destroy an Altar, it could have the battle effect of making all Dark Type Attacks in a Burst 1 Range be unable to miss and be treated as low lighting in that range. Some Passive Objects can just do nothing though, like a simple building that can't do anything.

3. What are the Enemies?

The Enemies obviously do not want the Point of Interest to be destroyed so they should be opposing the Party while they try to focus on the object. There could be multiple types of enemies to spice up the encounter. Some may try to stop the progress of the Party by impeding them with afflictions. Some may try to [Defend] the Point of Interest by fighting the Players. And some may try to empower the Point of Interest to restore the damage done to it. Having varied enemies could provide different priorities and focus for the Players to factor.

Example Destruction Encounter - During this Encounter, the Players need to destroy a Ritual site before it can be completed. The GM informs them that the site is swarmed with cultists so they're very outnumbered and all they need to do is halt the ritual. The Encounter will automatically refill with cultist Pokemon at the end of each round, so the Party needs to focus on two ritual sites, each being a Gold Tier Passive Object. The ritual sites themselves empower the cultists around them, increasing their Stats by +2 CS at the end of each round if they're within 2m of it.

After around 4 Rounds of fighting, they manage to break one of the ritual sites but get overwhelmed and have to flee before they could finish off the other objective. Narratively the encounter was partial success, delaying the cult but angering them in the process.



Objective [Escape]

Escape Objectives require the entire Party to move on the map to an “**Extraction Zone**”, by which they can escape the map. Below are a few examples of this Objective

Scenario 1 - The Party must [Escape] the Museum with the stolen artifact before the enemies find them

Scenario 2 - The Party must [Escape] the City with a hostage they [Capture]’d.

Scenario 3 - The Party must [Defend] the exit of a City as dangerous criminals attempt to [Escape]

Objective Rules

1. The Party succeeds this Objective if all Allies escape once they reach the Extraction Zone.
2. The Party fails this Objective if any Ally cannot reach the Extraction Zone, fainting before so.
3. When starting this Objective, create a Zone with a Maximum size of 3x3 (It can be any iteration such as 1x3). This will be known as the **Extraction Zone**. When an Ally reaches the Extraction Zone, as a Standard Action, they can escape. When they escape, they are removed from combat, removed from the Scene and successfully have escaped. Allies cannot Escape if there is an active Enemy within 3m of them.

Running an Escape Objective

When setting up an Escape Encounter, answer the following questions.

1. Where are the Escape Routes?

For each possible escape route, create an Extraction Zone at the edge of that area where the Party can move to as the scene progresses. There can be multiple Escape Routes if desired and Players could even create new Extraction Zones if they’re creative so don’t be afraid to manipulate the zones during the Scene. For example, the enemies could block a doorway by using Rock Slide to block the zone so they have to be destroyed before they can escape. Another example could be a Party member seeing that the exit is barricaded and deciding to climb to the roof and break a window to leave the area, creating a new Extraction Zone. Be sure that if you create an obstacle in the way of an Escape Route, there is a method of removing the Obstacle or there is another route planned. If your Players are having a hard time imagining a solution, rolling Guile can serve as your Character’s Wit and improvisational skills during a stressful situation like running away.

2. How is the Map laid out?

Map design is fairly important during an Escape so that the Encounter isn’t simply walking from point A to point B in 3 rounds. Designing an interesting escape map can be done in a couple ways. First, the map size should usually be around 30x30 to 50x50. Considering the default Combatant can move 6m in a round, this leads the Scene to take around 3-5 Rounds. Secondly, you should consider how the moveable areas are laid out so the Party has to move through interesting areas. For example, the escape could be indoors and have to jump through multiple obstacles that impede their progress. There also could be choke points and traps that have to be resolved before they could continue their path to the escape route, or they’d have to resolve them somehow to bypass it.

3. Where are the Enemies?

Whenever the Party is trying to escape, the area they’re in is rarely abandoned so where are the antagonists that intend to stop the Players from escaping? They could be bunched together and will disperse when the party triggers security. They could be patrolling the area near the extraction point. Or possibly they know the party is escaping and are barricaded near the Extraction Zone in order to stop them! Remember they can’t flee if enemies are near the Zone.

Interesting Escape Encounter Examples

- » The Party stole an Ancient Relic inside of a castle but their disguise has been figured out! They are now being chased throughout the hallways that currently have crowds of people and guards, leading to a chaotic encounter.
- » The Party is trying to escape the forest to reach a speed boat extraction point. They are being chased overhead by a Genesect that is blasting them with attacks from above.

Artist: @lime garden

4. What Obstacles will they face?

If there are no obstacles, escaping simply becomes walking from point A to point B as fast as possible in character. When creating the Encounter, think of the path the Players will take to reach the Extraction Zone and spice it up with some obstacles. Examples could include a locked door that needs to be broken down, security points such as tripwire or traps being set by those they're trying to escape from! These obstacles could range from requiring a Skill Check to remove it or serve as a checkpoint where they need to do something in the Encounter in order for it to be removed.

5. What are the Stakes?

If there were no stakes, it would simply be going from point A to point B in Character and maybe facing a few Pokemon in between then. When making this Encounter, think of the stakes involved and how you can add tension. This can usually be imposed by either a time limit to failure [Survive] or by having enemies actively threatening the Party as they try to reach the Extraction Zone. Examples could include needing to escape in 5 Rounds or else an Alarm will be tripped and the exit will be sealed off. Another could be that they need to rescue as many people as possible from a building on fire and escape with their own lives before the fire starts to weaken the building structure.

Example Escape Encounter - During this Encounter, the Party needs to steal a large silver bell with historical significance to Johto from a mansion which involves the [Capture] and [Escape] Objectives. Hypothetically, let's say the Party cleared a few guarding Pokemon and got to the sanctum and took the bell. An alarm was tripped and suddenly the house gets foggy with spectral sounds lingering around. The Party knows of one Escape Route being the back door they came through. They also know they could leave through the front door but that's riskier for being seen. They have one member carry the bell which makes them Slowed while they formulate a plan.

As they retrace their steps through the house, the fog starts to spawn ghost type Pokemon that try to defend the house and attack the intruders. It seems as though regardless of the number of Pokemon they defeat, more will spawn provided they're inside the house. Eventually reach the basement door which is mystically blocked as an obstacle, glowing the same dark red as a Dusclops Boss that just appeared. After the boss is defeated, the door opens and they gain access to the rest of the house and reach the exit they came through, however it is glowing a bright light that burns them when touched. They try an Occult Edu Check but fail to learn how to dispel the lock. After quick thinking, they break a nearby window to create a new extraction point, however it is small so it's a 1x1 space and each need to take their time to leave through the window.



Objective [Survive]

Survive Objectives are an Objective based on reaching the end of a specific round rather than completing an Objective. Conversely, it could be reaching a certain objective in a listed time frame rather than having infinite rounds to do so. Below are a few examples of this Objective

Scenario 1 - The Party must **[Survive]** 3 Rounds of Combat as they are swarmed by a horde of wild Pokemon. After which, an expert rescue team will come and save them

Scenario 2 - In a **[Survive]** Encounter, the Party must **[Capture]** an artifact and **[Escape]** before Round 5, by which the alarm will be set off as the guards notice the artifact is missing.

Scenario 3 - The Party must **[Survive]** 3 Rounds of Combat of swarming reinforcements, then **[Rout]** them all as the reinforcements cease after the **[Survive]** Objective is completed.

Objective Rules

1. Upon determining the Objective, inform the players what occurs at the end of the time limit and what Round in which this will occur. This should usually be at the end of Round 3 or Round 5.
2. The Objective automatically succeeds or fails whenever the time limit is reached, depending on what they are trying to survive.

Running a Survival Objective

When setting up a Survival Encounter, answer the following questions.

1. What are they trying to Survive?

Select one of the following examples and derive your encounter based on that:

A. Environmental Survival

In this type of Survival, the environment will have a dangerous element to it until the Win Condition is met, altering the Encounter until resolved. This may include the party getting caught in a heavy Sandstorm that deals scaling damage as time progresses. This could include a forest fire that started and will expand unless dealt with by the party and if 5 Rounds go by it will get out of control.

B. Swarming Survival

In this type of Survival, Pokemon will endlessly enter the Encounter until the Win Condition is met. When the number of enemies is determined upon statting, keep a note of that number. (The recommended number is double the number of Players) At the end of the Round, Pokemon will enter the Encounter from a source so that the total conscious Combatants equal the original number. For example, if there are 3 Players and an opposition of 5 Pokemon, then by the end of Round 1, 2 Pokemon faint. As a result at the start of Round 2, 2 Pokemon will enter the Scene. If the Swarm lasts until Round 3 for example, Pokemon will stop being added after that point and it could just return to [Escape] or [Rout].

C. Timed Survival

In this type of Survival, you need to complete the Win Condition before a certain Round is reached or else the Objective will be considered failed. While other types of Survival usually have a Timed Win Condition, this type of Survival doesn't alter the Encounter in any heavy way and instead poses a narrative consequence on failure. For example, a Poisoned NPC starts to hyperventilate and requires immediate medical attention in 3 Rounds or else they'll faint. Cases like this don't have to be the center of an Encounter but could be side Objectives for intrigue.

2. How can the Party Survive this?

This will need to be fairly transparent when declaring to the Party that this is a Survive Objective Encounter. The Party will need to know what they need to do in order to survive and beat this Objective. It is usually not clear as a player on how this is to be done without GM input. As a GM, remember to be open to Party solutions that can resolve the Objective earlier. As an example, if there is an explosion in a cave that reveals a tunnel that Pokemon are swarming out of, the Party could use Sticky Webs to close off the entrance with a net of webs and delay further Pokemon from coming out that way, allowing them to focus or escape.

If an Objective has a limited amount of time to win, such as an injured NPC needing medical attention, tell them it looks urgent if they have a good enough skill check. If a forest fire occurred during an encounter and it will spread way too far by Round 5, tell them it seems to be growing rapidly and they need to think of solutions to ease the spread such as Water Attacks to clear a number of zones. If the Party needs to wait until Round 3 before reinforcements can arrive, tell them nothing else they do will resolve the objective other than holding out.

Example Survival Encounter - The Party is trying to rescue an NPC that has found their way into a maximum security cell. While they have reached the cell, a Scene with a [Survive] and [Capture] Objective occurs solely inside that room because they discover that the room is full of special gas that neutralizes all supernatural powers, to the point where the NPC has lost their abilities of Divination. While the objective before was just to retrieve them, now they need to [Survive] the Encounter or else their Supernatural Powers may similarly be affected. The Cell is small, around 10x10, but occupied by some pokemon and the NPC is chained up.

The [Survive] Objective will Fail if Round 3 ends and they're still exposed to the Gas. The scene proceeds and they try to rush into the room, rushing to unchain the NPC and defeat the native Poison Type Cryogonals that have caused this gas in the first place. However, in the first Round, a Player was struggling with their chains and took a bit longer to free them. After some difficulty with the Pokemon, they manage to escape the Cell, but at the end of Round 4 instead. As a result of failing the [Survive] Objective, the Party will suffer some effects of the Gas, albeit temporarily. For a few sessions afterwards, they'll have some strain when using Supernatural Abilities and if they aren't careful, they may suffer more, causing them to try to relax more to let the effects wear off over time. As such, they'll gain Stress Tokens whenever they activate powers from their Supernatural Capabilities and Class Features.



Making Unique Encounters

Anyone can simply stat up Pokemon and throw them into an encounter, but what are some ways that you can make your sessions truly unique? Below are a few tips you could follow in order to increase their appeal.

Add Alternative Objectives

The basic and default win condition in most TTRPGs is beating up enemies until they lose all their HP and faint or a Narrative Encounter. This is the expected goal of encounters so if you want to make things interesting, change the encounter goal or add some alternative objectives! The GM guide has a list of objectives other than knocking out all enemies, such as defending, escaping or surviving! These objectives can either be the main point of an encounter or a side quest of sorts that the characters have to think of on the spot.

Example - While the Players face a team of evil villains who are setting fire to a town, they see a small group of orphans in two different alleyways, with a nearby house on fire! With their quick wit, they unlock a second Objective, being to defend the orphans from casualties of the battle and to escort them to safety! They could focus on simply defeating the enemies but it may affect the narrative if these combatants were hurt as a result.

Diversify the Enemies & Field

Ideally, if your Party faces an Alakazam, it shouldn't be the same as any other Alakazam they've faced in the past. This can be accomplished in multiple ways such as adding different Roles but Pokemon can also be adjusted in other ways. This can include adding Pokemon Templates to guys in your encounters such as Bosses, Minions, Swarms or Variant Pokemon. You can also diversify the field by incorporating Terrain Tags or other options listed in the "Making Unique Battlemaps" section which is more expansive.

Example - For one Encounter, I have the Party face a Kadabra trained by a Fighter who has the Mystic Role and knows a bunch of punching Attacks, channeling their Special Attack to their Attack stat and slaps people with their spoons instead of traditional telekinesis. For another Encounter, I have the Party face an Alakazam that has an Alpha Template and is in an arena in which it can shift the tiles underneath the enemies and if they fall, they land into a pit of Gravelers. For another Encounter, I have the Party face an Esper Trainer who has convinced an army of 4 Minion Abra to follow its command in order to rob bakeries.

Give Enemies unique Tactics & Gimmicks

You know how your players plan their builds and sometimes focus on specific combos and tactics? So should their enemies! Whenever you make an NPC, use the same thought process to determine what their specialty could be, if they have one. If you want to go a step further you could also grant them custom effects that buff their gimmick of choice that are unique to them! You don't have to do this for everyone but sprinkle it in here and there to showcase that other NPCs can have unique styles of their own to represent their own training!

Example - An enemy trainer is a Fire Specialist and has built their team to be solely of fire types. They even have a special [Order] that can cause an ally to burst into a vortex of flames as they fight and anyone who ends their turn adjacent to them becomes burned!

Consider Narrative Ties

If a Scene isn't tied to the narrative, it's basically playing PTE just for the gameplay. It's similar to running down a route and facing 4 different trainers, you won't remember their names, they're just EXP on a stick. If you want to make a scene more intriguing, add some stakes or some tie to the narrative so that the encounter matters more.

Change the Scene based on Combatant Interactions

The strength of a TTRPG System is the ability to improvise and react based on the players compared to a linear story in a video game, so take advantage of it! You can plan an encounter or a city your Players will interact with, but you can't possibly anticipate how they'll react. If you want your scenes to be more memorable, act on your toes and whatever your Players want to do, see how they can be incorporated into the scene and how the scene can react back to it!

Example - An Enemy Sandslash is running away, looking to escape through a small hole in the cave. The players use Rock slide in order to block off the enemy's path and making it panic. A player decides to use flamethrower on a bridge as they escape a group of enemies, causing it to burn down and be destroyed. In the scene you have a hidden crate that has mysterious glyphs on it when noticed. The party's objective was to simply clear the building of Pokemon but after investigating, they realize a glyph was on it and a Unown joins the encounter along with a Rockruff that was trapped inside!

Making Unique Battlemaps

Ever wonder how to make battle maps and build scenes as a GM? Follow the tips below when creating maps to ensure that the Encounter is interesting and engaging to interact with!

Use Terrain Tags

If you even use this one tip, I promise your maps will be 10x more interesting. Making a battlefield not just an empty space of flat land is the one thing that encourages tactical gameplay and creative thinking. For the example listed below, in this Scene, I need to transform a field of flowers into an interesting map.

Examples

- » I make a few patches of Rough Terrain, being tall fields of grass.
- » I add a few trees here and there to serve as Breakable Blocking Terrain that can also be climbed up to 3m. I even hid a sleeping Heracross in there!
- » I add a few large bushes that can be treated as Cover Terrain for Small Creatures.
- » I designate a few fields of flowers as Blessed Terrain and while any Combatant is on it, they have +2 to Save Checks and if they're Grass or Fairy and start their Turn there, they gain a Tick of Temporary HP.

Add Fluff

When designing a battlemap you should always add fluff and flavor that makes the environment feel lived in and alive. The most interesting battles I've seen are ones that don't take place in an arena with a flat field but those that happen in alleyways or on top of mountain cliffs, so when designing combat encounters take this into account! For example, I could make an Encounter in an alleyway a pure hallway of a 5x15 sized Map with high rise buildings on each side and scrap boxes along the walls but that wouldn't be very interesting. So when adding fluff, I decide to add the following to make the scene more lively.

Examples

- » I make the buildings smaller to reach around 10m in height, but I add fire escape platforms, allowing for a few platforms that can be climbed onto for high ground via a ladder
- » I add an NPC of two children who are simply playing in the alleyway but aren't expecting a dangerous Encounter to occur by a criminal being chased down it. This also leads to an additional element of the party needing to prevent damage to them as collateral damage.
- » I add a lot more storage boxes and dumpsters scattered along the wall and I even keep a list of loot that is contained with them in case they're broken but they can also climb them to a height of 2m.
- » I add a few small patches of oil and trash along the alleyway ground to serve as hazardous and slow terrain.

Make it Interactable

I never like looking at a map, getting an idea to do something, then having it shot down or just having it told to me that it's a set piece. When using Terrain Tags, think of the Breakable and Reactive Tag and how you can implement aspects of that in your map. Also think of how aspects of your map can be used in unique ways! Even if you don't foresee your players asking about it, keep in mind what something may do if interacted with, such as the examples below:

Examples

- » A player decides to use a Twin Flame Attack and instead of Targeting another Enemy, they target the stack of wooden boxes the first target is standing on. After it hits, the boxes are set on fire, turning into Fire Hazard and burning the first Enemy.
- » I have a "King of the Swamp" Swalot that is lurking within a massive 30x30 murky lake. It's ability allows it to originate any Water Attack from a space that is on the lake, allowing it to shoot waves all over the place
- » A Player that is standing on top of a cliff decides to strike the ground with their massive greatsword, causing a tremor that causes a rock slide to occur on enemies below.
- » A generator that is going haywire has two safety switches that need to be pulled at the same time in order to shut off the power, but they're on opposing sides of the map.

Account for Strategy

Lastly when making a map, consider what the layout and how the players will move inside it and how it can lead to strategy. If you have an alternate Objective other than routing, you should also pay attention to how they can use the terrain to their advantage. After all, castles oftentimes have moats associated with them because that way there would only be one way inside, leading to a choke point and easier time defending it. Here are some ways of accounting for strategy:

Examples

- » During an Escape Encounter map, the map consists of plenty of narrow hallways, obstacles and possible alternate escape routes such as a cracked wall that can be destroyed for a shortcut
- » There are many narrow corridors where enemies have set up traps and force players to be close together
- » There are two options for extraction zones as the team escapes a jail with multiple pathways to take like stairs, windows and elevators.

Map Hazards & Props

Do you want to add some spice to your map and set up traps or hazards to increase tactical play? Refer to this section for a few ideas on how you can make your battlefield interesting. For each of these, you must determine the source of the Hazard. If it were set up by an Enemy beforehand, it may only affect their Enemies, as they wouldn't trigger it themselves. If it's set up by the Terrain or environment, it should likely affect everyone. Smoke Hazards for example couldn't be ignored. All of the following is enforced by the rules of Hazardous Terrain.

Standard Hazards

Dust Hazard

Spaces with Dust Hazards are treated as Rough Terrain. A Combatant that enters a Space affected by this Hazard has their Accuracy lowered by -3 until the end of their next Turn. This is ignored by Enemies with Blindsense.

Examples - A Sandstorm whips up clouds of dust hazards around the field.

Fire Hazard

When any Combatant ends their Turn on or enters a space with a Fire Hazard, they become Burned. Ground and Rock Type Pokemon are Immune to Fire Hazards and destroy them when moving through. Ground, Rock and Water Type Attacks that Target these Spaces also destroy these Hazards. Fire Type Pokemon are Immune to this Hazard's Effects.

Note: This may also be refluffed to any other Affliction like a Sludge Hazard to make them Poisoned.

Examples - A barrel explodes and causes fire to the grass around it. A boss Charizard leaves a trail of flames in the wake of its Line 6 improved Flamethrower.

Gas Hazard

Any Combatant who ends their Turn on or enters a space with a Gas Hazard loses one Tick of Hit Points and suffers any additional effects derived from the source. This Effect is ignored by Combatants with the Breathless Capability.

Examples - Nerve Gas that causes anyone who enters it to become Suppressed or Poisoned. A noxious cloud from a Vileplume that causes Enemies to become Paralyzed.

Pitfall Hazard

Spaces with Pitfall Hazards are treated as Slow Terrain. A Grounded Combatant that ends their Turn on a Pitfall Trap becomes Tripped and Weakened while Tripped this way. At GM Discretion, some Pitfall Hazards may drop a Combatant up to 4m down.

Examples - A tribe of ninjas set up Pitfalls around the entrance of their village. Make sure if you use these you can think of at least one method of getting out.

Proximity Hazard

Any Combatant who enters a Space within 2m of this Hazard applies its effects. This Range may be adjusted by the GM.

Examples - An Explosive Prop Landmine has a proximity that explodes if someone enters 1m of it. A Gravity well slides Combatants to the center if they move within 2m of it unless they pass an Athletics Check.

Slick Hazard

Each Time a Grounded Combatant enters a Slick Hazard, roll a d6. On a 1, they may choose the one of the following to apply. They slide 3m in the direction they entered the Hazard from. They immediately Trip. After either of the following, their Movement ends. Unlike normal Hazard Rules, this applies each time a Combatant enters a Slick Hazard instead of just once per Round.

Examples - Slippery mud. Slick Ice. An oil spill.

Slow Hazard

Spaces with Slow Hazards are treated as Slow Terrain. A Grounded Combatant that enters a Space affected by this Hazard has their Speed lowered by -3 CS, becomes Slowed and is Vulnerable while Slowed this way.

Examples - Deep Mud. Webs. Dense Branches.

Smoke Hazard

Combatants within a Smoke Hazard cannot be Targeted by Attacks deriving from Combatants who are not in a Smoke Hazard. Combatants in a Smoke Hazard cannot Target Combatants outside of a Smoke Hazard. This Effect is ignored by Combatants with Tremorsense or Blindsense.

Note: Remember you can't split your Movement Action so someone can't start in the fog, walk out, attack, then walk back in.

Examples - Smokescreens. Fog. Steam vapor.

Spike Hazard

Spaces with Spike Hazards are treated as Slow Terrain. Any Grounded Combatant that enters a space with a Spike Hazard loses one Tick of Hit Points and cannot gain Hit Points or Temporary Hit Points until the end of the next Round..

Examples - Sharp rocky terrain or scattered debris.

Stealth Rock Hazard

Spaces with Stealth Rock Hazards are treated as Rough Terrain. Any Combatant that would move through or move within 1m of this Hazard loses a Tick of Hit Points, then this Hazard is destroyed. If the Triggering Enemy would be Weak to Rock Type Attacks, they lose Two Ticks.

Examples - Scattered rocks from a powerful rock attack. Rocky Terrain in a mountain.

Wall Hazard

Spaces with Wall Hazards are treated as Blocking Terrain. If this Hazard is Targeted by an Attack and hits, it is destroyed. (This is considered to have no Evasion).

Examples - Temporary Illusory barriers. Temporary walls built up from the ground.

Battlefield Props

Aura Conduit

This Prop has Hit Points equal to 20 times the Party's Trainer Level and Attacks cannot miss it. While this Prop exists on the field, an effect persists within a range specified by the GM.

Examples - A Banner that gives Enemies a Tick of Temp HP at the start of their Turn. An Electric Crystal that gives all Electric Attacks the Smite Keyword while it persists. A Cleanse Tag that causes Ghosts to become Weakened while they're within

Control Panel

This Prop may be interacted with as a Swift Action in order to change something on the Battlefield. Each Control panel has an associated Space on the Field that the Combatant must occupy in order to interact with it.

Examples - A Switch that opens and closes an illusory wall. A panel that activates a laser that charges a thunderbolt on projected spaces on the field that occur at the end of the next round. A button that causes random flooring to crumble and collapse.

Explosive Prop

When an Explosive is targeted by a Damaging Attack, they explode in a Burst 1 or Burst 2 Range, depending on their potency. All Combatants within this Range are hit by an Attack the GM assigns to this Hazard. If the Attack is Damaging, it follows Environmental Damage Rules. This Attack may be Analyzed by Combatants. This may also be created as a Hazard which triggers the Attack upon entering the Space.

Examples - A Barrel of Gunpowder explodes into a Flamethrower with a Burst 2 Range. A Spider Pod explodes into a Burst 1 of haze, affecting everyone with Stun Spore.

Machinery

While a Combatant is on the Space in which the Machinery occupies, they may utilize it if they succeed an appropriate Education Check as a Swift Action. The effects of this Machinery is dependent on the GM. While an Enemy is adjacent to them, they cannot utilize the effects of the Machinery as it requires more focus than a Control Panel.

Examples - A Ballista requires a Combat Check in order to use and is treated as a stationary Weapon with 10m Range. A Catapult can allow a Combatant to use a Standard Action to launch at a Ranged Blast 3 Area on the map with an Environmental "Rock Slide". A Fire Acolyte uses a channeling machine to empower their Fire Attacks into Line 8 and increases their AOE by +1.

Teleporters

When a Combatant enters this Space, as a Swift Action they may move to its linked Teleporter, as if they used the Teleporter Capability. They may continue any movement they were performing before teleporting this way. This may also be created as a Hazard which triggers the teleportation upon entering the Space.

Examples - A Spatial Portal created by palkia. Team Rocket hazard tiles that blink someone to a different location.

Unstable Prop

At the end of each Round, something occurs within a projected area. This can be disabled by the GM's Discretion, usually either being hit by a Damaging Attack or by passing a Skill Check when adjacent to it as a Swift Action.

Examples - An unstable machine that uses Discharge at the end of every round. A bunch of vines that whiplash with Power Whip in a projected Line 4 at the end of each round.

Rewards & Treasure

So your players deserve a reward after their hard work and achievements during their Campaign, what are your options? The following list a few options you could grant them (**Besides Money**):

Networking & Favor

While not always seen as a reward, social credit, favor points and building up your Party's social network is an underrated reward that when used by creative players is a great solution to problems. Whenever a Player would improve their relationship with NPCs, feel free to grant them Favor Points and keep track of their affiliation so that during the future, the NPC can possibly be called on when resolving potential problems. Not to mention, reaching certain levels of trust could also grant access to more personal services or provide unique solutions.

Examples - The player rescues the lost piplup of an npc who happens to be a bartender at a seedy nightclub. They can connect the player with a few people who have connections to the black market in order to find a rare mineral

Improved Resource Gain

A large reason why base building games are so popular is because people like their actions resulting in a greater output and improved resources. When factoring in rewards, perhaps the Party gains something that makes their lives easier? This could include gaining access to a service, gaining cheaper items from a source, or being able to craft something they couldn't before.

Examples - When investigating in a Power Plant they find a rare Electrizer which can be used as an energy source for a fisherman's boat back in their home village. The fisherman powers up his boat and can go out further into the ocean and has access to a lot more Water Pokemon of higher rarity such as selling Relicanths and Luvdiscs.

Character Boons

Sometimes whenever your Players achieve something, it makes sense that they'd learn a skill permanently or gain a blessing of some sort, leading to a permanent buff! This can consist of a blessing, a special talent, gaining a unique [Order], etc.

Examples - After saving an avatar of Xerneas, a Player is granted a unique capability called Lifesense in which they can sense if someone is injured within 50m of them and when touching a creature can sense their life force.

Plot Advancement

Everyone is here for the plot, a perfectly good reward is seeing tangible progress in completing the goals of the party. Additionally, rewards could also include advancements in personal character arcs.

Examples - After completing a quest, an NPC grants the Player an ancient book with history of a lost civilization that has ties to the Player's ancestry.

Direct Worldbuilding

Rewarding Players by granting Player Agency is a great way of feeling like they made an impact on your setting. When figuring out a reward for a Session, think of the impact they made on the world? Perhaps clearing a gang of Pokemon now allows traders to travel freely and the marketplace becomes full of exotic vendors the next day.

Examples - After defeating a Tyrant Arcanine terrorizing a forest, a lot of the more scared Pokemon start to repopulate the area with rare Pokemon.

Unique Items

Gaining Unique items akin to Magic Items is always something that will excite players especially if it fits into their build and enables them to do interesting things. When doing this however, be wary that you don't hand out too many unique items and there isn't favoritism in who gets them. If you need some examples of Items to give out, the Treasure Tab in the Item Index has some!

Examples - A Shrine Maiden had fun socializing with one of the Players and gives her a blessed charm that's a [Possession] and she can keep it in her jacket. The charm has a one time usage and when she or her Pokemon are hit by a critical hit Ghost or Psychic Attack, the charm instead absorbs the attack and the ward wears off.

Unique Pokemon

You could always grant your Players Pokemon whenever they complete an achievement! After all, Pokemon with special origins tend to be more meaningful compared to random Pokemon you find in the wild grass. They can be unique in either having special attacks, special abilities or possibly variant effects!

Examples - The Players find an NPC trapped in a power plant being held hostage by a massive Magnezone. After the players save the NPC, one of his two Elekids he was raising wants to join the players, admiring their bravery.

Creating Abilities & Attacks

Creating custom Attacks and Abilities is one of the more special rewards that a Trainer could get because they're entirely unique to your Campaign! However, it can be difficult to gauge what is balanced, especially if you're new to the system, so this section will offer some tips and examples on creating new ones.

CUSTOM ABILITIES

Abilities are all granted at Level 1 so they all have relatively the same amount of power level to them. When making an Ability, follow these tips.

Make it central to a playstyle

Think about abilities like Soundproof. How relevant are they in 99% of battles? The answer is usually minimally, so most Abilities have been remade to enable a sort of playstyle that the Pokemon can choose to excel in. When making an Ability, think about what its effects allow it to do different compared to the normal species of a Pokemon!

Example 1 - Chaotic allows the user to use Metronome with more viability, enabling a sort of chaotic random Pokemon.

Example 2 - Signature Abilities like Fiery Soul allow it to gain mechanics to a fluff part of their design, such as the little fire bird on Skeledirge.

Make it consistent or scaleable based on Level

Depending on what the ability grants, it should be balanced at Pokemon Level 5 and Pokemon Level 80. If it isn't, then it should be scalable around the point where it'd drop off. For example, Aroma Veil is a consistent Ability at all levels because it has the same result of curing an Affliction. Although the Aura Surge Ability needs restrictions and Level scaling because of its Effect. The Ability lets a Pokemon have a +5 Bonus to damage per Tick of HP they're missing. At low levels this can lead to insane damage boosts such as +30 if they have less than 40% HP and can easily one hit KO pokemon at that level. As a result, it's effect references the Character's Tier, by which its numbers will be scaled based on the Level they are and it'll automatically scale!

Example - The Bountiful Harvest Ability doesn't need to be scaled because it restores two Ticks of Hit points. As a Pokemon levels up, their Tick Value increases, so the output of this Ability also increases and scales up alongside them. 10% of their HP will always increase with their Level so it'll scale.

Don't make it too niche or conditional

The problem with niche or conditional Abilities is that whenever it isn't relevant, the Pokemon basically doesn't have an Ability. The reason why Abilities like Flash Fire were removed is because it had very few cases where it actually was useful with Fire Type Immunity. It's useful either when intercepting for someone who is weak to Fire, or when you're caught in an Area of Effect of an Ally's Fire Attack for a boost. While it had some cases, Pokemon that tended to be resistant to Fire already such as Magmar would never be targeted by Fire on their own and even if they Intercepted, they'd already be resistant to it. PTU classes like Occultism Researcher may have gained Damage Resistance to Special Psychic, Ghost and Dark Attacks, but if an Enemy doesn't have any, or has physical attacks of those types, it basically is useless.

The solution when making abilities is to either make it generic enough to be able to be relevant in most situations, able to be set up with help of allies, or able to be enabled through the user's actions. Abilities should tend to be proactive and not reactive, as if they're reactive, they're entirely dependent on if the Enemy walks into your trap. If you do decide to make an Ability niche such as in flavor, add a few more effects to make it more worthwhile.

Example - Flying Fly Trap make it immune to Bug and Ground Type Attacks. As a Grass Type, being Immune to bug is good but it is reactive. But they also have their Melee Attacks one step more effective against bugs, which is another small bonus and matches the fluff of Carnivine being a Fly Trap. This bonus is given because the reactive effect isn't as common in most encounters.

Example - Water Weapons [Greninja]

At-Will - Swift Action

Effect: Choose a Weapon. Depending on the Weapon chosen, the User's Water Type Damaging Attacks may be treated as the listed Range. The User can only be affected by one Weapon at a time.

» Shuriken- 8, Ranged Blast 2.

» Kunai- Melee, Smite.

» Katana- Melee, Pass.

Bonus: The User may use Water Type Damaging Attacks as if they were Physical or Special Category.

CUSTOM ATTACKS

In order to make a balanced ability, it needs to be relatively equal to others around its level. When making a custom Attack, determine what Level it will be granted and refer to those tips.

Levels 15 and Under

Attacks granted at Level 15 and Under should be Tier 1 of strength value. This likely means something that is DB 7 or less, has an At-Will or EOT Frequency and a small effect. Status Attacks of this range should likely inflict one Status Affliction or adjust Combat Stages by around 2 CS. Area of Effect Attacks of this Tier should be around Line 4 or a Blast 2 size, if any. Examples of Attacks of this Tier Level would be Psybeam, Will-O-Wisp or Swords Dance.

Levels 20 through 40

Attacks granted at Level 20 through 40 should be Tier 2 of strength value. This likely means something that is around 6 - 9 DB, has an EOT or Scene x2 Frequency and a decent effect. Status Attacks of this range should likely be more impactful and affect multiple enemies or allies rather than being single Target. Area of Effect Attacks of this Range could be around Burst 1, Ranged Blast 2 and Line 6, but more common than Tier 1. Examples of Attacks of this Tier Level would be Rock Slide, Synthesis or Light Screen.

Level 40 or Above

Attacks granted at Level 40 or higher should be Tier 3 of strength value. This likely means something that is at least DB 8 or higher, has a Scene x2 or Scene Frequency and either high power or a strong effect. Status Attacks of this range should be very impactful, have guaranteed effects even if they miss or be multi target. Area of Effect Attacks of this Range could be around Burst 2, Blast 3 or Line 8 and more common based on the Frequency. Examples of Attacks of this Tier Level would be Overheat, Pixie Dust or Giga Impact.

Adjusting Power Levels

If you find that a Player thinks an Attack isn't worthwhile or its output is too strong perhaps, custom content you make doesn't have to be set in stone! You can absolutely adjust the power level until it reaches a healthy spot. Refer to the following options on how to Buff or Nerf an Attack (Or Ability sometimes)

Nerf Options: Decrease the Damage Base, weaken the Effect. Remove a Keyword. Increase the AC. Remove Range Keywords or shorten the Range. Decrease versatility. Increase the Frequency for fewer usages.

Buff Options: Increase the Damage Base. Improve the Effect. Add a Keyword. Decrease the AC. Improve the Range or add Range Keywords. Grant more versatility. Decrease the Frequency for more usages.



Facilitating Downtime

The Downtime Phase section has a lot of details listing out what is possible and what your players can do whenever they're not in combat and have time to kill in character. Though the scope of downtime actions may seem daunting to some, being able to do anything and you're not sure what you can do and how you can accomplish your goals. **In this section we'll go over some examples of how you can use the Downtime system to give your Players goals and projects they can work on over the course of a Campaign.**

At some point during your Campaign you should go through each Player and figure out answers to the following questions to get ideas on what Projects they could want.

1. What do your Players do in their Free Time?

Does your Character cook in their downtime? They could spend the campaign creating custom recipes that buff their allies after gathering ingredients from the areas they visit! Are they a loner and stay in the library? Maybe they could discover some books and studying them could grant them skills and bonuses or information that could give them an edge in social situations! Characters will always want to pursue goals that align with what their characters would do, so grant them mechanical incentives and projects that are unique to them!

2. How do your Players contribute to Combat?

What they do in their downtime could also tie to how they perform in combat. Absolutely no player will say no to custom content that expands what their classes can do so try to think of what kind of projects they can do that are tied to what they do in battle! If they're a Hex Maniac, it could be researching custom curses. If they're a Sage, they could be learning about protective rituals. If they're a Commander, they could be training with a Pokemon one on one to teach them a special technique for a custom [Order]. If they're a Chronicler, maybe they can study books that grant them Studied against that Target in battle!

3. What are your Player's Goals?

Knowing what your Player's goals are can allow them to gain progress towards them without you having to shoehorn it into the narrative or make combat relevant around it. Projects they could be given could be relevant to their goals and they will be more than happy to spend time on it. If they're an occult researcher figuring out the secrets of a runic artifact, perhaps they have a few projects on studying unown glyphs as a language or asking around a village for anyone knowledgeable. If a Player wants to become a Fire Type Gym Leader, perhaps they spend their time searching around their camp site for any habitats that Fire Pokemon would be in or researching a bait for Fire Types.

Example - My Hex Maniac Player has a rival in a coven who is a more sinister warlock. They have come across an NPC who has been cursed with the Bane of Silence. One of their sidequests is to research a way to counter this curse and cure them. This is a relatively difficult project and requires the feathers of a chatot, some goomy sludge and various occult artifacts. They discovered the recipe for a cure after a TN 50 Research Project



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Once you have a few answers for the questions listed above and what they could do for some projects, then follow the next string of questions each time a Downtime Phase occurs.

1. What does the Character want to do?

When a Downtime Phase occurs, simply ask your Players what they want to do. It's your job as the GM to facilitate this period and guide them in narrative play. If they don't have ideas, suggest some that would be local! Go to your prior research from the questions before this and suggest what they'd want to do in character if they had your knowledge of the area. For example, a Player could not know that there is a researcher dedicated to the study of Giratina nearby and that they may want to ask them some questions.

2. How easy would it be to perform this goal?

So your Players have told you what they want to do. Now determine how easy it would be to accomplish this task. Some tasks can simply take an action and not be too complicated. Finding a Magnemite in a city might just be a Simple CR (1) Pokemon Education Check. Other Projects may need to take a lot of time in order to achieve, which are what Long Term Projects are for. If this is the case, determine the difficulty of the task which sets its TN.

3. What do they need in order to achieve this goal?

Long Term Projects shouldn't just be invested time, it should also tie back into the main campaign, shaping their actions in order to achieve their other projects. When deciding if a Downtime Action is possible, determine what they'd need in order to achieve it. If a Training Specialist is trying to teach their Charizard a spin attack that makes Flamethrower a Burst 2, perhaps they just need to spend time training with it as a TN 50 Project. Maybe if you want to tie it into gameplay as well, a limitation will also be set that they need to perform a Tough CR (3) Command Check in a battle when using Flamethrower. When succeeded they'll perform the Attack but only in a Burst 1, as they're learning. If they're a chef and want to make a dish that can grant Darkvision to an ally, they'll likely need to spend a lot of time procuring ingredients including a rare mushroom that grows in a dark wood! Make sure to limit their progress until they fulfill these conditions.

4. Are there any complications to this goal?

Not all goals are equal. Some Players may want to overthrow the government and some may just want to knit their buneary a sweater. (You'll be surprised how happy a player may be if they make a sweater for their Pokemon that gives a +1 bonus to charm). Whenever you decide what it'll take to perform a Downtime Action, think of what complications may come in the way, as some tasks are so gargantuan they may be impossible to do in less than 10 Sessions! For the second player, they may need to just find a place that sells wool or yarn to knit the sweater. But for the first player, they may need to take a bunch of steps such as convincing people on a local level, growing a cult following and sabotaging the government in multiple ways without getting caught before they confront them. Tasks can also be impossible until they reach a certain point or reach a certain milestone. If an Occult Researcher wants to study an artifact they found, it may be so obscure that local libraries don't have any info on it but a scientist in Canalave conveniently does as they hear by rumor.

5. What are the mechanical benefits of this goal?

Actions they perform in the downtime phase should always have some sort of benefit that makes it worthwhile to pursue. This could be narrative information, gaining some sort of tactical advantage, or improving their mechanical build and advancing their character. Some examples could be a researcher studying how to hack a digital lock and after a TN 50 Project, they can replace their Tech Edu with their General Edu when hacking digital locks specifically. Another could be that a Player wants to stalk their rival before a contest to see how she prepares so that they can counter them on the day of the contest.

NPC Mentorships

Do you have a veteran or wise NPC that is skilled in something the Players wish to learn about? You may want them to pursue a Mentorship as a Long Term Downtime Research Project! This may also be refluffed as anything, provided the intention is to slowly improve something over time.

In order to learn from the mentor they may need to meet a prerequisite, for example, studying Aura Skills may involve having the Aura Reader Capability and not anyone can learn it.

Each Topic a Mentor can teach will have maximum of 8 Advancement Effects that are gained whenever a Player reaches a milestone on the project. However a Player cannot exceed a TN more than 20x their Trainer Level. **For this Example, if a Player is Level 2, they can only research up to TN 40** and needs to level up to learn Milestones that are further down.

Below is an example of two Topics that Sabrina the Psychic Gym Leader could teach Players. She is a master of Teleportation and knows some of Telepathy. The Skill needed for this Project is Occult Education or Focus.

Topic - Teleportation	
Prerequisite: You have the Teleporter Capability	
Milestone TN	Advancement Effect
30	Your Movement Value is increased by +2 when using the Teleporter Capability.
50	When using the Teleporter Capability, you can Target 1 Willing Adjacent Creature and they appear in a Space Adjacent to your destination.
70	You can activate the Teleporter Capability as a Movement Action instead of a Swift + Movement Action.
100	When using the Teleporter Capability you can Target a non-Large+ Adjacent unwilling Creature and perform an opposed Focus Check. If you win, they appear in a Space Adjacent to your destination.
150	You can activate the Teleporter Capability even if you have a Mental Affliction.
200	The Teleport Attack can be used as a Reaction instead of a Standard + Reaction.
250	When Teleporting Adjacent Willing Creatures, you may Target any number of them instead of just one.
300	When Teleporting an Unwilling Creature, they can be Large+ but you have a Bane to the Opposed check.

Topic - Telepathy	
Prerequisite: You have the Telepath Capability	
Milestone TN	Advancement Effect
30	When using the Telepath Capability, you may project your thoughts to any number of minds within range, not just one.
50	It costs 1 less SP to read deeper thoughts through the Telepath Capability.
70	You may use the Telepath Capability on anyone you can see, ignoring the 10m Range.
100	Whenever you attempt to read deeper thoughts through the Telepath Capability, the required CR is reduced by -1.



Shops & NPC Services

While embarking on a Journey, your players should be able to come across NPCs that have specific skills that could help the party! In addition, the Players could also have a headquarters or base of operations, in which they can talk to any of these NPCs or gain access to something that could provide one of these services. Whenever you make an NPC that could be an artisan or provide a service of sorts, [view this section for a suggestion of their wares and possible services](#).

When creating an NPC, determine their Tier levels of expertise for each service or good they provide listed below. This could impact what they may be able to offer. Rare Services listed below can sometimes be provided by Journeyman and can definitely be provided by Masters.

Example - My Chef requires a darkbloom root in order to craft a dish that grants temporary darkvision to their Pokemon before they go diving into a cave. They come across an NPC that is a Journeyman Level Botanist. This NPC has knowledge of basic flora and sells them as well. Considering they're near a cave, it's also a local commodity!

» **Apprentice Level** is for NPCs that are new to the skill and likely only know the basics and can only offer simple goods and services. NPCs that don't have access to a supply chain and only hand goods on hand likely fall under this category.

» **Journeyman Level** is the tier level for those who are experienced but not yet considered expert level, the professionals so to speak, likely having 5-10 Years in the service. They likely are the people you'd find in a town with a well run shop, the small business type with access to all the essentials.

» **Master Level** is the highest class of experts and likely renown in the field or have access to lots of resources. These are likely people with 10+ years of experience and even have access to rare materials or know services that most in the industry wouldn't know or aren't skilled enough to perform. Master Level NPCs are usually rare to find, few and far between and have expensive costs.

Academic

Services: Specialty in an Education Category. Assistance in research or innovation in their specialty. Provides info on their Edu Specialty. Provides resources common to their field of specialty

Rare Services: Can assist in more difficult research or innovation projects. Provides info on lesser known subjects of their Edu Specialty. Can acquire or has info on rare resources based on their field of specialty

Rare Example - A Scientist helps with a rare cloning project to duplicate Mew.

Alchemist

Services: Sells Basic and Greater Potions. Identifies substances and their chemical properties. Sells alchemical and medicinal supplies.

Rare Services: Can brew more unique potions. Can craft potions based on specific needs. Can assist with unique alchemical projects.

Rare Example - An Alchemist provides a water breathing potion that gives the Gilled Capability temporarily so they can explore an underwater ruin.

Archivist

Services: Access to literature and information about nearly any topic. Has a vast well of knowledge. Can provide information about local or nearby topics. Sale of simple books.

Rare Services: Access to literature and information of obscure or forbidden topics. Possible ability to transcribe or interpret rare languages or texts. Possibly knows where to get information about anything.

Rare Example - An Archivist helps translate a tablet with Unown Glyphs

Athlete

Services: Can offer training or boons to Trainers, enhancing physical abilities.

Rare Services: Can offer training and information into special martial arts, allowing retrains and learning new Combat Classes in character.

Rare Example - A Martial Artist helps train an Aura Guardian on how to become a Monk

Blacksmith

Services: Crafting and repairing basic weapons and equipment. Familiarity with metalwork and general crafting.

Rare Services: Ability to create custom weaponry and equipment. Ability to create high quality weapons and equipment. Ability to use rare materials in production of equipment.

Rare Example - A Blacksmith helps create a Gravity Sword using a meteorite fragment

Botanist

Services: Identification and knowledge of basic flora. Sale of basic flora items that could serve as ingredients. Sale of herbal remedies.

Rare Services: Sale of mythical and rare flora items. Identification and knowledge of rare flora.

Rare Example - A Botanist creates a special garden to cultivate Gracidea Flowers for Shaymin

Cartographer

Services: Can assist in navigation depending on their specialty, such as through the forest, over seas, in the sky, etc. Can assist in navigation and directions based on their knowledge like directions to a city.

Rare Services: Knowledge of secretive and lesser known areas. Safer navigation to areas that are more hostile or risky such as over rapid seas.

Rare Example - A Sailor provides info on a secret Mirage Island and will help the party travel for a fee.

Chef

Services: Provides basic food and rations. Sale of simple meals for temporary boosts to either skills or combat.

Rare Services: Sale of exotic meals that can provide more unique temporary boons.

Rare Example - A Chef takes shedded Druddigon Scales and makes it into a meal that provides +2 Default Attack CS until the next Downtime Phase.

Disciple

Services: Has a wealth of knowledge about their faith or Legendary they serve. Can provide minor blessings based on their faith. Has general legendary knowledge.

Rare Services: Has a deeper knowledge about their faith or Legend. Can provide more powerful blessings based on their faith or legend. Can perform Rituals associated with their faith or legend

Rare Example - A Disciple of Giratina can help perform a ritual to send the Player's to the Reverse Dimension.

Enchanter

Services: Can infuse Items with special properties that make them artifacts. Can provide temporary blessing or cursed enchantments on items.

Rare Services: Can create custom enchantments that improve equipment. Can provide permanent blessings or cursed enchantments on items.

Rare Example - An Enchanter blesses a Player's Cloak and grants it the ability to give them the Blender Capability.

Fashionista

Services: Sells fashion equipment items. Can provide custom fashion items curated to the wearer.

Rare Services: Sale of higher quality fashion equipment items. Can infuse special and rare material into fashion items.

Rare Example - A Fashionista uses Zoroark fur to create a coat of illusions, allowing the Player to gain the Illusionist capability while worn.

Healthcare Specialist

Services: Can restore health and injuries on harmed Pokemon and Trainers. Can treat minor injuries. Can diagnose most ailments.

Rare Services: Can treat major injuries. Can perform surgical procedures. Can offer guidance on unique and rare ailments and possible cures.

Rare Example - A Player goes to a Doctor to help repair the wings of their cutiefly.

Inventor

Services: Each Inventor has an Edu specialty which they make and sell inventions in. Sale of unique inventions and items based on their specialty. Assistance in projects involving their specialty.

Rare Services: Developing and assisting in complex projects that involve their specialty. Sale of one of a kind inventions based on their specialty or custom inventions.

Rare Example - An Innovator that specializes in gadgets creates a set of jet pack boots that allows a character to fly.

Mercenary

Services: Provides any kind of manual work or combat assistance for exchange of money. Provides bounty hunting services and item retrieval services.

Rare Services: Provides any kind of manual work or combat assistance with a higher success rate. Will engage with riskier quests.

Rare Example - A Mercenary is hired by the players to assist them on a mission to fight Moltres.

Merchant

Services: Sells a specific category of items based on their specialty and common goods. Provides information in procuring items or has a network with other merchants. Can sell items for a Player for a cut.

Rare Services: Sells or procures rare or exotic items.

Rare Example - A Merchant is given a rare pearl to sell. They sell it for 5,000 and take 1,000 as a cut for finding a buyer.

Mystic

Services: Can offer training or boons to Trainers, enhancing mental abilities. Can offer services based on their occult specialty such as divination or witchcraft

Rare Services: Can offer training and information into special mental arts, allowing retrains and learning new Supernatural Combat Classes in character.

Rare Example - An Aura Guardian helps train an Monk to become Trained in the art of Aura.

Paleontologist

Services: Sells Fossils and basic Gems such as Shards. Specialized in minerals and fossil knowledge and prehistoric Pokemon.

Rare Services: Sale of Rare Fossils and Rare Gems. Can alter Fossil biology in experimentation.

Rare Example - A Paleontologist can manipulate an Aerodactyl to have wings of flame and be Fire/Flying Type.

Pokemon Caretaker

Services: Sells Pokemon Eggs. Can breed Pokemon to create Eggs. Basic Mentoring Skills to grant Attacks to Pokemon. Knowledge of Pokemon Species beyond the Pokedex.

Rare Services: Sells rare Pokemon Eggs. Can cross breed Pokemon for unique results. Can provide personalized training for difficult Pokemon.

Rare Example - A Pokemon Caretaker gives a rare Gible Egg that was bred on the beach, being a Water/Dragon Type.

Pokemon Hunter

Services: Sells common Pokemon. Can find and capture any common Pokemon. Provides habitat information on Pokemon.

Rare Services: Sells rare Pokemon. Can find and capture any rare Pokemon. Possible expertise in hunting mythological Pokemon.

Rare Example - A Pokemon Hunter is given money in exchange for finding a Tepig den nearby that the Trainers can go to.

Pokemon Trainer

Services: Can train Pokemon Levels. Can teach Pokemon Tutor Attacks. Can possibly trade their Pokemon.

Rare Services: Can create and teach custom Attacks for Pokemon.

Rare Example - A Pokemon Trainer helps train a Player's pichu while they take a gym challenge.

Socialite

Services: Grants Players access to their social network and others who can provide skills they may need.

Rare Services: Grant Players access to other craftsmen who may be more difficult to deal with without an inside connection

Rare Example - A Socialite influences the bouncer of a night club to let the Players in without being on the list of VIPs.



Common GM Pitfalls

As a GM, it's essential to create a fun and engaging experience for all players. However, several common pitfalls can disrupt the game and hinder player enjoyment, or even risk a good campaign collapsing out of nowhere. Awareness and proactive management of these issues can help keep a Campaign healthy and keep players happy. Listed below are some of the common issues that could plague a game:

GM PITFALLS

Railroading

Railroading occurs when the GM forces players down a predetermined path, limiting their choices and agency. This can make players feel like their decisions don't matter and can lead to frustration. To avoid railroading, be flexible with your story and allow players to explore their own solutions to problems. Adapt your plot to incorporate player choices and actions.

Over Preparing

Overpreparing can lead to rigidity and frustration when players deviate from the planned script. While it's good to be prepared, try to avoid detailed plans for every possible scenario. Instead, focus on key plot points and be ready to improvise. Flexibility allows you to adapt to unexpected player actions and maintain the flow of the game. This will also prevent burnout from needing to dedicate hours a week in preparing the setting, npcs, encounters, etc.

Pacing Issues

Poor pacing can lead to boredom or overwhelm your Players. Be mindful of the game's tempo, balancing action, and downtime. If the game is dragging, introduce new elements or challenges to re-engage players. Conversely, if things are moving too quickly, allow time for character development and exploration. There's a reason why many TV Shows and Anime have "Filler Episodes", as it's a perfect chance to develop characters in a low-stakes environment to alleviate the tension.

Player vs GM Mentality

A Player vs GM mentality fosters an adversarial relationship between the GM and the players. This approach can create tension and reduce the collaborative spirit of the game. Remember that the goal is to create a fun and engaging story together. Focus on facilitating an enjoyable experience rather than trying to outwit or challenge the players at every turn. Your goal as a GM isn't to win and beat player builds, but to enable a collective experience with your Players.

Overusing Deus Ex Machinas

While they can be helpful in dire needs such as the region champion saving the day to be an impactful first impression, don't have the party or npcs saved multiple times by forces that are stronger than the party. Doing so will reduce the players' agency and ability to influence the campaign they're in.

Having a Static World

Having a Static world that doesn't react to the players can make them feel like they have no agency and their choices do not matter. This can lead to them not caring about your world and not wanting to contribute to their world's improvement. Conversely, it can also encourage them to make selfish decisions that benefit their party at the cost of the wellbeing of the world around them. When your Players make actions, always think of how this affects the world around them and how it can change as a result. If they went into the mines and defeated a King Crobat, maybe the disturbance causes a swarm of zubats to be hyperactive as they lose their king. The disturbance leads to days of being unable to enter the mines and having the local economy disrupted as miners have their daily lives impeded by the Players' actions. When factoring in how it affects the world, make sure the results are equally positive and negative, as if too many negative occurrences happen, it'll discourage them from engaging as well.

SOCIAL PITFALLS

Player Exclusion

Excluding players, either intentionally or unintentionally, can lead to disengagement and dissatisfaction. Ensure that all players have opportunities to participate and contribute to the game. Balance spotlight time among players, and be mindful of including quieter or less assertive players in the narrative and decision-making processes. When distributing rewards or highlighting a Character's Backstory, make sure you create opportunities for other players as well.

Player Favoritism

Showing favoritism towards certain players can create resentment and imbalance in the game. Ensure that all players have equal opportunities to shine and contribute. Avoid giving preferential treatment to specific players, whether through more powerful items, more narrative focus, leniency with rules or allowing them to solve too many problems and act as the "Main Character".

Disregarding Player Feedback

Ignoring player feedback can lead to them feeling as though they're ignored and their fun doesn't matter. Regularly check in with your players to see how they feel about the game and be open to making adjustments based on their input. A game that evolves with player feedback is more likely to be enjoyable for everyone involved.

Problem Players

Problem players can disrupt the game and create tension among the group. Address issues such as disruptive behavior, rule-breaking, or conflicts with other players swiftly. Set clear expectations and boundaries for behavior, and if necessary, have a private conversation to resolve the issue. If conflicts cannot be resolved or the Player is constantly causing issues, do not hesitate to remove them from the game for the sake of everyone else's enjoyment, as the alternative is almost always the Campaign burning out and the focus being more on avoiding drama rather than the plot at hand.

Mismatched Party Goals

As a GM if you allow for mismatched Party Goals and your entire party isn't on board with the same goal, it will lead to segmented gameplay or player vs player conflict. A very frequent example in PTU was Parties that were interested in both Gyms and Contests, half of the Party liking contest and not caring for gyms while the reverse occurred for the other half. Having conflicting goals means that in order to cater to one side, the other side will have to slog through sessions where they have no interest and be essentially sidelined. Or even worse, if Players aren't aligned with the end goal of a plot, it could lead to conflict at the table. For example, if you're running a Team Rocket Campaign and one of the Players wants to take down the team from within while the other Party members are on board, it will lead to chaos later down the road. While sometimes this drama can be played maturely, this is a small percentage.

Player vs Player Conflict

Don't let PvP happen without express consent from the entire Party that it will be a theme in the campaign. Many times people are okay with PvP themes, only to later be annoyed when they lose and it leads to conflicts at the table. Unless your table is extremely mature, people tend to not like losing and more often than not will resent the Player they lost to. Additionally, those who are experienced with the System will always have an upper hand when fighting other Players who aren't knowledgeable.

GAMEPLAY PITFALLS

Rule Lawyering

Rule lawyering involves players or the GM excessively focusing on the rules at the expense of the story and fun. While it's important to have a consistent and fair application of rules, don't let them overshadow the enjoyment of the game. If you feel that a certain rule should be ignored so that a dramatic event can occur or the scene can be more fun, please do so. This is your campaign after all and most rules are just guidelines in order to play in a structured format.

Power Creep

Rewards are fun to give out! Just be aware that whenever you give out a custom reward, everything before that item is now obsolete as they replace their equipment with the new shiny thing. In order to gain the same level of excitement, some GMs tend to just make the new thing slightly more valuable in order for it to not be ignored because it's not as good as what they have. In order to mitigate, try giving out some rewards that don't have power attached to them or incrementally give out power when the Campaign is getting to higher levels and is more difficult.

Unbalanced Encounters

Encounters that are too one sided in either direction lead to the session not being fun, either from a lack of challenge or impossible odds. Remember the golden rule of Action Economy being king and whichever side has more Actions tends to be in favor of winning. When designing encounters as well, make sure all Encounters have a solution when you think through what your Players can do. If they only have grass Pokemon, maybe a pure Fire Type Encounter will be annoying for them due to lack of options.

Poor Resource Distribution

Make sure your Players have ample resources or access to resources at all times unless attrition is a major theme in your Campaign. If your Players want something, the answer should be twofold. One answer could be "Okay, here are the steps you need to take to achieve this goal". Another answer could be "That something is something that will need a few steps to earn or is impossible in your current state in the Campaign, but could be possible later". If something they ask for is impossible, tell them upfront. Also factor in that some classes need resources in order to function, especially if they use items. When factoring this in, be sure to give them enough Downtime to mechanically contribute to fights or have enough money to function.



1v1 Combat

Never have a Scene consist of one Combatant vs one Enemy. This is not the video games. PTE is built on the foundation of **group play** and some Classes can only perform when they have an ally to Target or intercept for. They are designed with the idea that multiple Players can fulfill multiple roles and work in conjunction to fight together. Additionally, many strategies are outright toxic if the singular enemy doesn't have a solution.

Example: A Player that is invested as a Tank with the Defender and Sentinel class can only sit there and take damage if it was simply them vs an Enemy. However, in a team environment, their contribution is defending the damage dealers and supports that can defeat their enemies. A Pokemon with the Companion Role cannot use it without an ally to target.

If you or your GM are ever in a situation where they would suggest 1v1 Combat or it would be the norm, look at the list below. **Here are some common situations where 1v1's normally occurs.** See this as your time to start an intervention before a mistake is made.

1. Is your Campaign for one Player?

Solo Campaigns are entirely valid! If the Campaign is just a Trainer acting alongside their Pokemon it may even be fine since it's technically 2 Combatants vs whoever, but it isn't the best solution. If you're GMing for one Player, I'd suggest adding NPC Companions to your Player's Party that journey alongside them and bolster the party's numbers. After all, wider class representation and more allies means more enjoyable gameplay and more weaknesses being covered. This way the single player can get the gameplay of a full party. Though be careful of making classic DMPCs that get more screen time than the actual player.

2. Is Trainer Combat disallowed?

It is entirely rational for some GMs to disallow Trainers fighting alongside their Pokemon but if they do so, ensure most Combat Classes are banned if they're not allowed to be used. All classes however have actions and options they can perform in combat however, so Trainers should still get a Turn in these scenarios, not making it a 1v1. However an alternate option is allowing Players to command 2 Pokemon at once, allowing Double Battles to be the norm, or alternatively allowing everyone to gain the Focused Commander Feature for free. If the Path of the Mundane Module is out, look into that as well.

3. Are you doing a Tournament?

If you're in a tournament, try to disallow 1v1 battles. Instead you could do tag team tournaments which could be just as interesting, pairing with a partner and developing strategies between your teams. If a Party consists of 4 Players, it could be two Players making two separate teams to compete. Alternatively they could each tag with an NPC or the entire Party could battle together. If you insist on having one participant face the other, revert to other suggestions like having the Trainer actively fight alongside them or battle with multiple Pokemon on the field.

4. Are you in a Gym?

Again, the generic solutions will help such as Trainers fighting alongside Pokemon, however most importantly, do not make your Gyms one Player vs the Gym leader at a time. The entire Party should attempt a Gym challenge all at once so nobody is sitting on the sidelines twiddling their thumbs and to save time. (Do not allow your Players to convince you they're fine with this) How does the entire Party face a Gym? Well if the Gym consists of a standard battle, do one of the following. Firstly, the Gym leader could command multiple Pokemon at once, such as throwing three Pokemon on the field and fighting alongside them against two other Players in the Party. Secondly, the Gym could command Pokemon that aren't party of their Party to pad the numbers in the encounter. This could be something like Misty commanding her Starmie but in the gym, there are multiple goldeen swimming around trying to attack the players. And Lastly, the Gym Leader could fight alongside Gym Trainers who have their own teams, you know, all the Trainers you beat before you face the leader.

Narrative Mechanic Disclaimer

When creating the Rule Book, I had to grapple with idea that everything in there would be a hard rule of the system and ideally should be the rules everyone goes by. The issue with Narrative Mechanics however, is that every GM tends to have hard opinions on how to run their game and how to progress the narrative. Some may enjoy gritty mechanics like Favor Points while others would find it too tedious and think it gamifies relationships. Some tables may love the Invoke Mechanic and some may never use it at all and see it as bloat. Some players may enjoy the more formulaic nature of Social Encounter Rules and some may just want to walk up to a totodile and roll for charm to convince them to do crime together. No opinion is wrong.

So essentially, PTE is a system with rules for combat. This isn't a narrative system but rules in this Chapter can be used if need be. Otherwise you can slot in any of your preferred style of play or however you run.

However, I still want to include some ideas on how you can implement Narrative Rules that could work in a PTE setting, especially when factoring in new GMs that may not know how to handle traveling from city to city. As such, I've moved all Narrative Rules into the GM Guide to serve as a rubric on how you could run non-combat gameplay, but not be baked into the system that you're forced to use it.

Basically, you don't need to use any mechanics in Chapter 4, **only use the ones that you as a GM like and your Players are fine with.**



Social Encounters

Similarly to battling, Pokemon and Trainers can also initiate in Social Encounters.

Unlike normal battles, **Social Encounter occurs whenever a Character opposes the goals of a Player.** This can be any opposition regardless of how dramatic it would be. Social Encounter would occur if a Chimchar doesn't want to be captured by a Player or it could occur if the Players are trying to defuse a Rampaging Nidoking from attacking them. **Basically, the goal of Social Encounter is to attempt to resolve the opposing Enemies without violence.** Whenever Social Encounter would occur, follow the phases below:

Phase 1 - Setting the Scene

1. Determine the Willpower of all opposing Enemies

The Willpower Value of an Enemy is determined by how **strong their conviction is against the Party's Goal.** If the conviction is low, their **Willpower Value is 1.** If the conviction is average, the **Willpower is 3.** If the conviction is high, the **Willpower is 5.** To determine how strong their conviction is, review their Character Aspects and see how many align with their decision to oppose.

When the Willpower Value is lowered to 0, they'll change their opinions and side with the Players they opposed or allow their actions to go unchallenged.

2. Determine the Patience of all opposing Enemies

The Patience Value of an Enemy is determined by **how long they're willing to wait before acting on their Instincts.** If the Patience is low, it is a **value of 1.** If it is average, **it is a value of 2.** If it is high, **it is a value of 3.** Each time the Player's Actions don't result in their Willpower lowering, their Patience is lowered by a value of the GM's choice.

When the Patience Value is lowered to 0, the Social Encounter will be ended with the Enemy either being unable to be convinced or escalating the scene by carrying out their Instinct.

Basically, Patience is the number of tries your Party has to change their mind and serves as a clock to failure.

Phase 2 - Resolve the Scene

1. Have your Players Observe the Scene

At the start of the Scene, each of your Players may observe the scene in some way. This will usually be in the form of a question that the GM has to answer, although some may require a Skill Check to gain info for. These actions are a method for the Players to learn the opposing Enemy's Character Aspects and learn ways in which they can succeed in Social Encounter.

2. Choose a Player to Act

After Step 1, the Players choose one Trainer or Pokemon on their side to attempt to lower their **Willpower** in some way. Depending on how the Enemy is opposing their goals, this action can range from attempting to feed a hungry pokemon, attempting to intimidate a guard or commanding a Pokemon to stand down.

3. Determine how the Actions resolve

If the GM determines this Action is enough to convince them, they will lose an amount of **Willpower** depending on how much it impacted them. If the Enemy isn't immediately convinced or there's a chance of failure, there will need to be a Skill Check in order to determine if its **Willpower** was lowered. If it fails, their **Patience** is instead lowered by an amount of how much it displeases them, possibly even making future actions riskier.

4. Repeat Steps 1-3

The Social Encounter will then repeat Steps 1-3 until either the **Willpower** or **Patience** is lowered to 0.

Phase 3 - Determine the Results

Depending on which value was lowered to 0 first determines the results of the Social Encounter. If the **Willpower** was lowered to 0, the Enemy either no longer opposes them or aligns with their goals and is convinced. If the **Patience** was lowered to 0, the Enemy either escalates the Scene or is unwilling to be convinced to change its stance in the conflict.

Social Encounter Examples

Example (Capturing a Pokemon)

The Party comes across a group of loud and chirping spearow in a nest. They seem unwilling to be captured and get a combative stance as the party approaches.

Phase 1 begins and the **Willpower** of the Spearow is **3** while their **Patience** is **1**. Phase 2 begins and the two players try to analyze the scene, one watching its body language. With a successful Intuition Check they realize the Spearows seem kind of skittish and defensive, likely not used to humans. The other trainer will try to look in their nest from a distance to see if there's anything of note, which they'll notice with a Perception Check that there is no food in the nest. The two Trainers assume the Sparrow is hungry and decide to attempt to feed it by approaching slowly with a sandwich.

The GM determines that the degree of this success will be determined by a Stealth Check to see how slow they approach. With a successful Stealth Check they're able to lower the **Willpower** by **2** as they greedily take the food and eat it, resulting in 1 left. Next round of actions begin as they observe the reaction of the Spearow and they're told it seems to be slightly distrustful but more willingly to listen to them.

Their next Action will be the second Trainer lying and saying "We have a bunch more food at our camp if you want to join us", which will be an opposed Guile vs Intuition Check. The Sparrow have no reason to doubt them so it's an easy check with a Simple CR (1). After succeeding, their **Willpower** is now at 0 and the scene resolves with the Spearow willingly being captured!

Example (Drastic Defusing of a Social Encounter)

The Party has confronted a Tauros that is bullying a small Pidgey. They tell the Tauros to stop attacking it, to which the Tauros confronts them, as it still wants to attack the pidgey.

Phase 1 begins and the **Willpower** of Tauros is **5** while their **Patience** is **1**. The Party starts by observing the Tauros, after a Pokemon Edu Check they realize most Tauros are very standoffish but respect strength. They also discover that the Tauros is seemingly confident in its stature, enjoying bullying smaller Pokemon. They get an idea and they decide to act by sending out their Tyranitar and having it Intimidate the Tauros into standing down.

While its willpower is high, the threat of a massive Tyranitar and an Intimidate result of 26 immediately results in its **Willpower** dropping to **0** in one action, scared to death of the Tauros. Despite being very hostile and strong in its willpower, the action taken was so drastic that there is zero reason why it would still be motivated to go against the players and still attack the pidgey.

Remember, depending on your Player's actions, you can adjust the Willpower and Patience accordingly on what makes sense, not needing to solely rely on Social Skill Checks.



Bonds

Over the course of your Journey, you will meet many Pokemon and NPCs along the way! Each time you meet someone notable or capture a Pokemon, you create a Bond with them, noted by a **Bond Rank** (The GM will inform you of your starting Favor). If the character has disdain towards you beyond just disliking you, you cannot form a Bond with them.

Bond Rank	Die Size	Favor Point Threshold
Disliked	d4	-5 Favor Points
Neutral	d6	0 Favor Points
Liked	d8	10 Favor Points
Trusted	d10	20 Favor Points
Cherished	d12	50 Favor Points

Bonds between Player Characters don't gain Favor Points, instead being agreed upon by the GM and both Players what their current Bond is narratively.

Bond Checks

Whenever you Invoke a Bond or at your GM's Discretion, they may make you perform a **Bond Check**. To perform a Bond Check, the GM will determine what the **Target Number** is, depending on the difficulty of the test or the impact of your request. You will then roll the dice, determined by your Bond Rank with that character.

A **Simple TN** will be **4**, **Moderate TN** will be **6**, **Major TN** will be **8** and an **Extraordinary TN** will be **10**.

Important Note

Bond Checks should only be performed for impactful requests. If there is no reason for the Bond to reject them, don't perform a Bond Check. Conversely, if there's no way a Bond would perform the request, it can't be Invoked. Asking a friendly NPC to give you directions to the nearest Pokemon center isn't meaningful. Invoking their bond and asking them to gather mushrooms for you is. Commanding your Pokemon in battle isn't meaningful. If they have a disliked bond with you, it does become meaningful.

If you meet the TN, they will be loyal to you or they will honor your request, possibly anticipating something in return. If you beat the TN by at least 4, they will be exceedingly loyal or honor the request with no strings attached or at some benefit to the player. If you fail a TN by at most 2, they'll be loyal or honor the request but with some strings attached or with some penalty applied. If you fail by more than 2, they either will be unwilling to honor the request, be disloyal, or be unable to honor the request.

Whenever you perform a Bond Check, you may also attempt to sway them with a Skill Check of some sort, with the TN depending on how you do so. On a success, add +2 to your Bond Check, but on a Failure, add a -2 penalty to it.

Example (Disobedience): A Pikachu doesn't like their trainer that much and is at a Disliked Rank. They use them in battle and tell them to use thundershock on a nearby Spearow. They additionally try to sway them with a Command Check and a TN of 10, which they pass. They roll a d4 for their Bond Rank. The TN for the action is deemed to be 4.

> [If they rolled a 1], the result is 3 from the +2 Sway Skill Check. The Pikachu attacks the Spearow but uses a Thunder Wave instead.

> [If they rolled a 3], the result is 5 from the +2 Sway Skill Check. The Pikachu agrees and uses thundershock on the Spearow.

Pushing a Bond

Whenever you fail a non-disliked Bond, you may attempt to push it in order to reroll the Bond Check. In order to do so, you need to give the Bond a reason to reconsider. If they agree, reroll the Bond Check. However, on a Failure, they'll lose up to 5 Favor Points and if you succeed, there will always be a stipulation or counter request in exchange for siding with your request.

Example (Large Request): A Trainer is planning a heist against the owner of a bar. They make friends with the bartender and end up with a Liked Bond (d8). They ask the bartender if they can give them a spare key to the storage room in exchange for money. They try to use their Intimidation to coerce them, succeeding and gaining a +2 bonus. Their first result is a 3+2 for a 5, failing the TN that was deemed to be an 8. They try to push their bond.

> [If they Failed Again], the bartender will get suspicious and quietly reject their bribe, lowering their bond to Neutral (d6), then informing their boss when they get the chance to next heist.

> [If they Succeed], after some convincing, the bartender will agree and "misplace" the key but requires them to catch a Combee from the forest nearby or give him a bigger bribe.

Improving Bonds

As you progress in your Journey, you'll interact with characters which will shape your bond with them, either improving their relations with you or possibly decreasing them! So how do you improve your bonds? **By gaining Favor Points!**

Whenever you improve a bond with someone, you'll gain a number of Favor Points and if you pass a certain threshold, your Bond Rank with them improves! (Your GM may restrict certain Bond Ranks until a Narrative moment occurs) The prior section states the thresholds of points needed to improve a Bond Rank. Whenever you first create a Bond, you start with Favor Points equal to the threshold.

Gaining & Losing Favor Points

Whenever you perform one of the following actions beneath this section, your Favor Points could be adjusted somehow within GM Discretion. If an action is **Minor**, you gain or lose 2 Favor Points. If it's **Meaningful**, you gain or lose 5 Favor Points. If it's **Major**, you gain or lose 10 or more Favor Points.

1. Vibing with your Bond

Whenever you interact with your bond and the vibes either match or oppose, you will gain or lose favor. If they hear of actions you've done, they'll also have Favor adjusted based on how they view it.

Example- If a ranger npc hears about you saving a popplio from a pack of carvahna, they may admire you and gain +2. If you criticise your Rival's methods of Training, they may lose-2. If you tell a funny joke or show a personality trait that they admire, you may gain +2 Points. If an NPC learns you also serve Xerneas, they may immediately gain +10 Points out of alignment of values.

2. Conflicts with your Bond

Whenever you solve conflicts for your Bond, you'll gain favor based on the severity of the problem. Conversely if you cause problems for your bond, you'll lose favor equal to the severity of the problem.

Example - The Players clear a weedle infestation for a Farmer, gaining +5 Favor. A Player breaks a promise to find a Fossil in a nearby cave, losing-5 Favor. A Player thwarts a heist from Team Rocket, causing the store owner to gain +20 Favor, being thankful for their livelihood being saved.

3. Spending Downtime with your Bond

Whenever you Socialize with a Bond or perform a Downtime Action with them, you'll possibly gain Favor with them. This is the primary way of players being able to spend time to improve their relationships.

Example- A Player goes on a date with a Gym Trainer and Socializes. It goes well and they gain +5 Points and some info about their gym and gossip. A Player trains with their Burmy, gaining +2 Points as it goes well. A Player relaxes in a hot spring with their combusken, gaining +2 Points. A Player tries to spend time with their Zorua that doesn't like them, bonding with them and gaining +5 Points, thus increasing them to Neutral Rank.



Invoking a Bond

The primary way you perform Bond Checks is through **Invoking a Bond**. **Once per Session per Player**, whenever appropriate and if approved by the GM, you can call on a Bond for any of the following options below. A Bond cannot be invoked if they're already performing a Favor.

Seeking Assistance

You may Invoke an appropriate Bond in order to gain assistance in a task they're able to perform to help you. Whenever you perform a Skill Check (Usually for Downtime Actions), you may perform a Bond Check and if it succeeds, you gain a Boon to this Skill Check. If it succeeded by at least 4, add 1d6 to the Skill Check as well (Max 6d6).

Example- A Player is performing a Downtime Action of "Innovating", trying to create a new Pokeball. They Invoke their Bond with one of the engineers they've met that's a Liked Bond. They call them and ask them for assistance and advice with creating the Pokeball. With a TN of 4, they pass the Bond Check and as a result gain a Boon, having learned a breakthrough from them.

Asking for a Favor

You may Invoke a Bond to have them perform a task of some sort for you with the TN being based on how difficult it may be to convince them or perform the task. Offering them something they want or a Favor in return usually lowers this TN. If they have little reason to do this Favor, the TN will be higher. This favor usually grants you some resource or gives you an opportunity to gain something.

Example- A Player asks an Alchemist to brew them a custom potion that could help with a sickness that their Quilava is facing. With a successful Bond Check they'll be more than happy to research it and will give a discount because the Bond Check was high!

Gaining Information

You may Invoke a Bond to have them give you information regarding some topic or problem the Players are facing. A higher TN usually occurs when the Bond either isn't likely to know something or is reluctant to share it.

Example- A Player is denied entry to the Safari Zone. They call up on one of their Bonds that is tied to Team Rocket and ask them for a way to get in. After succeeding the Bond Check, they tell the Player they'll show them a secret tunnel that can get them in.

Combat Aid

You may Invoke a Bond with a character that is currently in combat with you to assist you in some way. This is very vague and meant to be a method of negotiating with the GM to have characters with a good relationship perform better teamwork in combat. If the Action is more impactful the Bond may need to use an Action to perform it. This Bond Check cannot have any modifiers. If the result is at least 4, there is a positive effect. If the result is 8 or higher, the best result occurs for what they're invoking. If the Check fails, some sort of penalty will occur.

Example- A Player is battling alongside their starter Rhydon who is currently at a Trusted Rank (d10). An avalanche of boulders are rolling down the hill and the Player fails their Acrobatics Check. They Invoke their Bond with Rhydon to help save them. They pass with a 6 and block the boulders from hitting them.

Example- Two Players have a strong trusted bond (d10) and one of them performs the Help Maneuver on the other to cure them of the Poisoned Affliction. After passing the Bond Check, the other player gains a +3 bonus to the Save Check from the Maneuver.

Example- A Player is attacked by a Flamethrower and a Cherished Azumarill (d12) performs an Intercept Maneuver. The Player Invokes their Bond and on a success, they resist the Attack by an additional step. If they failed the Bond Check, they may have become Burned as well as taking Neutral Damage.



Campfire Scenes

It's currently **Midnight Phase** and your players are about to sleep and get their rest in for the day. They've set up camp while out on a Journey or they've returned to the Pokemon Center to call it a night. Once per Day, **whenever 2+ Player Characters are grouped together**, you may enact a **Campfire Scene**. Most frequently this can occur **whenever two or more Players perform a Downtime Action** together, or when **two or more Players enter Midnight Phase** or are about to end the day.

What is a Campfire Scene?

A Campfire Scene is moment in time where Players can take a breather, bond and catch up after all the events of their journey thus far. **It is a brief moment of roleplay** within a Time Phase where two Players can simply get to know each other better or even just banter! **When this scene ends, you may gain or lose up to 5 Favor Points with one or more of the other present Characters in the Scene (At GM Discretion).**

Campfire Topics

If you're having trouble setting up the Scene, use any of the following prompts as an ice breaker!

1. Character's Curiosity

Use this topic whenever a Player did something questionable within past couple of sessions or they want to know context behind their actions.

Example- "So...why did you become a Baker?"

Example- "So...how are you so good at hacking?"

2. Recent Events

Use this topic to discuss recent events in the past couple of session or to discuss future plans.

Example- "Seems odd to me that Rangers charge a toll"

Example- "Does Professor Kukui seem off to you lately?"

3. Pokemon Mischief

Start the Scene with one of the Pokemon owned by any Player in the Scene then describe what they're doing or how they're acting with others.

Example- The Scene is two Players researching an Ancient Curse in a library. One of the Player's Yamper is chasing a kid around, annoying a librarian who scolds the Player.

4. Backstory & Memories

Use this topic to develop your backstory by creating a memory related to recent events.

Example- "If I had this much money when I was in Celadon, I would've blown it all on gambling before noon!"

Example- "Last time i delved in a cave...bad things happened"

5. Rumors, Myths & Gossip

Use this topic to make up rumors and myths that your Character may have heard on their journey or in their past. (The GM can make them real maybe!)

Example- "You know...I've heard that children go missing in these woods."

Example- "Have you ever heard the story of the frozen witch?"

6. Intrusive Questions & Thoughts

Give a random question to a Player which their Character would randomly ask out of curiosity.

Example- Two Players are in the woods gathering berries and one asks. "I'm curious, which region would you want to travel to in the future?"



Journeys

So you've just beaten the first Gym and you're ready to move on to the next city! How do you emulate travel in PTE? Whenever your Party is traveling from one place to the next, your GM may declare that this is a **Journey**!

Journeys are a gauntlet of Encounters and travel checks meant to emulate a series of instances that can occur while you're traveling to a destination. Journey Sessions follow the rules in this section:

Should this Session have a Journey?

There could be a lot of reasons why your GM can ignore Journeys despite traveling or not have traveling follow its rules, such as the following:

» If the **distance traveled is short or brief enough** your GM could time skip past traveling and just appear at the destination. If there are methods of fast traveling, Journeys wouldn't make sense.

» If **traveling takes weeks or months**, you could fast forward and have a moment going over what happened during the journey that was notable or do full sessions.

» If your GM wants to ignore travel events for the **sake of time or lack of importance**, it could just be concluded that nothing happens in between the starting point and the destination. Remember, if a Journey would be boring or tedious, there's no point in having it take session time! If the Players need to resolve something in a Cave, they could just skip travel and appear in the section of the cave where the important stuff is.

1. Determine how long the Journey will last

A Journey can either be **Quick**, **Average**, or **Long**. The Journey's speed will determine how many Encounters there will be before the Players reach their destination. These Encounters are preplanned instances and areas in which the Players find something. It doesn't have to be combat! They could just stumble across a group of solosis near a meteor!

As a frame of reference, Journeys should usually take 1-2 Sessions.

If a Journey is **Quick**, there are no encounters before the destination (But you still perform a Travel Check!).

If a Journey is **Average**, there are 2 Encounters at a Minimum before the Destination (Can be up to 4).

If a Journey is **Long**, there are 6 Encounters at a Minimum before the Destination (Can be up to 8).

Example (Short) - The players are traveling to a farm from a nearby city that is just a short walk. There are no Encounters between but the GM rolls a Travel Check and determines a Ralts follows them on the way there.

Example (Long) - The players are traveling from Viridian City to Pewter City. The Journey is deemed to be long and will travel through Viridian Forest, having a couple of encounters they find while there and a bunch of travel checks between.



2. Determine what the Players are bringing

A Journey notably is a prolonged Session without access to your stored Pokemon or items in your storage. This means whatever your Party has equipped or in their Inventory matters alot! Before leaving, ask each Player what they're packing for the Journey. Additionally, ask them which 3 Pokemon will be in their Party, since they won't have access to their storage while traveling!

Example - One Player decides to bring 2 Pokeballs, 2 Basic Healing Potions and 2 Pokepuffs while the second player brings the Tent for both of them, a Healing Potion, 2 Pokeballs and Some Food Ingredients.

GM Note: Items gained on a Journey should not take an Inventory Slot until the Journey is concluded. This way they don't have to throw something away or keep slots open just in case they find something.

Important Note

If your Party doesn't have a centralized base they can return to after sessions, make it so that the transfer of Items in their Storage and their Pokemon are extremely easy and of no cost to them. If they leave Viridian City, their stuff should be accessible once they get to Pewter City even if they don't have space to carry it all.

3. Perform a Travel Check before each Encounter

Before your Players enter an Encounter on their Journey, the GM will perform a **Travel Check** which consists of a secretive 3d6. After which, they'll consult the Travel Check Table on the next page to determine what happens. This is usually something happening between Encounters or something that affects the pre planned Encounter that they are about to enter.

If something happens before they enter the Encounter, it should be short in duration, no more than 5-10 Minutes and usually resolvable with a Skill Check or clever solution. Remember, the Encounters are the main source of substance in the session!

Example - While Traveling down a Route, the GM rolls a 7, leading to a Traveling Mishap Event. The GM determines that one of the bridges was broken by a wild Gyarados. If the Party has no solutions, it could take an extra Time Phase to find a route around it, wasting the Morning. The Party could also bring out their Staraptor and take turns flying across the Ravine, resolving the issue.

4. Determine how much time passes

After each Encounter is resolved and the Players continue traveling, determine how much time passes. If an Encounter was mostly ignored or minimally interacted with (Small talk), it takes half a Time Phase or no significant time, of your choice. If the Encounter was interacted with or they got something of value from it, it takes a full Time Phase.

Example (Minimal Interaction) - One of the Encounters the Players find while traveling through Viridian Forest is finding a waterfall with a Fisherman nearby fishing for Pokemon. They decide to talk with him a little bit before continuing on their travels, not bothering him much. This only takes half a Time Phase

Example (Full Interaction) - While talking to the Fisherman from the prior example, a swarm of Poliwhag suddenly rushes out, being chased by a Seaking. The Players battle the swarm and help the fisherman out, with him being grateful.

5. Make a Campfire if needed

Sometimes Journeys take a lot of time and the Players need to settle down in order to rest if it gets too late. At any point during a Journey the Players may find a safe location to create a Campsite. If there is no safe location nearby, a Skill Check may be required to find a safe location or someone will need to keep watch.

While in a Campsite they can perform Extended and Downtime Actions freely (If they have necessary resources such as Travel Sets) and pass time that way. Additionally they may rest and regain health as they normally would sleeping in a secure place like an Inn. If a Player doesn't have a Tent or Sleeping Bag on hand it may result in a rougher night sleeping.



Travel Check Table

3d6	Name	Event	Example
3	Dire Encounter	A negative twist will occur in the next Encounter of some kind. The Party is in the wrong place at the wrong time.	The Party stumbles across the Guardian of the Forest Mandibuzz. The Party finds a gang that is trading illegal substances.
4	Tough Enemy	One of the Pokemon in the next Encounter will be upgraded to a boss template or be increased a number of Levels equal to double the Party's Tier Value.	A Mightyena that was bullying the Pokemon in the next Encounter is now an Alpha Boss Pokemon.
5	Environmental Change	Something in the environment changes as they travel which either persists until they reach their destination or for your preferred duration. If the effect is particularly hostile, there could be some penalty due to the conditions.	This could cause the weather to suddenly turn into a Snowstorm and reduce visibility. A surge of Ivy could start to block off future paths.
6	Dangerous Terrain	Something about the route is dangerous and requires a Skill Check or creative solution. Upon failing, the Player could lose Items, Health, or Money.	This could include crumbling bridges, cliffs, uneven ground, ambushing Pokemon.
7	Traveling Mishap	Some sort of obstacle is preventing the Party from going to the next Encounter. Clearing the obstacle requires a creative solution of some sort or a Skill Check depending on the fluff. Upon failing, a Time Phase will pass.	This could be a physical barrier like mudslide or broken bridge or getting lost or a pokenav breaking or running into a big Pokemon that chases you.
8	NPC Nuisance	The Party encounters a less friendly NPC in some way. They could be negatively affecting other people or Pokemon around them while the party passes by or they could directly confront the Players. If a conflict should arise, it is minor enough where the Players will surely succeed but perform a luck check to determine how much they are set back, either with damage or time.	The Party finds a group of Pokemon being bullied by a Trainer and his Magmortar. The Party is confronted by a group of Team Magma grunts wanting a toll before progressing on the trail.
9	Pestering Pokemon	A Random Pokemon will start to pursue the Party, somehow taking an interest in the Players or their Pokemon that are out or possibly wanting to be mischeivous or pester them. They will enter the next area with this Pokemon. This Pokemon will have a more negative intention with their reason to follow.	This could be a Bisharp stalking the players, a Primeape that is trying to pick a fight with a Player's Haxorus, or a Misdreavus trying to steal from a Player.
10 & 11	Calm Travels	Nothing eventful happens.	--
12	Wild Companion	A Random Pokemon will start to pursue the Party, somehow taking an interest in the Players or their Pokemon that are out or possibly wanting to be mischeivous or pester them. They will enter the next area with this Pokemon. This Pokemon will have a more innocent intention with their reason to follow.	This could be a Skitty following and begging for food, or a Spearow wanting to nest in someone's hair, or a pidove that wants to sit on a Player's Rhyhorn.
13	NPC Assistance	An NPC needs assistance somehow. When helped, they'll possibly grant the Player a small reward less than \$1,000 in value. This could usually be resolved with a Skill Check.	This could be being harassed by a Pokémon, having an injured Pokémon, wanting to know if a berry is poisonous.
14	Scavenging Luck	While traveling, the Party finds some sort of Item or cluster of Items. Have one of them roll a Luck Check. On a 10 or less it's worth \$500. Any higher it's worth \$1000 approximately. On a 20+ they instead find a Rare Treasure from the Lucky Table.	The party finds a cluster of berries that could be used for food and gain 5 Ingredients (Cooking).
15	Traveling Vendor	The party comes across a Vendor or Caravan that is carrying their wares down the road and will be willing to trade with them.	They could sell Equipment, Tutor Services, Books, Fossils, Fashion, Tech. Pokemon Held Items, Artificing Items, Medicine, Food, Pokemon Eggs, Pokemon for Adoption, Treasures, etc.
16	Guardian Crossing	The Party comes across an extremely strong Pokemon which is added to the next area. It is unlikely that it is hostile towards the Players but has some connection to the existing Pokemon	A Torterra is guarding a group of grass pokemon that are vibing. A Nidoking is being pestered by Finneon.
17	Fated Luck	A Player performs a Luck Check. On a 15+, apply the Lucky Encounter. Otherwise, reroll this Travel Check.	--
18	Lucky Encounter	Roll 1d3 from the Lucky Table or apply a custom benefits based on the area or apply a positive twist to the next Encounter.	You can also choose instead of rolling if you have a good idea!

Lucky Table

1d3	Name	Event	Example
1	Rare Pokemon	The Party comes across an odd Pokemon of some kind. This Pokemon will be added to the next area in some manner that feels natural. This Pokemon will either be a Type Shift or have a Variant Effect.	The party comes across a Turtwig that's shell is completely made of stone and is a Grass/Rock type.
2	Rare Location	The Party finds a rare location while traveling that they can note in their map to visit at another time or explore later.	The Party finds a lake with dratini and feebas. The Party finds an ruined and abandoned mage tower in the distance.
3	Rare Treasure	The Party finds a random item while traveling that is fairly rare. Something at least \$2,000 in value.	A Player finds a glowing berry on a bush that is a Tutor Record (Grass). A Player finds an abandoned nest with a Snorunt Egg.

Sample Journey

So how does a Journey Session look? Let's take a look below at an **Average** Length Journey for a Party consisting of 2 Players both at Level 2!

Determining Journey Duration - The Journey through Viridian Forest will be Average in length with 2 Encounters.

Determining Loadout - Player 1 (Adam) has two Pokemon, his Tailow and Treecko. Player 2 (Hailey) has two Pokemon as well, her Mudkip and Seedot. Adam also brings 2 Pokeball, 2 Healing Potions and a First Aid Kit. Hailey will bring 2 Pokeballs, 2000 Ingredients (Tech), 1 Travel Set (Tech)

Journey Summary

The Players head out bright and early in the Morning Time Phase and leave Viridian to head into the forest.

Travel Check #1

The GM rolls a 13 (NPC Assistance) on the Travel Check. The GM states that as they walk into the forest, they see a young Trainer rushing past them holding a Pikachu that looks sickly. Adam calls out to the Trainer and asks if they need help, telling them his Pikachu is Poisoned and he's rushing to the Pokemon Center. Adam tells them not to worry, he has a First Aid Kit conveniently! After helping the Pikachu, he thanks them by handing Adam 3 Ingredients (Food) as a bundle of berries he found before they continue on.

Encounter #1

The group, having successfully completed the Travel Check, goes into the first Encounter. The group comes across a few bug Pokemon being swarmed by a group of Beedrill! The Party decides to be brave and interferes, fending off the Beedrill. A few of their Pokemon are hurt in the process and her Treecko faints, by which they use their Healing Potions and First Aid Kit to restore some of their Damage. The group of grass pokemon are overjoyed and one of the Shroomish wants

to join Hailey, to which she uses a Pokeball and captures it! Considering they interacted with the Encounter, it took up a full time Phase and it is now the Afternoon.

Travel Check #2

The Party then continues in the forest, performing another Travel Check. The GM rolls a 14 (Scavenging Luck) on the Travel Check. He then has them perform a Luck Check and it results in a 13. The GM tells them as they wander through the forest they come across a berry cluster of Oran and Citrus, leading to finding 10 Ingredients (Food).

Encounter #2

They then continue through the forest and reach the 2nd Encounter Area. In this area they find their Rivals chasing around a Bulbasaur and catching it! They talk with them for a little bit and decide to have a fight.

Journey Conclusion

After the fight resolves, they head out of the forest. Considering this was their last Encounter for the Journey, they have now reached their **destination** of Pewter City! That last Encounter was interacted with in Full so when they reach Pewter City it is now the Evening Time Phase!

Methods of Creating Enemies

PTE is a very crunchy system and as such, we offer multiple ways of statting Enemies depending on your preference or needs, each of which are listed below. **Remember that if you don't anticipate a Pokemon or NPC being battled, you do not need to stat them.** You can easily remember what their narrative talents are such as what skills they're good in.

Boss Templates

For enemies you truly want to be challenging, we have the Boss Templates such as Alpha and Guardian Pokemon. These are fully stattd but gain extra powers so they can even exceed the power of your Players and prove to be a challenge. *Whenever you want an Enemy to be meaningful, use these Templates.*

Full Statting

Fully statting a Pokemon or Trainer is going through the player creation process or pokemon creation process and following all of the rules there so that the Enemies are equal in capabilities compared to the player since they have access to the same things. *You should fully stat something when you want them to be a challenge, be a recurring character, want them to be equal in options to the Players or if the Encounter is small enough.* It is not recommended to fully stat everything, as players will rarely get to experience the full build of an enemy that you've stattd unless it's a boss and it takes a while to do.

Minion Combatants

Minions are a 'Lite' Character builds that you can do when you're making one off or simpler Pokemon for the enemies to fight, a simple goon so to speak. Minions do not follow Level progression like normal characters and are designed in a way where a GM can quickly create a Pokemon without thinking too hard and still have it be impactful. *When you want to quickly add Pokemon to an Encounter such as reinforcements of two or three magnemite, make them minions.*



Enemy Variations

Gameplay would be fairly boring if every enemy you faced was the same power level and that's why we have **Enemy Variations**. These Variations are different types of templates you can apply to either **Pokemon or Human Enemies** to make them more interesting in combat, such as making them stronger or weaker or just more interesting. This section will have an overview of each Variation and subsequent sections will explain in full detail how to create that variation of enemy

Alpha Bosses

Alpha Bosses are your standard Boss Pokemon. Whenever one Pokemon or Trainer stands out in strength among the rest, make them an Alpha! These Enemies will have a stronger level than your Party and often have multiple Turns and Health Bars. They are also considered a Boss so they will follow Boss Rules that make them sturdier and harder to defeat than normal Pokemon.

Guardian Bosses

Guardians are your advanced Bosses such as leaders of an area or even Legendary Pokemon. They stand out with even more strength than alphas and have a control of the area around them, being able to perform Lair Actions to warp the battlefield to their benefit.

Swarm Pokemon

Swarm Pokemon are not considered a Boss Pokemon and follow different Rules but specifically because of their stature, they aren't as bulky but have a lot more Actions based on the number of creatures in the swarm. They won't be powerful in numbers but their impact with actions will be great.

Variant Pokemon

There is no strength difference with Variant Pokemon, however these Pokemon can be added to spice up an Encounter with an odd effect. These Pokemon are different than their default species and you can add a Variant Effect with them to display this. This also allows your Party to catch unique Pokemon with special alterations, however they won't be able to obtain the Deep Bond (Bond Perk) if those rules are being used. This can include shinies or type shifts among other odd effects.

Minions

Minions are quick and easy to stat enemies that don't involve going through the fully level progression for creating an enemy. They can be statted at different power levels and given more or fewer options but allow for quick enemies to be added to encounters.



Alpha Bosses

Anytime you wish to make an Enemy that is harder than the norm, use an Alpha Boss Template which comprises the following rules. This Enemy is considered to have a Boss Template, for the sake of Affliction Effects like Drowsy and Suppressed. When Capturing a Boss Pokemon, any special rules applied to them as a result of being a boss may be removed or kept at GM discretion. (Usually remove them)

1. Alpha Pokemon are always **5 Levels higher** than your Player's Maximum Pokemon Level. If they're Tier 3, the Boss is instead **10 Levels higher**. Alpha Trainers are always 2 Levels higher than your Player's Trainer Level. If a boss exceeds a Level cap this way, grant them +5 Stat points per level exceeded.

Example - If a Player has a Level 15 Combusken, an Alpha Linoone would be Level 20.

2. Alpha Enemies will have **multiple Health Bars**. If there are 1-2 Players in the Party, they have 2. If there are 3+ Players, they have 3. Whenever they would faint, they instead revert to their Maximum Hit Point value with the damage not carrying over, then they lose one of their Health Bars. This is a **"Bar Break"**.

Example - An Alpha Gloom with 2 HP Bars and 60 Hit Points essentially has 120 HP with a buffer. If they have 10 HP and take 30 damage, they reset to 60 HP and lose an HP Bar with a Bar Break.

3. Alpha Enemies will have **multiple Turns**, equal to the number of Players. Only one Turn may be a part of a Combat Pair, the rest are just the Alpha Enemy acting alone.

4. Effects that reference, **Start of Turn, Per Turn, or End of Turn**, only occur once per Round on their first applicable turn where they could occur, regardless of the number of turns they have. Additionally, Save Checks can only occur once per Round at the end of one of their Turns of choice unless provoked by an outside source such as the Help Maneuver.

Example - If a Boss is burned, the immediate next turn they lose the Tick from starting their Turn burned, but all subsequent turns that round they don't lose the tick from starting the Round (Unless it's cured and afflicted as a new Affliction). Effects like Aqua Ring that restore hit points at the start of their Turn only affect the first one per Round since it becomes relevant.

5. Bosses may perform Boss Perks, listed below, once at the start of a Scene and twice each time a Bar Break would occur and they don't faint as a result.

BOSS PERK LIST

1. Choose two different Combat Values below to gain +1 (Modifier or CS) in or reset to their Default Value: » Any Stat except HP, Accuracy, Critical Hit Range, Effect Range, Save Checks.

2. The Boss is cured (or removes) of two of the following options:

» A Status Affliction, A Coat, A Condition other than Fainted.

3. The Boss replaces up to 2 Attacks with ones on their Known List, learns an Attack from their Tutor List, refreshes the Frequency of all Attacks or refreshes the Frequency of one Ability.

4. The Boss gains a **Surge Token** or two if there are 3+ Players in the opposing Party. (See: Spicing up Bosses)

5. The Boss may enter a **Stance** (See: Spicing up Bosses). This can only occur once per Scene.

6. The Boss may use a **Lair Action** (See: Spicing up Bosses)

7. The Boss may transform into a different form that you have prepared. Cannot be used at the start of Combat.

Guardian Bosses

Unlike Alpha Bosses, Guardians are a step above even them and constitute a major challenge to be faced. These Pokemon should be used sparingly for a larger impact but Guardians are usually the leaders of an entire area and the big boss of all bosses. This Enemy is considered to have a Boss Template, for the sake of Affliction Effects like Drowsy and Suppressed.

Guardian Pokemon follow all of the same rules as Alpha Pokemon do, including Boss Perks, however the following rules overwrite Alpha Rules as well as are rules exclusive to Guardians:

1. Guardian Pokemon are always **20 Levels higher** than your Player's Maximum Pokemon Level. If they're Tier 3, the Boss is instead **40 Levels higher**. Alpha Trainers are always 5 Levels higher than your Player's Trainer Level. If a boss exceeds a Level cap this way, grant them +5 Stat points per level exceeded.

Example - A Player and their Level 30 Blaziken finds a Level 50 Shiftry as a king of the forest.

2. Pokemon Guardians have **8 Attack Slots** instead of 6.

3. At the end of each Round, **the Guardian may use a Boss Perk**. We recommend this be used mostly for Lair Actions. Additionally, Guardians may use **Boss Perks twice at the start of the Scene** instead of once.

Guardian Pokemon Example

I have two Players in the Party, both Trainer Level 10 with their Max Level as Pokemon level 50. They go into a sacred ruins and find a Guardian Claydol that has a been of strange glyphs on their body. This Claydol is level 90. For their Attacks, I chose to give it Barrier, Extrasensory, Earth Power, Psychic Storm, Hyper Beam, Meteor Shower, Thunderbolt and Psychic Noise. Its Abilities gained will be Clay Cannons and Magic Bounce while its role will be Rank 2 in the Ranger Role. It will have two HP Bars and two Turns. It will likely have a few irrelevant allies for this example, let's say 3 Golurk. Claydol was also given a Boss Gimmick known as "Runic Sigils", which has the effects of switching between different runes which grant it different effects. For example a Strength rune would allow its Special Attacks to deal Physical Damage instead.

At the start of the Scene, Claydol will use a Boss Perk to use a Lair Action using Battlefield Alteration, setting Mystical Weather which boosts some of his abilities, then boost his Critical Hit Range by +1. He'll then use Extrasensory and a turn later, using Cosmic Power and then the Versatile Effect of Psychic Storm. At the end of the Round a few Golurks have fainted, then another Boss Perk can be used. This time, Claydol uses it to enter a Charging Stance.

For the first Turn this Round he uses Stored Power to knock out a Pokemon, then charges with a Swift Action. However before his second Turn can occur, his plans to use a charged up Hyper beam fail as he loses an HP Bar, making him Vulnerable for a while and then triggering another two Boss Perks. For one Perk he'll boost his SP ATK by +1 CS, then he'll use another Lair Action to cause a psychic landslide with Area Retaliation in a couple of 3x3 Zones.

For the third Round, he'll use an imprisoning Rune from his Gimmick to lock a person in place unless they pass a Focus Check, which they pass, allowing them to run from the rockslide and deal the final blow to Claydol.



Spicing up Bosses

In previous sections we have the base rules for ruling an Alpha or Guardian Boss Pokemon, however this section will list additional ways you can add some spice to your bosses and make them more interesting. **The Boss Perk List** will specify this section for the sake of [Surge Tokens](#), [Stances](#) and [Lair Actions](#).

SURGE TOKENS

In order to even the scales of an Encounter, you could grant your Boss Surge Tokens either as a Boss Perk when they lose HP Bars or through special occasions such as an Environmental Conduit granting Surge Tokens while they're active. Bosses can expend a Surge Token to perform any of the following as a Free Action either on their Turn, at the end of any Turn, or when it would be triggered (Such as using it for an Intercept Maneuver)

- 1. To perform a Damaging Attack** - This Attack is resisted by an additional damage step. This is ignored if the Attack only has one Target or they expend another Surge Token.
- 2. To perform a Status Attack** - This Attack cannot have a range of "Self or Shield". The Frequency of an Attack used this way is not expended.
- 3. To perform a Maneuver** - This Maneuver cannot be an Attack of Opportunity, Riposte or Respite. If they use the Help Maneuver, it ignores its restrictions
- 4. To resist an Attack by an additional damage step** - However their next Swift Action is expended.
- 5. To perform a Save Check** - However their next Swift Action is expended.

BOSS STANCES

Sometimes Bosses enter a certain Stance that empowers them in a specific way, but also has the chance to leave them vulnerable if a weakness is exploited, leaving it as a high risk for higher output option. Each Stance has an **Effect and a Break Condition**. During their current Health Bar, they will have the Effect of the Stance applied to them. When they lose an HP Bar, they automatically lose their Stance's Effects and leave their Stance, however if the **Break Condition** occurs, they lose their Stance's Effects and they become Vulnerable until the end of the next Round.

A list of stances are on the next page:



Stance Name	Effect	Break Condition
Frenzied	The Boss immediately becomes Enraged and cannot be cured of it while affected by this Stance. The user's Damaging Attacks all gain the Smite Keyword and their Critical Hit Range is increased by +2.	The Stance is broken when the Boss misses two Attacks or causes one of their enemies to faint.
Shielded	The Boss gains Damage Reduction equal to their Tier Value multiplied by the number of enemy Players (Keep track of this separately from other sources of DR). Designate Physical or Special. The user applies this whole DR value towards the Attacks of the Designated Category and half towards the other. Whenever the user is hit by an Attack of their designated Category while in this Stance, they lose DR gained this way equal to their Tier Value after Damage Calculations.	The Stance is broken when the Boss loses all DR gained this way or has their corresponding Defense Stat lowered to -3 CS or less.
Unyielding	When the Boss enters an Unyielding Stance, they choose a Player to become their Rival (All their Pokemon are also treated as Rivals). Whenever the Boss Attacks a Rival, they have a +3 to Accuracy, ignore Damage Reduction, can't have their Attacks resisted by the Rival by any means and their Attacks cannot be Intercepted by non Rivals.	The Stance is broken if a Rival of the Boss inflicts a Critical Hit against the Boss, avoids two Attacks or a Rival Faints.
Charging	While in this Stance, as a Swift Action, they gain +1 Charge Token. Whenever they're hit by a Critical Hit or gain an Affliction, they lose a Charge Token. At the end of the Round, if they have at least one Charge Token, they expend all Charge Tokens and may use a Damaging Attack as a Free Action. For each Charge Token expended, they gain a benefit listed below: » The Attack gains +3 DB » The Attack gains the Smite Keyword or Sureshot if it already has Smite. » The Attack increases its Area of Effect by +1	The Stance automatically breaks after the resolution of the Attack used with the expended Charge Tokens or the end of the Round if they're unable to use the Attack. The Stance is also considered to be broken if they lose their HP Bar before they would resolve this Attack.
Desperate	When the Boss enters the Desperate Stance, an Underling Minion enters the Field for each opposing Player. Whenever the Boss would start their Turn, instead, two Minions may act or they may add another Underling Minion to the fight.	The Stance breaks when a number of Minions equal to the number of Players in the opposing Party faint. After this Stance breaks, all Minions flee the Encounter or are unable to act, of your choice.
Regenerative	The user has a +3 bonus to Save Checks and at the end of their Turns (Ignoring the end of Turn rule), they restore two Ticks of Hit Points or gain a Tick of Temporary Hit Points.	The Stance breaks when the Boss is hit by a Critical Hit, recovers at least 8 Ticks of Hit Points, or recovers from at least 2 Status Afflictions while in the Stance.

Stance Example

A Rhyperior enters the Shielded Stance and pulls rocks from all directions to create rocky armor for itself. The enemy Tier Rank is 2 and there are 3 Players so it gains 30 Damage Reduction against Physical and half of it applies to Special. The Players strike it with a Physical attack and it barely does any damage but chips its DR to 20. After a few more hits, the stance is broken and they become Vulnerable.

LAIR ACTIONS

The Party is facing a Magmortar Guardian in a volcano. You want to show that the environment is dangerous and the Magmortar has an influence on it. How do you perform this? With Lair Actions!

Lair Actions can be done easily by Guardians but sometimes by regular bosses in order to show that the environment is alive and often dangerous. Whenever you wish to perform a Lair Action, choose something from the list below to enable on the Scene. These are just examples however and you can create your own effects if desired based on the environment your Players are in and what they're facing. Additionally in the column I listed the Magmortar Guardian Pokemon for an example of how they can be implemented.

Note - Be wary however that overusing the same Lair Action may lead to combat being stale!

Lair Action	Effect	Magmortar Example
Area Retaliation	Choose one Attack on the Boss's Battle Attack List or an Attack that would make sense to come from the environment. Then choose either three 3x3 Zones or a 5x5 Zone, or whatever other Zone would make sense for the trigger (These Zones are visible to all Combatants). At the end of the next Round or upon a Trigger being fulfilled, the chosen Attack is used as a Free Action, Targeting all Combatants or Enemies of the Boss within the chosen Zones. If it was chosen from the Boss's list of Attacks, it ignores Frequency and uses their Offensive Stat. Otherwise it follows the Environmental Damage rules. Example- A wild jungle causes vines to whiplash in five "Line 4" Ranges, each using the Power Whip Attack. A loud Exploud causes Stalactites to fall from the ceiling in three 3x3 Zones with the Rock Slide Attack.	Magmortar channels an eruption from the nearby lake of magma which causes the lake to bubble. A Round later, the lake erupts, making steaming Smoke Hazards in three 3x3 Zones that burn on contact.
Attack Blowback	A delayed change in the environment has occurred based on something that happened during this Round. Resolving the effects of this blowback should use a Standard action or Swift Action if resourceful. Example- A machine overloads from a missed thunderbolt causing anyone who ends their turn adjacent to it to become Paralyzed, trees catching on fire from a flamethrower leading to an area of effect of Fire Hazards or a draco meteor landing on a grassland causing a cloud of pollen to haze the field, leading to a -2 to Accuracy for a Round.	A hydro pump that targeted Magmortar led to its body starting to steam, leading it to be covered in a fog of steam for a round. Enemies have a -3 Accuracy Penalty while it's affected. A Pidgeot blows it away with a Hurricane Attack that's resisted by an additional step.
Battlefield Alteration	The Battlefield has been altered somehow. One Effect enters the field or alters the terrain that either affects all Combatants, harms the Player's Party or benefits the Boss's Party. This usually is either Terrain being changed, Blessings entering the field or the Weather changing. Example- The Weather changes to Thunderstorm. A Nidoking's rampage leads to a lot of earthen blocking terrain being created on the field in a labyrinth shape. Psionic aura created by an Alakazam lead to a protective aura on its allies, leading to 2 Activations of Reflect	The high heat of the volcano has led to the Weather being treated as Sunny. The high intensity has also granted a Heated Coat to Magmortar and an ally of theirs (See Heat Veil Attack).

Lair Action	Effect	Magmortar Example
Environmental Conduit	Something appears on the Battlefield that likely has a connection with the Boss and causes a passive effect while it remains undestroyed. This "Conduit" is treated as Blocking Terrain and has HP equal to 20 times the Party's Trainer Level. Alternatively, three "Conduits" can appear but they only have HP equal to 5 Times their Trainer Level. When it is destroyed, the effects that derived from it cease. Example- Three paintings in a Haunted House start to look alive and at the end of each turn unless destroyed, they roll a Luck Check and on a 5 or under, they Curse someone within 3m of them. A massive generator starts to stir, creating a psychic aura that makes all Psychic Attacks have the Sureshot Keyword unless destroyed and increases in power each round. The Boss creates a crystal that gives it Immunity to Dark Type Damage while active.	Three Slugmas function as a Conduit whose only purpose is to roam around on the field and spit magma at Magmortar at the end of the round, which either restore a Tick of Hit Points or gives a Tick of Temp HP each. They don't do anything else.
Fleeting Catastrophe	Something has occurred on the battlefield that doesn't have any immediate impact but if not dealt with somehow, it will cause something to occur at the end of the next round or a timer of your discretion. The result from this Catastrophe not being resolved could be another Lair Action but with more drastic impact. Resolving this Catastrophe should use a Standard action or Swift Action if resourceful. Example- A generator starts to fizz and spark looking like it'll explode. If the Party doesn't destroy it before it explodes or stops the explosion, it'll cause a Burst 2 Electric Special Attack with Massive Damage. Alternatively they could use it to their advantage and slide an enemy into its range! A Forest Fire is beginning and will double in Fire Hazards every round its not extinguished.	Magmortar spends a Movement Action to activate this Lair Effect by shooting a flamethrower into a volcanic geyser, causing it to stir. If not blocked off somehow it'll cause a Lava Plume Attack to occur that can't miss and hits all Targets in a Burst 2 Range. However a Player's Mr. Mime uses a Swift Action to use its Wallshaper Capability in a creative way to block off the geyser from erupting.
Reactive Battlefield	Something has occurred in the scene that requires a quick reaction from a Combatant in order to stave off its negative effects. Designate a Combatant or a maximum of a 3x3 Zone to be affected by this Lair Action. They then must perform a Luck Roll with a Modifier of their Skill Rank in a Skill allowed by the GM and a TN of 12. If they fail this Luck Roll, they're affected by the negative effect, usually gaining a Status Affliction or Conditions or temporary penalty. The Modifier can be doubled before rolling as a Swift Action, Priority (Advanced). . Example- A cloud of dark smoke looms towards a Player that Suppresses them on a failed roll, they can use Occult Edu as their Skill Modifier or Intuition to determine the weird nature of the smoke. The earth shifts under a 2x2 zone from an Earthquake and on a failed roll they are Tripped, they can use Acrobatics as their Skill Modifier to represent their nimbleness.	Some lava is overflowing from a pool within the volcanic cavern and the Party is in the heat of battle not noticing it's spilling onto the ground. Combatants in a 2x2 Zone near the pool need to pass a Luck Roll or else they become Burned and lose a Tick of Hit Points. They can use Perception as a Skill Modifier to represent noticing the spilling lava in their peripherals.

Continued on the next page

Lair Action	Effect	Magmortar Example
Reinforcements	A Path has opened on the battlefield in which Pokemon that are allied to the Boss can enter the field. An Underling Minion (Or two if there are 3+ Players in the Party) enters the Field when this Lair Action is used and at the end of every subsequent Round this isn't resolved. Resolving this Lair Action should use a Standard action or Swift Action if resourceful. Example- A rift in space is opened and a Solrock comes out. The player's Metagross attacks the portal with a Psychic and it fizzles out. Goomy start to wander out of a swamp lake. The player's Pangoro stands nearby the lake and uses a Swift Action to intimidate and stave off any other goomy from joining the encounter.	A Slugma crawls out of a small hole within the wall of the volcanic cavern after Magmortar blasts one open. After a round another comes out. Eventually the Party's Nidoking uses a Rock Slide near it which allows the hole to be covered by the debris

BOSS GIMMICKS

Sometimes if you want a boss to be really special, you can grant it a unique ability known as a Boss Gimmick. This is functionally an ability but does not interact with Attacks such as Gastro Acid or abilities like Trace. The power level of this gimmick is up to your discretion, however it should be treated as a Variant Effect on steroids. (If you give them a Gimmick, don't also give them a Variant Effect). These do not persist after capture. Some examples are below for inspiration!

Tag Team Duo! Basic Gimmick- Boss Hawlucha
Static

Effect: The user is considered to be in a Combat Pair with its partner Hitmontop. Whenever Hawlucha Attacks an Enemy, Hitmontop ignores the Speed Evasion of the same Target for the rest of the Round. Conversely, whenever Hitmontop Attacks an Enemy, Hawlucha ignores the Physical Evasion of the same Target for the rest of the Round. Whenever Hitmontop faints, Hawlucha gains +2 CS in Attack and Speed and becomes Enraged. Whenever Hawlucha faints, Hitmontop's Melee Attacks become Burst 1 and its Burst or Blast Attacks increase by +1 Range.

Soul Storm Advanced Gimmick- Boss Spiritomb
At-Will- Swift Action

Effect: The Soul is expended. Choose one of the following Effects to apply

- » The user gains +1 CS in a Stat of your choice
- » The user restores two Ticks of Hit Points
- » The user's next Ghost Type Attack cannot miss

Bonus: Whenever a Combatant Faints or a Ghost Type Attack rolls a Natural 15+, a Soul is created within 5m of the user in a random space.

Blazing Fury Master Gimmick- Boss Blaziken
At-Will- Free Action, Interrupt

Trigger: The user lands a Critical Hit, is hit by a Super Effective Attack or rolls a Natural 15+ on a Fire Attack

Effect: The user gains a Blaze Counter.

Bonus: The user's Melee and Fire Attacks have +2 DB per Blaze Counter the user has. When the user has 3 Blaze Counters, they become Enraged and cannot be cured of it. When the user has 5 Blaze Counters, their Melee Attacks cannot miss.

Swarm Pokemon

The Party comes across a swarm of Zubat in a cave! How does one balance an encounter with around 20 Zubat? Not only that, why should you deal with 20 Combatants per Turn? Instead what you could do is create a **Swarm Pokemon**. These Pokemon function similarly to a boss but do not follow their rules and are not functionally “Boss Pokemon”, instead following a different set of rules listed below.

1. Instead of Statting multiple Pokemon, a **Swarm Pokemon has one Character Sheet** representing the entire Swarm.
2. The Swarm will have a number of **Turns equal to the number of Players in the Opposing Party +1**.
3. Whenever the Swarm Pokemon **hits 0 HP, they instead permanently lose a Turn**, then reset to 100% Hit Points. When they have no Turns remaining, the Swarm faints.
4. Swarm Pokemon do not have Battle Attack Lists, and instead **may use any Attack they can learn**.
5. Swarm Pokemon **do not have Pokemon Roles**, instead, each time they would gain an Ability from Pokemon Progression, they instead gain two.
6. **There will be a number of tokens to represent on the Swarm equal to the number of Turns they currently have**. These are all treated as different combatants. If multiple tokens would be targeted by the same Attack, it doesn't deal damage twice or apply the effect twice, but instead is treated as one step more effective.

Swarm Pokemon Example

I have two Players in my Party. They wander into a forest and find a swarm of Oddish rushing around chaotically. This swarm has three Turns per round and has 3 tokens rushing around the map. The Oddish Swarm is determined to be Level 15 so it only gets two Abilities which I deem to be Aroma Veil and Life Force. For the Level 10 Advancement, I teach the swarm the Tutor Attack Razor Leaf. Its total Attack List is Absorb, Acid, Growth, Sweet Scent, Poison Powder, Acid Spray, Sleep Powder and Razor Leaf.

During the first round, the first two turns of oddish lead to them poisoning and sleeping two players with their attacks before one of the Oddish are knocked out. The next round the swarm only has two turns, lead them to use Razor Leaf and then Growth to get stronger. Another is knocked out from a flame wheel, leaving one left to spray acid on the players before it finally faints.



Variant Pokemon

How does one differentiate between Pokemon of the same species? Well mechanically there are a few methods such as different attack lists, roles and ability choices, but there are also **Variant Effects!** At any point, a GM can grant a Pokemon a Variant Effect in order to give them a custom effect that makes them different from others of that species, similar to shiny Pokemon. Mechanically, Variant Effects are basically custom Abilities.

As a GM, when considering whether you want to implement Variant Pokemon, follow the rules and suggestions below. Additionally beneath these rules, there will be some examples of Variant Effects, including a scaling one that's named, "Golden Egg".

1. Variant Effects could be given in any of the following circumstances

Variant Effects can be given to your Trainer's Starter Pokemon to make them more special. Variant Effects can be given when a Trainer reaches the Ally Bond level with a Pokemon. Variant Effects can be granted to some wild Pokemon to make them unique and desirable. Variant Effects can be given to Boss Pokemon that are captured in order to carry over their boss effects in a more balanced way for the players. Remember "This one is Special, I know it"? Situations like that.

2. Pokemon can only have one Variant Effect

Each Pokemon, if they have a Variant Effect at all, should only have one Effect and if it would increase in power, the increase adjusts that one effect. For example, a Starter could start with a basic variant effect and have it upgrade to an advanced level once they reach an Ally Bond and spend a lot of time with their Trainer. Pokemon should not have 3+ different variant effects that increase tedium and bloat the power of a Pokemon.

3. Variant Effects have three power levels

There are three levels of power, each of which listed under the examples known as **Basic** Variant Effects, **Advanced** Variant Effects and **Mythic** Variant Effects. Whichever power level of effects you give out should be dependent on your table's preferred power level, however they should be consistent or context dependent as to prevent power creep from phasing out other Pokemon. Basic Variant effects are usually narrative based and affect combat in a niche way. Advanced Variant effects could affect combat some but be a little less powerful than an ability. Mythic Variant effects should be equal to the power of an Ability or higher. If you need a rubric, Around Trainer Level 5-8, Advanced Variants would be fine. Around Levels 10+, Mythic Variants should be fine.

4. You can also give out negative Variant Effects

Some Pokemon have flaws or penalties that can be expressed through Variant Effects, however it should be clear that these Variant Effects can either be improved into a positive one over time or can be outright removed, given enough investment. This could be a fear of Ghost Pokemon and needing a Command Check when near one.

5. All Variant Effects should be equally distributed and equal-ish in power

If something is accessible to one player, it should be accessible to all players in the party (Eventually). Treat these as you would magic items for sake of availability. If you create Variant Effects at all, Basic should be the most common while Advanced are rare and Mythic should only be for very rare Pokemon or during the end game.

6. Consider the frequency Variant Effects are given out

If the Effects are given to almost everything, the Players will expect them to be on everything, otherwise the ones who don't have an effect will be weaker than the ones who do. If everything is special, nothing is. We suggest that Variant Effects be infrequently given out to likely 10% of total Pokemon in order to keep their unique nature. Additionally their effects shouldn't be so wild that those without these effects can't compete. Though it is important that Variant Effects are accessible to all Pokemon, so with an adequate amount of effort invested into a Pokemon, they should be able to become stronger and gain an effect this way so they're not inherently weaker.

What's the difference between a Variant Effect and an Ability?

Not much. They're formatted pretty much the exact same way as an Ability or Feature. Variant Effects are just mechanical terms that describe random things a GM would give to a Pokemon to make them special. It serves as a rubric for how they can be given out and how their power is measured. It could easily be made as a custom homebrew Ability instead.

Basic Variant Effect Examples

Golden Egg

Static

Effect: Whenever this Pokemon is Trained, they gain +1 Golden Egg Counter. When using the Mender Capability, they may expend a Golden Egg Counter to instead fully heal them.

Context- This Chansey was raised by a wealthy family in an affluent town and kept for their medicinal marvels.

Avian Magus

Static

Effect: The user loses the Wielder (Melee) capability and instead gains the Wielder (Arcane) capability. The user's Damaging Attacks may be used as a Weapon Attack. If done this way, they are treated as Special Attacks instead and have their Range replaced with their equipped Weapon. The user's Attack and Special Attack Base Stats are swapped.

Context- This Sirfetch'd has been trained in the runic arts by a magic user and has abandoned its lance leek in favor of a staff and runic shield.

Phasmophobia

Static

Effect: The user resists Ghost Type Attacks by an additional Step. The user's Damaging Attacks are resisted by Ghost Type Enemies by an additional step. While a Ghost Type is within 5m of the user, they suffer -2d6 to all Skill Checks.

Context - This Rockruff was tormented by a Haunter after being kidnapped, leading to an intense fear of them and an inability to attack with full ferocity.

Shining Sandcastle

Static

Effect: Connection - Flash. The user has the Glow Capability.

Context- Some kid left a flashlight on the beach when this Sandyghost was born. When it evolved into a Palossand it kept the flashlight as a sentimental gift and can somewhat manipulate it.

Vitalizing Aroma

Static

Effect: Combatants within 3m of this pokemon have a +3 bonus to Save Checks if they're affected by the Drowsy Affliction.

Context- This Bayleef has a special type of spicy aroma that tends to keep people awake.

Advanced Variant Effect Examples

Golden Egg

Scene- Standard Action

Target: An Adjacent Ally

Effect: The user expends a Golden Egg Counter, then the Target restores 5 Ticks of Hit Points or is cured of all Status Afflictions.

Bonus: Whenever this Pokemon is Trained, they gain +1 Golden Egg Counter. When using the Mender Capability, they may expend a Golden Egg Counter to instead fully heal them.

Context- Given more bonding with their Trainer who is a medic, they've reached the highest bond with their Trainer. They've learned how to handle their eggs in combat and bestow them to injured allies.

Cat-pitalist

Scene x2- Free Action

Trigger: The user misses an Attack against all Targets

Effect: The user's Trainer may expend \$500 to have the user reroll the Triggering Attack without any Accuracy Modifiers. If the Attack is a Critical Hit, they must expend another \$500.

Context - This litten was an urban street rat, stealing coins and giving them to merchants in exchange for food. Old habits die hard, as they now expect payment whenever they do well in combat. This behavior can be removed if trained well enough.

Decaying Body

Scene x2- Free Action

Trigger: The user is hit with a Damaging Attack

Effect: A Number of Stealth Rock Hazards may be created in adjacent spaces equal to the number of Ticks of damage dealt by the Triggering Attack.

Context- This Golem has a weaker body and tends to crumble whenever it's attacked

Rushing Lava

Static

Effect: Connection - Rollout. The user may use Dash Attacks as if they were Fire Type. When taking an Ability, the user may choose Quick Curl, as if it were on their Pokedex's Ability List.

Context- This Quilava likes to roll around and perform rush attacks, having been trained by a Rider

Mythic Variant Effect Examples

Golden Egg

Scene- Standard Action

Target: An Adjacent Ally

Effect: The user expends a Golden Egg Counter, then the Target restores 5 Ticks of Hit Points or is cured of all Status Afflictions. If the Target was Fainted, they are also revived when restoring Hit Points this way

Bonus: Whenever this Pokemon is Trained, they gain +2 Golden Egg Counter. When using the Mender Capability, they may expend a Golden Egg Counter to instead fully heal them.

Context- Now a Blissey, the Campaign has reached the end stages where they met a Ho-Oh and they have blessed this Pokemon, making their golden eggs revitalize those who are even fainted.

Frozen Witch

Scene- Swift Action

Target: An Enemy within 5m

Effect: The Target gains a Hexed Coat. Each time a Hexed Enemy is hit with an Ice or Ghost Type Attack, they have a -2 Modifier to their next Save Check. The Hexed Coat is expended when the Target would cure the Chilled or Cursed Affliction in order to not cure it instead.

Context- The Party captured a Froslass in an abandoned tundra woods rumored to have a deadly witch who curses those who trespass.

Lava Mine

At-Will- Swift Action

Effect: Create a 2x2 Zone within 3m that contains a Lava Mine Hazard. Whenever this Hazard is moved onto by an Enemy, it triggers and is then destroyed. Enemies that Trigger this hazard lose two Ticks of Hit Points and become Burned.

Context- This Armarouge has an expanded armory kit that allows their cannon to shoot out lava mines that explode on impact. They gained this after the Trainer created a high tech upgrade in their downtime specifically for this Pokemon.

Runic Prison

At-Will- Swift Action

Effect: Create a 2x2 Zone within 3m that contains an Arcane Hazard. Whenever an Enemy ends their Turn on this Hazard, it triggers. Enemies that Trigger this Hazard have any Special Attack they use during their next Turn resisted by an additional Damage Step. If they have a Mental Affliction, it also cannot be cured at the end of that Turn.

Bonus: Whenever the user causes an Enemy with a Mental Affliction to become Trapped, they become affected by the effects of an Arcane Hazard until the end of their next Turn.

Context- This Runerigus was found in an ancient crypt of a powerful spellcaster and was known to set arcane traps.

Solar Infusion

Scene- Swift Action

Condition: The Weather is Sunny

Effect: Choose an Effect to apply:

- » The User's next Special Attack has the Sureshot Keyword
- » The User is cured of a Status Affliction
- » The User gains two Ticks of Temporary Hit Points

Context- This Espeon has a special connection to the sun, loving to sunbathe and their Trainer is a Fire Specialist. The hot conditions allowed for the Espeon to adapt and gain solace and power from the sun.



Minions

How long did it take you to stat your Pokemon or your Trainer? Imagine doing that for every session. To resolve this, I've created a special enemy template known as a Minion. **A Minion is a Pokemon or Trainer that is extremely barebones and can be generated quickly on the spot** to provide a challenge without needing to build it per the rules, nor look at any other documentation. It is a barebones approximation of a character build that is enough to challenge players without them knowing it took you a minute to make.

I highly recommend that most Enemies start as a Minion Template, only deviating if they need to be more special such as a recurring character, boss or central asset of a scene. You can always fully stat an Enemy if desired, but this method is a lot more lightweight and meant for quick creation. Speaking of which, we've made a tool specifically for quick generation. Click [here](#) to view it.

When creating a Minion, follow the steps below. **You do not follow standard Level Progression for Minions.**

- 1. Choose the Species** - The first thing you obviously do is choose what the Minion will be. It could be a Human or a Pokemon. The only things that don't change, if you choose a Pokemon, are their Skills, Capabilities and their Typing. Everything else is overwritten by Minion rules below.
- 2. Choose their Skills** - Next, you choose two Skills. One Skill will be treated as a 5d6 (or 6d6 if the Minion is Rank 3+) and one will be treated as 1d6. You can always estimate what their Skill Ranks would be if it becomes relevant in the session, but this helps determine their strength and weakness at a baseline without thinking too much. You can also just use their default Skills and choose one to be Trained.
- 3. Choose their Stats.** When creating a Minion, determine what Rank it is approximately, which will determine its Stat Values. Then, choose one Stat to be Strong, and two Stats to be Weak, the rest will be their Base Value. The section on the next page shows what Stats each Rank are. This allows you to adjust the minion based on what they are, such as an Onix being good at defense. (Their CS can still be adjusted but they do not get Level-Up Stats or Stats)
- 4. Choose their Attack List.** In a further section there will be a Table with various pools of attacks, divided by category and subdivided by Rank. Minions may choose two different Attack Pools, then gain up to four total attacks from those pools for which they qualify. For instance, if they chose the Physical Electric Pool and were Rank 2, they could pick the Rank 1 or 2 Pool. If a pool has-- listed, there are no new attacks for that Attack Pool for that Rank.
- 5. Choose their Trait (Optional).** You can stop at Step 4 and battle with them as is, however you can also grant them Traits and Perks to better suit the type of role it has in combat from a tactical lens. These are most equivalent to Pokemon Roles or Abilities but are boiled down to create variation in enemy design. Any Minion can be given a Pokemon Role instead, but this expands your options so your Players will always have the chance to face something fresh. If you choose to give them a Pokemon Role, they do not gain Stats from it, only benefiting from the effect.
- 6. Grant them a Perk(s) (Optional)** There is a list of a few Perks on the next page that you can add to a Minion in order to alter it and give it some individuality despite not being fully stattd. Think of Perks as your lever of balance and complexity.

Minion Stat Block

When creating a Minion, you will choose their Rank, 1 Strong Stat, and 2 Weak Stats. The chart below will determine their "Total" Stat Value for that Stat. This can, of course, cause it be affected by CS, but the Minion will not be affected by normal Levelup Stats or their species Base Stat in return. When determining a Minion's Rank, the range below is a rough estimate of what Rank they would be based on what Level they approximately would be if they were statted normally.

Stat Rank	Pokemon Level Equivalent	Trainer Level Equivalent
Rank 1	Level 1- 15	Level 1-3
Rank 2	Level 16- 30	Level 4- 6
Rank 3	Level 31- 50	Level 7- 10
Rank 4	Level 51- 75	Level 11- 15
Rank 5	Level 76+	Level 16+

	Total Hit Points (Not HP Stat)			Other Stats (Atk, Def, Sp Atk, Sp Def, Spd)		
Rank	Base	Strong	Weak	Base	Strong	Weak
1	45	60	30	5	10	1
2	75	100	50	10	20	5
3	100	150	75	15	30	5
4	150	200	100	20	40	10
5	175	250	125	25	50	10

Minion Perks

As a GM, you can give an Enemy literally anything for the ease of statting or for the sake of engaging Encounters. But some people may need permission to adjust things or else it feels like you're cheating against the players. If desired, you can use any number of Perks below to adjust a Minion to grant it more flexibility.

Standard Minion - You may choose any aspects from the Pokemon Minion's Pokedex to grant it as if it were a normal statted Pokemon. This could be learning an Attack on its Levelup or Tutor List, gaining an ability or having a role instead of a trait. For Trainer Minions, this could be having a Feature from a Class they could have qualified for, such as being able to use the Commander Feature.

Alpha Minion - You may grant them an extra turn per Round (and another set of actions for it), or you may grant them an extra HP Bar as if they were a boss template, but nothing else applies from boss rules.

Adept Minion - You may do one any of the following. Grant them an additional Trait. Grant them an additional Strong Stat. Apply an Attack Pool from one higher Rank than they are statted as. Gain an additional Attack Pool for which they qualify.

Minion Attack Pools

When Statting a Minion, at this point you should have given them a Rank. You may then select up to two Attack Pools and grant them any number of Attacks from it that are their Rank or under, however they cannot exceed 4 Total Attacks chosen between all selected pools.

There are two tables of Attack Pools, one featuring **Typed Attack Pools** and another featuring **Themed Attack Pools**. For instance, the Typed Attack Pool could have a pool named Electric Special, that can grant Thunder or Shock Wave. But the Themed Attack Pool can have a pool named "Beams", which could grant Ice Beam and Signal Beam.

Note - Outside of Rank prerequisites, there are no other prerequisites for taking an Attack Pool, so please use GM Discretion to distribute Attacks that make sense for that Pokemon. If there were other prerequisites it'd need you to look up more information to see if they qualify and the goal is to streamline fast character generation, so prerequisites are removed for the sake of flexibility. This can enable you to give Pokemon thematic moves that make sense for their context but aren't codified in the rules, such as giving an Onix Flamethrower, but should not be used to optimize for type coverage or for shock value such as giving Draco Meteor to a Nuzleaf, despite being legal.

Typed Attack Pools				
Name	Rank 1+	Rank 2+	Rank 3+	Rank 4
Bug Physical	Fell Stinger, Fury Cutter	Bug Bite, Insect Cleave, Skitter Smack	X-Scissor, Lunge	Giga Leech, Lance Stinger, Megahorn
Bug Special	Dull Drone, Struggle Bug	Signal Beam, Silver Wind, Web Shot	Bug Buzz, Signal Beam	Powder Storm, Silver Cyclone
Bug Status	String Shot	Powder, Rage Powder	Heal Order, Infestation, Sticky Web	Locus Swarm, Pheromone Haze, Spider Web
Dark Physical	Bite, Thief	Feint Attack, Night Slash, Payback	Ambush, Crunch, Lash Out	Power Trip, Punishment
Dark Special	Dark Waves, Sabotage	Backlash, Shadow Snare, Snarl	Dark Pulse, Siphon Life	Chaos Strike, Lunar Beam, Shadow Bolt
Dark Status	Fake Tears, Flatter, Taunt	Gash, Torment, Savage Roar	Cackle, Memento, Snatch	New Moon, Ripping Abyss
Dragon Physical	Dragon Dash	Breaking Swipe, Dragon Claw, Dragon Tail	Dragon Hammer, Rending Swipe	Dragon Axe, Outrage
Dragon Special	Dragon Breath, Spitfire	Breath Blast, Twister	Dragon Pulse, Mystic Aura, Scorching Breath	Draco Meteor, Scorched Earth
Dragon Status	Dragon Dance, Dragon Spirit	Dragon Rage, Imposing Stare	Draconic Roar, Dragon Force	Draconic Aura, Primal Storm
Electric Physical	Static Jolt	Thunder Punch, Thunder Spear	Volt Crush, Wild Charge	Plasma Bolt, Plasma Fists, Plasma Tail
Electric Special	Thunder Shock	Charge Beam, Shock Wave, Volt Switch	Discharge, Thunderbolt	Electro Shot, Lightning Lance, Thunder
Electric Status	Charge, Thunder Wave	Electric Terrain, Eerie Impulse	Ion Capture, Ion Deluge	Magnetic Flux, Plasma Storm, Thunderstorm

Typed Attack Pools				
Name	Rank 1+	Rank 2+	Rank 3+	Rank 4
Fairy Physical	Snuggle	Star Slash, Love Bite	Play Rough, Spirit Break	Glitter Bomb, Sparkling Slam
Fairy Special	Disarming Voice, Fairy Wind	Alluring Voice, Draining Kiss, Enchanting Aria	Dazzling Gleam, Misty Eruption, Spellbind	Light of Ruin, Moonblast, Starlight Spark
Fairy Status	Baby-Doll Eyes, Charm, Sweet Kiss	Aromatic Mist, Fae Blessing, Misty Terrain	Floral Healing, Moonlight, Moral Support	Fey Storm, Glittering Mist, Misty Guard
Fighting Physical	Karate Chop, Mach Punch, Rock Smash	Low Sweep, Revenge, Vital Throw	Brick Break, Drain Punch, Jump Kick	Close Combat, Hammer Arm, Superpower
Fighting Special	Force Bullet, Vacuum Wave	Aura Blast	Aura Sphere, Pressure Point	Aura Burst, Focus Blast
Fighting Status	Bulk Up, Concentration	Coaching, Quick Guard	Adrenaline Boost, Chakra Block, Detect	Aura Tempest, Intense Aura
Fire Physical	Fire Claw, Flame Charge	Fire Fang, Fire Punch, Flame Wheel	Blaze Kick, Flame Rush, Temper Flare	Flare Blitz, Firestorm
Fire Special	Ember, Incinerate	Fire Spin, Flame Burst, Twin Flames	Flamethrower, Lava Plume, Mystical Fire	Fire Blast, Heat Wave, Overheat
Fire Status	Kindle, Will-o-Wisp	Fire Wall, Heat Veil, Wildfire	Lava Armor	Blazing Sun, Sunny Day
Flying Physical	Peck	Aerial Ace, Quick Strike, Wing Attack	Acrobatics, Drill Peck, Wind Blades	Aerial Combat, Brave Bird
Flying Special	Gust	Aerial Cutter, Concussive Burst, Gale Force	Air Slash, Cyclone	Feather Storm, Razor Wind, Hurricane
Flying Status	Feather Dance, Whirlwind	Defog, Molt Feathers, Tailwind	Roost, Tempest, Wind Wall	Heavy Winds, Wind Shift, Windstorm
Ghost Physical	Astonish, Shadow Sneak	Devious Strike, Shadow Punch, Shadow Claw	Spirit Shackle, Vengeance	Phantom Fury, Wrathful Blitz
Ghost Special	Haunted Breeze	Ghostly Scream, Ominous Wind, Soul Drain	Hex, Shadow Ball	Spectral Storm
Ghost Status	Confuse Ray, Spite	Haunting Aura, Malice, Night Shade	Curse, Nightmare, Poltergeist	Dark Fog, Deception, Shadow Realm
Grass Physical	Leafage, Vine Whip	Bullet Seed, Grassy Glide, Razor Leaf	Leaf Blade, Petal Blizzard, Seed Bomb	Power Whip, Solar Blade, Wood Hammer
Grass Special	Absorb	Leaf Tornado, Mega Drain, Magical Leaf	Energy Ball, Floral Burst, Giga Drain	Leaf Storm, Chloroblast, Solar Beam
Grass Status	Burn Powder, Sleep Powder, Stun Spore	Grass Whistle, Grassy Terrain, Ingrain	Aromatherapy, Leech Seed, Synthesis	Pollen Storm, Spore, Wild Growth
Ground Physical	Earth Shard, Tremor	Bulldoze, Sand Tomb	Dual Quake, Landslide, Stomping Tantrum	Earthquake, Headlong Rush, Tectonic Burst
Ground Special	Mud Hurl, Mud Slap	Mud Bomb, Mud Shot	Earth Power, Quicksand, Scorching Sands	Shifting Soil
Ground Status	Mud Sport, Sand Attack, Spikes	Dust Cloud, Sand Pit, Sandy Terrain	Rototiller, Shore Up, Sinkhole	Dust Storm, Dusty Day, Terraform

Typed Attack Pools				
Name	Rank 1+	Rank 2+	Rank 3+	Rank 4
Ice Physical	Ice Shard	Ice Fang, Ice Punch	Avalanche, Crystal Slash, Frozen Rush	Arctic Quake, Ice Hammer, Icicle Storm
Ice Special	Powder Snow	Aurora Beam, Frost Breath, Icy Wind	Frost Blast, Ice Beam	Blizzard, Frost Typhoon
Ice Status	--	Frozen Terrain, Haze, Mist	Aurora Veil, Cleansing Aurora	Frostbite, Hail, Snowstorm
Normal Physical	Tackle, Pound, Scratch	Crush Claw, Fury Swipes, Headbutt	Body Slam, Retaliate, Slash	Double-Edge, Head Charge, Horn Drill
Normal Special	Echoed Voice	Burning Light, Starbeam, Swift	Hyper Voice, Prismatic Shot, Radiant Beam	Boomburst, Hyper Beam
Normal Status	Captivate, Focus Energy, Helping Hand	Assist, Double Team, Work Up	Heal Bell, Hold Hands, Noble Roar	Blinding Radiance, Recover, Solstice Dance
Poison Physical	Poison Dart, Poison Sting	Cross Poison, Poison Fang, Poison Tail	Assassinate, Poison Jab	Gunk Shot
Poison Special	Acid Spray, Toxin Splash	Sludge, Smog, Venoshock	Clear Smog, Numbing Venom, Sludge Bomb	Sludge Wave
Poison Status	Poison Gas, Toxic Spikes, Poison Powder	Smog Cloud, Toxic, Venom Drench	Acid Armor, Corrosive Gas, Gastro Acid	Acid Rain, Blighted Touch, Toxic Mist
Psychic Physical	Psy Bolt	Cognition Strike, Force Dash, Psycho Cut	Force Punch, Psychic Fangs, Zen Headbutt	Mind Crush, Mind Flay, Psycho Slash
Psychic Special	Confusion	Psybeam, Psywave	Expanding Force, Extrasensory, Psychic	Future Sight, Stored Power
Psychic Status	Calm Mind, Cosmic Power, Hypnosis	Light Screen, Psychic Terrain, Reflect	Barrier, Heal Pulse, Imprison	Kinesis, Psionic Surge, Psychic Storm
Rock Physical	Accelerock, Rock Throw, Terra Charge	Rock Tomb, Smack Down	Ancient Strike, Rock Slide, Terra Burst	Head Smash, Stone Edge
Rock Special	Stygian Stone	Ancient Power, Crystal Rupture, Power Gem	Geode Beam, Gleaming Ore	Crystal Cyclone, Crystal Prison, Meteor Beam
Rock Status	Stealth Rock	Crystalize, Rock Polish	Fossilize, Tar Shot	Diamond Dust, Sandstorm, Wide Guard
Steel Physical	Bullet Punch, Slice	Gear Grind, Metal Swipe, Smart Strike	Gyro Ball, Iron Blade, Iron Head	Iron Tail, Kinetic Strike
Steel Special	Alloy Beam	Magnet Bomb, Magnetic Pulse, Mirror Shot	Flash Cannon, Plasma Beam	Ferrous Flash, Steel Beam
Steel Status	Iron Spikes	Iron Defense, Metal Sound	Gear Up, Iron Coating	Magnetic Surge, Metallurgy
Water Physical	Aqua Jet	Aqua Cutter, Fin Swipe, Flip Turn	Aqua Tail, Razor Shell, Waterfall	Geyser Surge, Riptide
Water Special	Bubble, Water Gun	Bubblebeam, Water Pulse, Whirlpool	Muddy Water, Scald, Surf	Hydro Pump
Water Status	Water Sport	Aqua Ring, Life Dew, Steam Cloud	Aqua Infusion, Soak	Hydro Cleanse, Rainy Day, Torrential Typhoon

Themed Attack Pools				
Name	Rank 1+	Rank 2+	Rank 3+	Rank 4
Beam Kit	Alloy Beam, Concentration, Lock-On	Charge Beam, Signal Beam, Starbeam	Ice Beam, Plasma Beam, Radiant Beam	Hyper Beam, Lunar Beam, Solar Beam
Benevolent Kit	Helping Hand	Coaching, Assist	Fae Blessing, Hold Hands, Moral Support	--
Bladed Kit	Cut, Slice, Sharpen	False Swipe, Gash, Swords Dance	Leaf Blade, Iron Blade, Slash	Solar Blade
Chaotic Kit	Fake Tears, Metronome, Taunt	Flatter, Snatch, Torment	Cackle, Psycho Shift	--
Commanding Kit	Growl, Howl, Roar	Draconic Roar, Noble Roar, Savage Roar	Glare, Mean Look, Swagger	Instruct
Defensive Kit	Harden	Amnesia, Iron Defense	Counter, Mirror Coat	Magic Coat
Fist Kit	Comet Punch, Mach Punch, Power-Up Punch	Fire Punch, Ice Punch, Sucker Punch, Thunder Punch	Drain Punch, Mega Punch	Dynamic Punch, Focus Punch, Plasma Fists
Guardian Kit	Block, Taunt	Quick Guard	Crafty Shield, Wide Guard	Shell Shelter
Hazard Kit	Spikes, Iron Spikes, Toxic Spikes	Poison Gas, Stealth Rock, Smokescreen	Dust Cloud, Sinkhole	Terraform
Healing Kit	--	Heal Pulse, Recover	Aromatherapy, Heal Bell, Refresh	--
Innocent Kit	Charm, Play Nice	Baby-Doll Eyes, Lovely Kiss, Sweet Kiss	Attract, Tearful Look	--
Offensive Kit	Bulk Up, Hone Claws, Sharpen	Focus Energy, Swords Dance	Adrenaline Boost, Feint	--
Psionic Kit	Calm Mind, Confusion, Psybolt	Barrier, Imprison, Psybeam	Kinesis, Psychic, Telekinesis	--
Rage Kit	Dragon Rage, Fury Attack, Rage	--	Ancestral Fury, Lash Out, Stomping Tantrum	Outrage, Thrash
Spectral Kit	Confuse Ray, Will-o-Wisp	Curse, Hex, Shadow Claw	Haunting Aura, Poltergeist	Destiny Bond, Grudge
Tactical Kit	Taunt, Work Up	Double Team, Feint	Detect, Laser Focus, Lock-On	Endure, Protect
Warding Kit	--	Light Screen, Reflect, Lucky Chant, Safeguard	--	--
Web Kit	String Shot, Web Shot	Electroweb, Sticky Web	Spider Web, Silk Trap	Silk Weave, Toxic Threads

Minion Example Scenario - Haunted Manor

The Players decide to investigate rumors of a haunted manor which I had not prepared. I decide to have them greeted by a butler **Mimikyu**, who telepathically speaks to the players about a terrible Mismagius who is keeping them all trapped. It guides them through and eventually they'll find a room full of impromptu statted minions, including a **Mismagius**, a bunch of **Gastly** and **Shuppet**. Good thing Mimikyu helps them!

Mimikyu - Rank 2, Strong ATK, Weak HP + SPD, Helping Hand, Coaching, Assist, Shadow Claw

Gastly - Rank 1, Strong SP ATK, Poison Gas, Confuse Ray, Poison Powder, Underling Trait

Shuppet - Rank 2, Strong ATK, Weak HP + DEF, Feint Attack, Torment, Flatter, Taunt, Regeneration Trait

Mismagius - Rank 3, Strong SP ATK, Weak DEF + ATK, Metronome, Cackle, Shadow Ball, Soul Drain, 2 HP Bars + 2 Turns, Siphon Trait (Can Target fainted Gastly)

Minion Traits

This can be considered an **expanded version of Pokemon Roles** that are only available to GMs to help with designing unique encounters. Each Trait is designed where an Enemy has certain positive effects that determine its tactical role, but it can be countered by the Players if played around wisely.

Traits should be used scarcely and not applied to every Minion or every Pokemon in an Encounter, lest it get overwhelming or stale. By a rule of thumb, usually include no more than two Trait Types in a single Scene. (Feel free to make custom Traits for unique enemies!) You can also apply these to non-Minions if you wish to have them as a gimmick to design around!

Note - Players should be able to visibly tell what a Minion's Trait is if they succeed an Analyze Maneuver. For instance, they could notice that an Electrode is sparking energy and looks unstable enough to have the Explosive Trait, or a Hitmonchan's stance lets them know it is reactive enough to strike back with the Reactive Trait. The goal of Minion Traits is to provide an enemy with a distinct strategy where they can analyze the field and go, "Okay, the Commanding Oranguru is giving more actions to the Sceptile, we need to prioritize it"

Armored

This Minion starts the Scene with Temporary Hit Points equal to their Defense Stat or Special Defense of your choice. This Temp HP is ignored by Attacks that match the other category. When this Temp HP is depleted, they become Vulnerable until the end of the next Round and Weakened until the end of their next Turn.

Examples - A Rhyperior has formidable defenses and is very sturdy.

Aura

This Minion provides a benefit or penalty to all Combatants within 2m of them while they're within this range, to the GM's Discretion

Examples - A Banette has an aura of terror that prevents Cursed from being cured while nearby.

Bolstering

At the end of the Round, this Minion gains some sort of benefit, to the GM's Discretion. If they didn't take damage during the Round, it is gained twice. Whatever is gained is uncapped if applicable.

Examples - A Magmortar sits in a lake of lava and frequently absorbs lava to replenish it, gaining a Tick of Temporary HP which can stack on itself, ignoring rules.

Contagious

This Minion has a negative effect of some kind applied to it that cannot be cured during the Scene. At the end of the Round, all Combatants adjacent to this Minion suffer an effect similar to the chosen negative effect.

Examples - A haunted mimikyu causes adjacent enemies to be Cursed but it's Cursed for the scene. A Lopunny has burning rage that can set nearby enemies on fire but they also suffer from the burn.

Commanding

At any point, this Minion may grant any Ally within 3m an additional Reaction or Shift Action. If they're Stat Rank 2+, they may also grant a Swift Action. If they're Stat Rank 4+, they may also grant a Standard Action. This Pokemon cannot grant Action types they've used this Round, nor can they use it for the rest of the Round and a Combatant can only be Targeted by this Trait once per Round.

Examples - A Machop is commanding its prodigy Machoke and helping it in battle

Conduit

Choose an Ally. The chosen Ally can originate effects as if they were in this Minion's occupying space. Whenever this Minion faints, the chosen Ally becomes Vulnerable until the end of the Round.

Examples - A Gengar has a misty shroud full of Conduit Gastly that it can originate Smog from, but defeating them drains its energy.

Devoted

Choose an Ally. This Minion cannot use Attacks or Maneuvers on any Combatant other than that Ally or an Enemy that Attacked them this Round. In addition, their Status Attacks may ignore Frequency rules and they ignore Versatile restrictions. When the chosen ally Faints, this Minion will either attempt to flee or will become Provoked by the enemy who caused them to faint for the rest of the scene.

Examples - A Minun stays close to the boss electivire and uses helping hand on them frequently.

Distracting

At the end of this Minion's Turn, all Enemies within 3m of them must pass an opposed Skill Check or else they become Trapped by them and Provoked if they failed by more than 2 Successes. The Skills used in this check depend on the flavor of how the Minion is getting their attention, usually opposed by Focus.

Examples - An imposing shiftry has a scary aura that makes it hard for the players to look elsewhere, resulting in an Intimidate check opposed by their focus. A Cofagrigus's shadow tendrils lock Enemies in place if they fail an opposed Occult Edu Check.

Explosive

When this Minion faints, all Combatants within a Burst X range, where X is equal to half their Stat Rank (Rounded Up), must perform an Acrobatics or Intuition Check. The CR for this is equal to 1 plus their Rank. On a Failure, something to your discretion occurs.

Examples - An Electrode causes those hit by the explosion to be hit by a DB 10 Electric Special Attack. A Vileplume causes an eruption of pollen, causing anyone who fails to become Poisoned.

Healer

At the end of this Pokemon's Turn, choose an Ally within X meters to restore Hit Points equal to the user's Stat Rank multiplied by 10, or 20 if they expend their Standard Action. X is equal to their Stat Rank. If the chosen Ally was Fainted, this Revives them. This Minion cannot use Damaging Attacks.

Examples - A swarm of solosis cluster around an Alakazam and heal it over time.

Invulnerable

This Minion's cannot lose Hit Points or take Damage while a condition is met. When this condition is no longer met, they become Vulnerable and Weakened until the end of their next Turn.

Examples - A massive claydol construct is super charging baltoys but drops the charge when it faints. A Rotom can't take damage while they're within 3m of a Generator, which causes the players to smash it.

Launcher

At the start of the Round, choose a number of spaces within 10m equal to triple this Minion's Stat Rank. At the end of the Round, they must use a Basic Attack against all Combatants in these spaces as a Free Action. If the Minion moves from the space they started in that Round, this effect does not resolve.

Examples - A Magmortar stays in the backline and shoots magma

Lurker

Until they take a non-Movement Action, this Minion cannot be seen and is Untargetable. This Minion's Attacks have Unstoppable while they're Untargetable by all Targets. If a Combatant ends their movement within 2m of this Minion, they may perform a Skill Check to reveal them and they ignore this Trait's effects.

Examples - A Grovyle is hiding in a tree and lashes out at the first unknowing enemy. But a Trainer spots them with a successful Perception Check opposed by their Stealth.

Parasitic

Once per Round as a Free Action, whenever a Combatant within 3m restores Hit Points or gains Combat Stages, this Minion also benefits from the Effects. If the Minion is adjacent to them, they may gain it instead or ignore the Once per Round limit. This cannot be used if the Minion has an Affliction.

Examples - A Trevenant has a collection of roots that can steal the effects of a nearby Sableye attempting to use Nasty Plot.

Predatory

This Minion will always be Provoked by the Enemy with the lowest current Hit Points or the closest enemy that has a specific condition determined by GM Discretion. Enemies this Minion is Provoked by cannot apply Stat Evasion against this Minion.

Examples - A Garchomp always targets enemies that are currently Wounded. A Bishop assassin lays in waiting until someone drops below 50%.

Puglist

This Minion has a bonus to Damage Rolls against Adjacent Enemies and Damage Reduction against Adjacent Attacks equal to the number of Adjacent Enemies multiplied by 3, then multiplied by their Stat Rank.

Examples - A Rank 3 Hitmonchan is Flanked by 3 Enemies. Hitmonchan has 27 DR against their Attacks and a +27 bonus to Damage against them.

Reactive

Choose Adjacent or Ranged. Once per Round (or twice if they're Rank 3+), when this Minion is hit by an Attack from the chosen distance, they may use a Basic Attack as a Free Action against only the Attacker. This Minion is Vulnerable against all Attacks from the distance not chosen and cannot resist them.

Examples - A Hitmonchan can easily counter punch anyone who is next to them but can't dodge an Air Slash from a distant pidgeot.

Rebounder

Whenever this Minion is hit with an Attack, they gain a bonus to Damage Rolls for their next Attack this Round equal to the Damage they took. If their next Attack misses, the Target instead take Damage equal to half the Damage Roll Modifier gained this way.

Examples - A Sudowoodo stores energy and launches it back in its quick punches

Regeneration

Whenever this Minion faints, it turns into a [Breakable - Fragile] Hazard. At the end of each Round if this Hazard isn't destroyed, roll a d6. If the result is equal to or under their Stat Block Rank, they revive and are set to 2 Ticks of Hit Points.

Examples - A Grimer melts into a pile of sludge but reforms and revives after being ignored after absorbing nearby toxins.

Resonating

As a Full Action, or at the start of the Scene, create a Personal Depletion Clock of any Size. At the end of each Round, or if a condition is met according to GM Discretion, this Clock depletes. When this Clock is empty, it expires and something happens with an impact based on the Clock's size. While this Clock persists, all Attacks have Sureshot against them and they cannot use Actions.

Examples - A bunch of Kakuna are lingering in the trees and look like they'll evolve into Beedrill soon, creating a 2 Span Clocks. A few Sigilyph are channeling a ritual and the creature that is summoned depends on how many Spans were depleted in total amongst all of them (Even if it didn't complete)

Sacrificial

This Minion will always use the Intercept Maneuver whenever a non-Sacrificial Ally within 2m is Attacked, if able, but it becomes a Free Action. This Minion does not have the damage step increased by a step when intercepting.

Examples - A Garchomp has a horde of Gabite that will protect it with their lives.

Sharpshooter

This Minion's Movement Value becomes 2. At the start of each Round, as a Reaction, choose an Enemy within 8m. At the end of the Round if they're still within 8m, they may use an Attack on them as a Free Action but any of their Allies adjacent to the Minion or Target may become the Target instead if desired.

Examples - An Octillery sits on a lookout post and snipes below.

Siphon

This Minion can use a Swift Action to Target an Adjacent Combatant and gain +1 CS in a Stat of their choice and a Tick of Temporary Hit Points. Combatants can only be Targeted this way once per Scene. The Minion can only Target a specific type of Combatant with this Trait, based on GM Discretion.

Examples - A Spiritomb can Target Combatants that are Fainted, Suppressed or Cursed. A Magmortar can siphon power from slugma that are wading through the lava lake and other Fire Types.

Thrasher

This Minion is always Enraged and their Damaging Attacks have the Smite Keyword.

Examples - A Machop is enraged and is striking whoever provokes its anger.

Underling

This Minion's Stat Block is one Rank weaker than other Enemies in the Encounter. If it is lower than 1, it is treated as Rank 1 but they automatically faint when hit with a Damaging Attack that isn't resisted. Pokemon that use this Role tend to be easily replaceable and aren't the bulk of the encounter.

Examples - A nearby earthquake caused a bunch of underling diglett to pop up on the battlefield in a panic, their only job is throwing stealth rocks

Underling Minions

Whenever you want to throw a multitude of weak enemies that can easily be defeated, use the Underling Trait. They function similarly to minions in past versions and can pad encounters while still being a threat if ignored

Unstable

This Minion has a strange source of unstable power. At the end of this Minion's turn, roll a d20 Save Check. Each time they're hit with an Attack, they have a -2 penalty to their next roll for this Trait. On a 17+, a positive effect happens to the Minion. On a 5 or less, something negative happens to this Minion and those within 2m. On a 1 or less, something very negative happens.

Examples - A Clefable is blessed with moonlight energy and uses Metronome randomly. On a 5 or less, I roll until I get a damaging attack which attacks the user and those within 2m. On a 18+, I roll until I hit a positive Status Attack.

Vengeful

Whenever a non-Underling Ally Faints, the Minion gains +1 CS in their Strong Stat(s) and becomes Provoked by the one who caused them to Faint until the end of their next Turn.

Examples - A Bisharp retaliates and gets stronger when their pawniard ally faints.

Warded

Choose a Type. This Minion treats that Type as if it were Super Effective and is Vulnerable against Attacks of that Type, but every other Type is Resisted by an extra step. This Trait is disabled while they have a Mental Affliction or until the end of the Round if they're hit by an Attack of the chosen Type.

Examples - A Claydol is powered by a generator that grants it a shield that can be short circuited by Electric Attacks.



Creating a Type Shift

It is my subjective opinion that Regional Variants are the best gimmick Pokemon has made in the most recent generations when compared to other ideas they've had. Nothing breathes life into a world other than having Pokemon adapt to your setting and the intricacies of how they'd change to live in the environment. As such, I think the most exciting Pokemon Variant one may obtain is a **Type Shift Pokemon**, so in this section we'll go over how to create one and some examples.

1. Coming up with a Concept

Type Shifts should always be rooted within your world in order to have the most impact, always having a reason why they exist and why they're unique. When making a concept, start by selecting a Pokémon and envisioning a new habitat or region where it might have evolved differently due to local conditions. Consider how this environment would impact the Pokémon's appearance, abilities, and behavior.

For instance, imagine an icy tundra region where a typically Fire-type Pokémon has adapted to the cold, resulting in an Ice-type variant. This explains pokemon like Alolan Vulpix and Galarian Darumaka. Then, think about the new typing's impact on its design, moveset, and lore and how its physical features would change to reflect its new environment. Lastly, incorporate cultural elements from your region to enhance the Pokémon's backstory, making it feel like a natural part of the world. By combining environmental factors, design changes, and embedded lore, you can create compelling type shift ideas that bring a fresh perspective to beloved Pokémon. Below are some examples of Type Shift Concepts that could inspire you:

Example 1 - A great first example is the lore behind Hisuian Zorua. The Zorua species tended to be exiled from tribes due to their illusionary capabilities and trickster nature and due to the inability to survive in the Hisuian wilds, most of them perished. Their souls lingered in a new form of a Normal/Ghost Zorua instead of a Dark Type. Its behavior also changes to a much more heavy malice towards humanity as a result. This leads to the new Type Shift being grounded in the Hisui Region and fitting the world.

Example 2 - One Type Shift I've made for one of my Campaigns was for a Shinx that lived in a mountain full of dragon type Pokemon. Similarly to Zorua from the first example, they had issues surviving draconic predators until it adapted and gained a dragon-like form, becoming an Electric/Dragon Type. Since this shift, these Shinx have become prominent predators in the region, gaining even more power as the mountains were local to Zekrom.

2. Changing Stats

Now that you have the concept for your Type Shift, it's time to go through each aspect of the Pokemon and alter it based on their new form. For Stats, you don't have to do much, just alter the Base Stats based on their new Form. The new pokemon should always have the same Base Stat Total, just rearranged. For example, if you have a Scrafty that has mastered the shadows and mind manipulation, turning into a Dark/Psychic Pokemon, you could swap their Attack Base Stat with their Special attack and take some points out of defense and put it into Special Defense. When adjusting stats this way, no Stat should drop below 5 to prevent min-maxing.

3. Changing Capabilities

The next aspect of a Pokemon to adjust is to change their capability list based on the type they lost or gained. **Below are a few capabilities that you could grant or remove** from a pokemon based on the type they gained or lost. What they gain or lose would be dependent on the fluff.

Type	Capabilities
Bug	Climber, Flier, Threaded
Dark	Darkvision, Pack Mon
Dragon	Flier, Mountable
Electric	Glow, Magnetic
Fairy	Alluring, Mender
Fighting	Aura Reader
Fire	Glow, Heater
Flying	Quick, Flier, Mountable
Ghost	Flier, Phaser, Invisibility, Shadow Meld
Grass	Threaded
Ground	Burrower, Groundshaper, Tremorsense
Ice	Chilled
Normal	Quick, Tracker
Poison	Amorphous
Psychic	Teleporter, Telekinetic, Telepath, Empath, Mindlock, Premonition
Rock	Burrower, Groundshaper, Tremorsense
Steel	Breathless, Flier, Magnetic
Water	Swimmer, Gilled

4. Changing Abilities

Next you'll want to adjust the Ability list to remove Abilities that would no longer make sense in favor of Abilities that could fit their new form. Again, you may refer to the list below for some examples on Abilities you could grant but you should look through the Ability & Attack list for a full idea of Abilities you could grant. However be wary that some Abilities are signature Abilities and balanced due to only being on one species and designed around them. Don't grant abilities like Wallop to anyone since it's made for Tinkaton

Attack & Ability List.

Type	Ability Suggestions
Bug	Compound Eyes, Hyper Cutter, Shed Skin
Dark	Ambush, Dusk Body, Intimidate
Dragon	Anger Point, Conqueror, Regal Challenge
Electric	Electric Surge, Illuminate, Static
Fairy	Blessed Touch, Cute Tears, Gentle Vibe
Fighting	Defiant, Discipline, Scrappy
Fire	Drought, Flame Body, Solar Power
Flying	Blow Away, Gale Surge, Vanguard
Ghost	Cursed Body, Omen, Shadow Shield
Grass	Chlorophyll, Effect Spore, Flower Veil
Ground	Arena Trap, Dusty Guard, Sand Force
Ice	Frostbite, Snow Cloak, Solid Ice
Normal	Absorb Force, Courage, Vital Spirit
Poison	Corrosion, Poison Point, Stench
Psychic	Forewarn, Levitate, Magic Guard
Rock	Battle Armor, Dusty Guard, Sand Stream
Steel	Clear Body, Iron Barbs, Targeting System
Water	Damp, Rain Dish, Torrent

5. Changing Attack Pools

Almost done! The last step is adjusting the Attack Pool of the Pokemon based on what type it lost and what type it gained. Usually I go for the simple solution and remove all Attacks whose type they lost from their Levelup and Tutor Pool, then swap it with attacks of a similar nature to the new type. This could be as simple as swapping out Thunderbolt for Flamethrower. The Attack and Ability List mentioned in Step 4 will have a list of all Attacks you can curate. Alternatively what you could do is simply swap the Type of all Attacks to any new Type and change their effects accordingly.

Type Shift Example - Yetichamp

Step 1 - Yetichamp is an Ice/Fighting Variant of Machop that lives in an icy mountain in a deep cave and is an urban legend.

Step 2 - I don't want the stats changed drastically so I'll remove -3 Special Defense and grant it +2 HP and +1 Defense.

Step 3 - It's still Fighting type so it can keep most of its info but I'll give it Chilled and Naturewalk (Tundra), replacing (Urban)

Step 4 - I'll replace Bodyguard with Frostbite and Iron Fist with Anger Point since its yeti coded.

Step 5 - I don't change out too much but I'll grant it some additional Ice Type Attacks. I'll swap out Retaliate with Ice Hammer, Dual Chop with Avalanche, and Foresight with Ice Shard



Creating new Pokemon

1. The Concept

When making a fakemon, come up with a general concept of what you want. Usually this step is already done as you have a concept and you want to convert it to a fakemon but let's use Delta Bulbasaur from the Pokemon Insurgence fan game as an example of a concept you want to convert to a PTE Campaign.

2. The Base Stats

The Base Stats of your Pokemon is dependent on its evolution stages but if you're converting from a fangame, divide their video game stats by 10 and round up.

Example- Delta Bulbasaur has 45 HP which converts to 5 HP, 49 Attack which converts to 5, 49 Defense which converts to 5, 65 Sp Atk which converts to 7, 65 Sp Def which converts to 7 and 45 Speed which converts to 5. Its final Stats are 5 / 5 / 5 / 7 / 7 / 5, leading to a Base Stat Total (BST) of 34

If the Pokemon is a First Stage of (2-3) Total Pokemon, like Charmander or Taillow, the Average Base Stat Total (BST) should be between **30-35**. If the Pokemon is the second Stage of (3) Total Pokemon like Charmeleon or Nidorino, the Average BST should be between **35-45**. If the Pokemon is a Final Stage Evolution or has no Evolutions, its BST should be between **40-55**. If the Pokemon is a Pseudo-Legendary similar to Ultra Beasts or Paradox Pokemon, its BST should be between **55-60**. As a general note, each evolution should increase the BST by around 5-10 Points. Final Evolutions on the lower end of around 40-45 BST should have some sort of gimmick like how Smeargle is to contrast their lower stats.

Example: Fletchling has a BST of 30. Fletchinder has a BST of 38. Talonflame has a BST of 51. Spinarak has a BST of 30. Ariados has BST 40.

4. The Skill Information

The Rule Book should have information in the Skill Section on how Pokemon Skills work differently but just know there are three tiers you can set a Pokemon's skills, Inept, Proficient and Mastered. Anything not listed will be treated as Untrained. Pokemon usually have 1-3 Skills distributed as Proficient or Mastered and maybe 1-2 Skills listed as Inept. Remember that whatever you list under their Skills applies to everything of that species.

3. The Basic Information

After figuring out the Stats of your Pokemon, next is to decide their **Type, Abilities and Capabilities!**

For your Type, it should be fairly obvious what Type you're envisioning for them but when deciding keep in mind their weaknesses and resistances. Pokemon that are two weak types such as Grass/Ice will suffer from a lot of weaknesses compared to something stronger like Ghost/Dark. After all, Pokemon tend to be balanced around their type combination such as Ice Pokemon like Frosmoth getting the Ice Scales ability in the games.

For your Abilities, go through the Attacks & Abilities document and pick 4 Abilities that would make sense to add for the Pokemon you're creating. All non-Signature Abilities are balanced around the same power level so just pick what fits. If you want the Pokemon to be even more special, you could create a custom signature Ability as well that many Pokemon have such as Bronzong having the Sacred Bell Ability.

For your Capabilities, check through the list of Capabilities in the Rule Book and determine what would fit for your Pokemon. Start with Movement capabilities, seeing what type of movement your Pokemon would specialize in. Pokemon like Gligar wouldn't be slow or quick and would have the Glider Capability. Then think about Combat capabilities if any. Be wary however if you decide to homebrew a combat capability as the power level tends to be tricky, if you want to then just make it an ability instead. Lastly go through the Narrative capability list and see if there's anything that could apply to the Pokemon.

Example- Delta Bulbasaur has a typing of Fairy / Psychic in the game so that's already sorted out. For abilities, it has two options in the game of Psycho Call and Regenerator. I don't feel like making a custom ability so I give it the following options. Regenerator, Aroma Veil, Mental Force and Mystic Veil. For Capabilities, I don't think it gains anything special for Movement. For Combat, I give it Naturewalk (Forest) and Reach to account for its vines and Telekinetic because of its psychic powers. While I don't know how they are in the game, I take a guess and give it Mender for Narrative Capabilities, myself seeing its psychic powers as curative in nature

Example- The only thing I see Delta Bulbasaur being good in is the Focus Skill so I list that as Mastered. Under Proficient and Inept I list None because it's not really bad at anything or decent at anything else.

5. The Skill Information

Attack Pools and Ability options are often what make or break a Pokemon so follow this section to make sure your Pokemon is good.

Firstly, each species line has **4 Starting Attacks** that are learned at Level 1. These Attacks usually follow a pattern of one STAB Attack that matches their higher Attack Stat, one Normal Type Attack that preferably matches their higher Attack Stat, one Status Attack that is At-Will or EOT, and one flex slot. The flex slot is usually a second STAB Attack that matches their second type, another Status Attack or a STAB Attack that matches their lower Attack Stat.

Example- For actual Bulbasaur, its Starting Attacks are Absorb, Tackle, Leech Seed and Growl. Absorb is its STAB Attack of its higher Attack Stat. Tackle is their Normal Attack that makes the most sense for them. Leech Seed is their Status Attack and their Flex option is used for Growl. For Delta Bulbasaur I decide for its Attacks to be the following. Confusion, Fairy Wind, Tackle, Sweet Scent. The flex option in this case was a second STAB attack matching their Fairy Type.

Secondly, each Pokemon follows a standardized Level-up List, usually learning Attacks every increment of 4 Levels. On their Level Up List, 1st Stage Pokemon of 3 Stages have Attacks up to Level 40. 2nd Stage Pokemon of 3 Stages or 1st Stage Pokemon of 2 Stages have Attacks up to Level 50. Single Stage Pokemon or Final Stage Evolutions have Attacks up to Level 60. Additionally, each Pokemon gets an Evo (Evolution) Attack whenever they evolve. When thinking of type coverage, Pokemon should usually learn Attacks from 2-4 Types on their Level-Up List, prioritizing Attacks based on their Type. Attacks are learned in the following Levels, 4, 8, 12, 16, 20, 24, 28, 32, 36, 40, 45, 50, 55, 60.

Example: Bulbasaur has Attacks up to Level 40. Pinsir has Attacks up to level 60. Nidorino has Attacks up to Level 50 and has an Evo Attack.

When determining what Attacks you should put on a Level-Up List, use the following list for some examples.

Levels 4-20: Levels 4 and 8 should have other options that could have been given out as a Starting Attack. For example, Bulbasaur learns Toxin Splash at Level 4 which is their first Poison Type Attack. On Levels 12, 16 and 20, they should start to learn Attacks in Tier 1 that either are stronger versions of their starting Attacks or branch off in type coverage. For example, at Level 20, Bulbasaur learns Razor Leaf, being stronger than Absorb and at Level 16 they learn Take Down, a stronger version of Tackle.

Levels 24-40: On levels 24, 28 and 32 they should be upgrading their Attacks to Tier 2 in strength level. During this period they can learn stronger Status Attacks and Damaging Attacks around DB 6-9. For example, Ivysaur learns Body Slam at 36, being an alternative for Take Down and Synthesis which is a versatile recovery status attack. And while late, they learn Seed Bomb at 40, being a better option than Razor Leaf sometimes and is a ranged option.

Levels 45-60: On Levels 45+, they should start learning their Tier 3 Attacks as their best option for their type that makes sense to them along with some stronger Status Attacks as flex options. The DB for Damaging Attacks at this stage should be 9+. For example, Venusaur learns Solar Beam and Frenzy Plant, being strong Grass Attacks and Sludge Wave, being their best Poison Option. Lastly they get Worry Seed which can be a good Status option.

Example- For Delta Bulbasaur I do have a few options to pull from the actual game but I can divert from it to make a custom list. I decide to make their Level-Up list the following. Level 4 (Leech Seed), Level 8 (Hypnosis), Level 12 (Psybeam), Level 16 (Draining Kiss), 20 (Magical Leaf), 24 (Calm Mind), 28 (Dazzling Gleam), 32 (Psychic), 36 (Moonlight), 40 (Misty Terrain). Once they reach their evolutions the list will continue to Level 45 (Moonblast), 50 (Leaf Storm), 55 (Grassy Terrain), 60 (Psycho Boost). They'll also get two Evo Attacks. When they evolve to Ivysaur, they'll learn (Disarming Voice) and when they evolve to Venusaur they'll learn (Extrasensory).

Lastly, each Pokemon will have a Tutor Attack List filled with other Attacks they can learn outside of leveling up. This usually takes the longest to draft up but make sure to skim through the Attack & Ability doc for a total list of options. In our example I'll be pulling from the learnable TMs that Delta Bulbasaur can learn in order to fill up most of the list. It is tedious but you'll also have to separate based on the Attack's Tier. When you're done, the Tutor List should fulfill the following:

1. It should be around 30-50 Attacks being learnable across all Tiers
2. Damaging Attacks it can learn should be no more than 8 different Types for sake of coverage but no less than 4 different Types.
3. They should be able to learn a decent portion of Attacks from their corresponding Types, usually around 25% to 50%. Attacks on the Level-Up List would be natural to learn but those that would still fit should go to the Tutor List.

6. The Evolution Path

The next step is determining when your Pokemon evolves! This is fairly simple so follow the list below.

3 Stages: The Pokemon should first evolve around Level 15 or 20 unless their BST is fairly low, then it could evolve at Level 10. Low Level examples could include Azurill or Weedle. Standard Levels could include Charmander evolving into Charmeleon at Level 15. They should evolve into their final evolution at around Level 30-40. If their BST is low, it would be around Level 20-25. Low Level examples could include Weedle evolving into Beedrill. Standard Levels could include Charmeleon evolving into Charizard at Level 30.

2 Stages: The Pokemon should evolve around Level 20-40, depending on the BST of its evolution. Some Pokemon like Eevee can evolve earlier at Level 20 but if they're like Larvesta, they should evolve at a higher level like 30.

Example: For Delta Bulbasaur, he evolves into Delta Ivysaur at 15 and Delta Venusaur at 30, pretty standard

7. Other Information

Congrats! This step is easy, just note down its height, weight and diet along with other info like a Pokedex entry!



Handling Legendaries

As you may have noticed, there are no Legendary or Mythical Pokemon listed in the PTE Pokedex. Why? Because I didn't feel like making a baseline yet. It's at least 100 Pokemon. Legendary Pokemon will be fully tackled in the **"Path of the Divine"** Module, but until then you can follow the advice below if you want Legendary Pokemon to be a factor in your campaign. I am fully aware that Legendaries are very subjective in their implementation, but I have listed the [3 most common implementations](#) that have come to mind and how to add them below. **For these Examples, we will be using Entei.**

1. Raisable Legendaries

No guarantees, but the Pokedex in the future will likely be created with Legendaries as intended to be raised from the ground up. They can be encountered in later stages of development but being developed in stages allows for them to be raised as baby Pokemon as well. They will be similar to normal Pokemon but instead have 3 Stages of "Evolution" or maturity. If you need an example, think of Kubfu to Urshifu or the multiple forms of Zygarde. As a low level trainer you could have a 10% Zygarde Form that eventually evolves into 50% Origin Form, then 100% as its complete form. If you're doing this implementation, it is generally feasible that legendaries in your world can breed like anything else. When implementing this style of Legends, you'll need to do some groundwork based on what Legends your Players will encounter.

What you'll need for each Legend:

- 1. Standard Details** - At the moment we don't have Legendaries in the Dex so you'll have to craft an Ability List, Attack Pool and Capability list for each Legend you plan on using.
- 2. A Signature Attack** - This Attack will evolve alongside the Legendary depending on their Stage.
- 3. A Signature Ability** - Each Legend, on top of their normal Progression should get a Signature Ability that scales in power depending on their Stage.
- 4. A Signature Aura** - This doesn't have to be for all campaigns but some Legendary Pokemon have control over some domain of reality such as Dialga having control over time. You could possibly give them an Aura that scales in scope depending on their Stage. This could mostly be narratively powered instead of in combat

Stage 1 Legends

When creating a Stage 1 Pokemon, the Base Stat Total of the Pokemon should equal 40 in any combination. At Level 30, they evolve into their Second Stage. The power level of the Signature Attack should be around Tier 2.

Stage 2 Legends

When creating a Stage 2 Pokemon, the Base Stat Total of the Pokemon should equal 60 in any combination. At Level 50, they evolve into their Third Stage and should visually be what the Legend is by canon. The power level of the Signature Attack should be slightly above Tier 3.

Stage 3 Legends

When creating a Stage 3 Pokemon, the Base Stat Total of the Pokemon should be equal to 80 in any combination. The power level of the Signature Attack should definitely be above Tier 3. If it's a low frequency it should have a big impact on the Field or if it has the power of a Tier 3, it could be something used at an EOT Frequency.

The next page will list 3 Stage of a Raisable Entei

Entei [Stage 1]**Base Details**

HP- 8 | ATK 10 | DEF 5 | SP ATK 8 | SP DEF 5 | SPD 6

Ability Pool - Molten Ground, Flame Body, Regal Challenge, Rivalry

Capabilities - Quick, Mountable, Heater

Skills - Proficient Command, Athletics & Combat

Legendary Details**Raging Inferno** [Signature Attack]

EOT- Physical- Fire, 6, Ranged Blast 2- AC 3- DB 8

Effect: If the User is enraged, this Attack has the Smite Keyword. After Damage Calculations, the user becomes Enraged.

Infernal Mane [Signature Ability]

Static

Effect: Whenever the user would burn an Enemy, they cannot be cured of the Affliction via Save Checks.

Fiery Dominion [Signature Aura]

Effect: All Fire within 10m of the User may be extinguished as a Swift or Extended Action. As a Swift Action, the User may Target a Fire Hazard and expand it, creating 3 more adjacent to the Targeted Hazard.

Entei [Stage 2]**Base Details**

HP- 10 | ATK 14 | DEF 8 | SP ATK 10 | SP DEF 8 | SPD 10

Ability Pool - Molten Ground, Flame Body, Regal Challenge, Rivalry

Capabilities - Quick, Mountable, Heater

Skills - Proficient Command, Athletics & Combat

Legendary Details**Raging Inferno** [Signature Attack]

Scene x2- Physical- Fire, 6, Ranged Blast 3- AC 3- DB 12

Effect: If the User is enraged, all Spaces within the Range of this Attack have Fire Hazards created in it. After Damage Calculations, the user may become Enraged. Smite. Spirit Surge.

Infernal Mane [Signature Ability]

Static

Effect: Whenever the user would burn an Enemy, they cannot be cured of the Affliction. The user's Fire Type Attacks have a 18+ Effect Range to Burn all Targets or have existing Burn Ranges increased by +2.

Fiery Dominion [Signature Aura]

Effect: All Fire within 10m of the User may be extinguished as a Swift or Extended Action. As a Swift Action, the User may Target a Fire Hazard and expand it, creating 3 more adjacent to the Targeted Hazard. The user has a Boon to Command and Intimidate Checks against Fire Type Pokemon.

Entei [Stage 3]

Base Details

HP- 12 | ATK 20 | DEF 14 | SP ATK 14 | SP DEF 8 | SPD 12

Ability Pool - Molten Ground, Flame Body, Regal Challenge, Rivalry

Capabilities - Quick, Mountable, Heater

Skills - Proficient Command, Athletics & Combat

Legendary Details

Raging Inferno [Signature Attack]

Scene x2- Physical- Fire, 6, Ranged Blast 3- AC 3- DB 14

Effect: All Spaces within the Range of this Attack have Fire Hazards created in it. If the User is Enraged when these Hazards are created, they cannot be removed and persist until the end of the Scene. After Damage Calculations, the user may become Enraged. Smite. Spirit Surge.

Infernal Mane [Signature Ability]

Static

Effect: Whenever the user would burn an Enemy, they cannot be cured of the Affliction. While an Enemy is burned this way, they cannot gain Temporary hit Points. The user's Fire Type Attacks have a 17+ Effect Range to Burn all Targets or have existing Burn Ranges increased by +3.

Fiery Dominion [Signature Aura]

Effect: All Fire within 10m of the User may be extinguished as a Swift or Extended Action. As a Swift Action, the User may Target a Fire Hazard and expand it, creating 3 more adjacent to the Targeted Hazard. The user passes all Command or Intimidate Checks against Fire Type Pokemon that don't have a Boss Template. If they could, the GM will have an opposed Command or Intimidate vs Focus Check.

2. Catchable Legendaries

In this implementation, Legendaries and Mythical Pokemon are exactly that, myths and stories. There is likely only one of each in existence but they don't have any reality bending powers, just unique ones. In this version, they're simply rare Pokemon so they would entirely be used by other Trainers and be traded around frequently, or even be a valuable commodity as to who controls them. They should very much be difficult bosses, however beatable.

Base Stat wise, they should be around 70 Total which you can distribute based on how you feel. Additionally, These Pokemon should likely appear starting around Trainer Level 8 at the earliest, but the later they appear, the more power they should be given. Legendaries should obviously always have Boss Templates, either Alpha or Guardian of your choice.

Two versions of Entei are listed on the next page, **one as a Level 50 Roaming Boss** and one as a **Level 80 Guardian of the Volcano**. Anything you grant a Legendary at this stage or above should be subject to your discretion whether or not it stays post capture, much like other bosses.

Entei - Roaming [Level 50 Legendary]**Boss Attributes****Raging Inferno** [Signature Attack]

Scene x2- Physical- Fire, 6, Ranged Blast 3- AC 3- DB 12

Effect: If the User is enraged, this Attack has the Smite Keyword. After Damage Calculations, the user becomes Enraged.

Infernal Mane [Unique Ability]

Static

Effect: Whenever the user would burn an Enemy, they cannot be cured of the Affliction via Save Checks.

Infernal Temper [Boss Condition]

Effect: Upon the User breaking an HP Bar, their next Fire Type Attack automatically causes all Targets to become Burned

Entei - Guardian of the Volcano [Level 80 Legendary]**Boss Attributes****Raging Inferno** [Signature Attack]

Scene x2- Physical- Fire, 6, Ranged Blast 3- AC 3- DB 14

Effect: If the User is enraged, this Attack has the Sureshot Keyword. All Enemies become Vortexed if they are Burned or took Super Effective Damage from this Attack. After Damage Calculations, the user becomes Enraged.

Infernal Mane [Unique Ability]

Static

Effect: Whenever the user would burn an Enemy, they cannot be cured of the Affliction via Save Checks. Additionally, Enemies cannot restore Hit Points while burned by the User.

Volcanic Eruption [Unique Lair Action]

Effect: When this Lair Action is triggered, volcanic stones rain down in the field. All non-Fire Combatants must pass a Tough CR (3) Acrobatics Check or else they become Burned.

Volcanic Flood [Unique Lair Action]

Effect: When this Lair Action is triggered, the user may place up to 20 Lava Hazards on the Field. These Hazards enter the field at the end of the next Round but are treated as a projected zone until then. When this Hazard is Triggered, the Combatant becomes Burned and loses two ticks of Hit Points.



3. Divine Entity Legendaries

In this implementation, Legendaries are Divine Entities that have powers far beyond normal Pokemon. Unlike the other implementations, these Pokemon cannot be captured but if you're able to, they use the template of one of the other two Implementations and are likely an avatar of that Legend that follows the Player.

The difficult part of this is that the power of each legendary tends to be subjective based on the power of the campaign so instead, we'll divide Divine Legendaries into [3 Tiers](#). Whenever you want the Players to encounter a Legend, choose one of the tiers to determine what it gains. It should be noted that you stat these Pokemon in a similar way as if you were doing the catchable Legend implementation, each with their own Signature Abilities and Attacks and treated as a Boss, however they should definitely be a Guardian Boss. Below each of the tiers is also a brief description on **Brands, Blessings and Aspects**, which will be further developed in its own expansion, this is just a quick bandaid implementation so something exists before i go in depth.

Lower Pantheon

These Pokemon are Level 100. These Pokemon usually hold dominion over a small aspect of your universe and their Aspect would use its lower effect. These Legendaries have their own brand but it can be removed by either a Legend of a Higher+ Pantheon or a high ranking servant of one of those Legendaries. These Pokemon are likely beatable around Trainer Level 10-15

Higher Pantheon

These Pokemon are Level 150. These Pokemon usually hold dominion over a large aspect of your universe and their Aspect would use its higher and lower effect. These Legendaries have their own brand but it can only be removed by an Absolute Pantheon Legendary or one of their higher ranking servants. These Pokemon are likely beatable around Trainer Level 15-20.

Absolute Pantheon

These Pokemon are Level 300 and are not intended to be beaten in combat as they are too strong. They shouldn't be fought at all really but if you do intend to beat them, there needs to be some sort of assistance that either weakens them to a Higher Pantheon Level or provides massive assistance to the Party. Brands given by Absolute Pantheon Legendaries cannot be removed by anyone else. They also hold dominion over a very large and impactful part of your universe and its effects should be overwhelming.

Brands

Brands are the name for narrative penalties that a Legendary can inflict on those it dislikes. Consider these curses that are applied to a Player or Pokemon until a condition is met. Brands can only be applied by Legendaries depending on their Pantheon Tier. Lower Pantheons can only brand someone if they're in a state of submission or defeat with physical touch. Higher Pantheon Legendaries can only do so if they're within 10 Meters, regardless of their health. Absolute Pantheon Legendaries can do so at any point. Brands however can only be formed as a contract where they each have a condition that must be met in order to remove it. Other than meeting this condition, they can only be removed by a ritual from Legendaries that are stronger than the bestower or a servant of the Legendary that has a high enough status.

Infernal Brand

Effect: At the start of a Scene, the user becomes Burned. Enemy Fire Attacks within 10m cannot be resisted by any means. This brand has been bestowed due to the wrath of the user. Whenever the bestower is convinced that measures have been made to rectify this behavior or a suitable amount of favor has been gained, this Brand is removed.

Aspects

Consider Aspects as stronger Abilities that are indicators of the divine powers that a Legendary has. Each Aspect has a lower and higher effect based on the Pantheon that the Legend occupies. Aspects are meant to be strong, so have some ways that Players can temporarily disable them until the end of the next round! Some methods could be depleting an HP Bar, destroying some artifact on the field or being lucky after hitting them with an effective tactic (Such as a luck roll after a Super Effective attack). Aspects tend to be based on the domain a Legend controls such as the following:

Aspect of Revival

Lower: The User may Target an Adjacent Ally as a Standard Action and revive them, setting them to 5 Ticks of Hit Points. This may only be performed once per enemy Player.

Higher: Whenever the User loses an HP Bar, they are cured of all Status Afflictions. The User's allies faint at -50% HP.

Blessings

As you gain favor with a Legendary Pokemon, they may grant you blessings based on your devotion that are within its power to do so. Gifts should be considered an equivalent to a Talent or Feature that is based around what the legend is capable of. Depending on the Pantheon the Legendary is in usually determines the strength of their Gifts. Gifts can be given as a reward by the GM from the Legend with the Blessing below as an example

Blessing of the Sun

Effect: The user gains the Drought Ability

Blessing of Infernal Rage

Effect: The user may become Burned and Enraged as a Free Action. While they're enraged, their Damaging Attack may be used as if they were Fire Type.

Blessing of the Volcanic Leader

Effect: The user gains a Boon to Command and Intimidate Checks against Fire Type Pokemon.

